Curating Political Information: Who Shares What with Whom?

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Abstract

Political information reaches people through others who share it. In four experiments with US and German adults and professional journalists, I study *what* governs people's decisions to share information. Senders favor facts aligned with their own political positions, even with prior knowledge held fixed and although they rate the facts as credible. When eliciting senders' expectations, provision responds to the fact's alignment, the factual correction and persuasion senders expect it to produce, as well as the political distance between sender and receiver. When receivers are randomly assigned to make a real political donation, senders appear to select more on the facts they expect to move receivers toward the senders' own political positions, with no detectable change in selection on the expected factual correction. Professional journalists exhibit similar alignment-based selection with competition, ownership and audience demand removed. Receivers whose sender withheld a fact hold substantially less accurate beliefs than receivers shown it. Receivers underestimate how often senders disclose and perceive little of how disclosure depends on the fact. Importantly, selection among true facts distorts information supply without any falsehood, a margin that current policy interventions, such as fact-checking, do not target.

JEL classification: D83, D82, C91, D72, L82

Key words: Information Provision, Selective Disclosure, Political Information, Media Bias

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1 Introduction

Political information reaches people through others who share it (Bakshy et al. 2015, Guess et al. 2023, Wang et al. 2024, Shearer et al. 2024). Journalists and editors decide whether to include a finding in an article their readers see, and fact-checkers whether to examine a politician's statement for their audience. Outside professional settings, people frequently choose whether to raise what they know in conversation and whether to post an article to their followers (Altay et al. 2025, Eddy et al. 2026).

These decisions matter as they affect how well informed the public can be and thereby the functioning of democracies. Accordingly, much legislation—most notably the EU Digital Services Act—aims to address distortion in information supply.[1] Understanding people's motives and considerations for supplying information is a prerequisite for effectively designing any such interventions. Therefore, this paper investigates which motives drive individual decisions to share or withhold information, when they matter, how they are traded off, and how withholding affects others' beliefs and policy views.

Politically slanted supply of information is documented among fact-checkers, politicians, and social-media users (Louis-Sidois 2025, Freitag et al. 2021, Shin and Thorson 2017). However, observed choices alone do not reveal motivations. People may pass on aligned information disproportionately because they are more likely to encounter it, or because they are more skeptical of unaligned information's truthfulness or relevance. People may also value providing information that supports their own position for its own sake, or value what it would do to the other's beliefs or actions. Professional information suppliers additionally respond to competition, ownership, and audience demand.

Prior work provides evidence for several of these explanations. Partisan polarization predicts the sharing of real news and low-credibility news (Osmundsen et al. 2021). Moralization and attitude extremity amplify aligned sharing (Marie et al. 2023). Marie and Petersen (2025) find that Twitter users who believe their followers share their politics post more links from news outlets on their own side. In their experiments, having people imagine posting to fellow partisans rather than to opponents increases willingness to share news that favors their party. Thaler (2025) shows that paying senders to be rated truthful can lead them to supply false messages that confirm receivers' motivated beliefs, and Guriev et al. (2026) find evidence for reputation concerns and partisan persuasion, while partisan signaling appears comparatively less important. Among professional suppliers, slant also responds to audience composition, to ownership, and to the number of competitors (e.g., Gentzkow and Shapiro 2010, Martin and

[1] Other instruments address online safety (the UK's Online Safety Act), electoral integrity (the Canada Elections Act), media independence and pluralism (the European Media Freedom Act), and content provision (Canada's Broadcasting Act).

McCrain 2019, Gentzkow and Shapiro 2006).

Most of this evidence comes from observation of broadcast sharing, or from experimentally varying (hypothetical) audiences consisting of several individuals. A single decision to share then aggregates expected effects on many people at once, and those effects need not point the same way. Therefore, expected returns to sharing with particular people cannot be separated without maintained assumptions about the sender's objective.[2] Separating those returns instead requires eliciting what people expect a specific fact to do to one particular other person, for every pairing of the two. Canonical disclosure models supply a natural framework for this direct exchange, and assume the sender's objective is to change the receiver's belief and action (Grossman 1981, Milgrom 1981). Whether this framework fully describes how people share political information is unclear.

In this paper, I show which returns predict senders' choices and examine how consequences change the relevance of these returns. Senders decide to share or withhold information that supports and cuts against their position for receivers with different political positions and knowledge. Each decision concerns one fact and one designated receiver, so provision is measured individually rather than averaged over an audience. The facts are assigned from a direction-balanced pool and decided one at a time, so sharing one fact does not eliminate the chance to share another. What the receiver knows of the sender's political position is fixed independently of provision, so sharing cannot be used to signal the sender's policy view. Experiments 2 and 3 additionally elicit senders' forecasts of the effect of receiving a fact on the accuracy of receivers' beliefs and on their policy views, allowing me to estimate how provision responds to them. Finally, Experiments 1 and 2 randomize whether the receiver takes political action: this identifies how consequentiality changes alignment-based selection in Experiment 1 and how it changes selection on the elicited returns in Experiment 2.

I study only true information for three reasons. First, while individual false content spreads faster and further than true content (Vosoughi et al. 2018), it is only about 1 percent of Americans' news consumption and 0.15 percent of their total media diet (Allen et al. 2020), exposure is concentrated among a small minority of heavy consumers (Budak et al. 2024), and sharing it is rare (Guess et al. 2019). The behavior that needs explaining persists even without false statements. Second, restricting to true statements limits the effect of lie aversion (Abeler et al. 2019) and reputational concerns about accuracy. Third, selection among truths alone can distort what a receiver believes with no false statement (Bowen et al. 2023). The consequences of selection can be similar to those of false content.

[2]Direct sender–receiver communication is typically studied with direct financial incentives attached to the message, as in Thaler (2025). That setting is important but uncommon for non-professional information suppliers.

I find that people respond to three dimensions when sharing political information. First, people respond to the content of the information. People value sharing what supports their position beyond signaling their position, whoever receives it. Second, people respond to others' identity. People share less with others who are politically distant, whatever the information. Third, people respond to how they expect information to affect others: what specific information does to a particular recipient. People value correcting false beliefs and persuading toward their own political position. Importantly, when others face a consequential choice, the evidence suggests that provision responds more strongly to the expected persuasion, with no detectable change in its response to the expected belief correction. Withholding has strong downstream consequences for receivers. Those who face withheld information hold substantially less accurate beliefs, and receivers underestimate how often senders disclose and perceive little of how disclosure depends on the sender–fact alignment.

Experiment 1 documents alignment-based selection despite high perceived credibility and a corrective rationale for providing every fact. Each of 1,200 quota-sampled U.S. adults decides whether to provide four immigration facts, two supporting each side, to receivers who did not answer a corresponding factual question correctly. Prior knowledge is elicited before any provision decision, and the receiver never learns that such a decision occurred. Comparing choices for receivers who do not make a real political donation with choices for receivers who do, aligned facts are provided 6.7 percentage points more often than unaligned facts in the former and 13.3 points more often in the latter. Disbelief accounts for at most a fraction of these gaps: senders rate 97.2 percent of facts credible, and even attributing all differential non-credibility of unaligned facts to disbelief bounds that channel at 2.4 points. The alignment gap does not, however, inform whether an expression or persuasion motive drives it. Senders expect movement toward their own position for 78.0 percent of aligned facts and 17.2 percent of unaligned facts, so expression and persuasion returns largely overlap.

Experiment 2 makes the returns separately estimable and shows provision responds to them. Each of 1,548 quota-sampled German adults makes separate provision decisions over five facts in one of two policy domains. A provided fact reaches a matched receiver with probability one half. Senders observe each receiver's political position, while receivers learn the senders' positions independently of provision. Alignment therefore varies with the sender–fact pairing, whereas expected correction and persuasion additionally vary with the particular receiver. For every fact–receiver pairing, senders give incentivized forecasts of how receipt changes the accuracy of receivers' beliefs (the expected accuracy gain) and their political positions (the expected persuasion). Provision rises with a fact's alignment with the sender's position, with its expected accuracy gain and with its expected persuasion, and falls with sender–receiver political distance. Randomly assigning receivers to make a real donation does not de-

tectably increase the alignment bias, and the slant of provision is the same in both treatments. The evidence suggests, however, that it changes what senders select on: provision responds more strongly to the expected persuasion, while its response to the expected accuracy gain shows no detectable change. Provision also falls less steeply with political distance. Importantly, the elicited expectations are similarly distributed in both treatments, so political action appears to affect how senders act on them rather than what they expect.

Experiment 3 shows that alignment-based selection and response to receiver-specific returns and receiver identity persist among professional journalists. A sample of 309 professional German journalists faces Experiment 2's political-donation setting. Journalists provide aligned facts 20.4 percentage points more often than unaligned facts. Within journalists, a fact's alignment with their position, expected accuracy gain, and expected persuasion each positively predict provision, while provision falls with political distance. Under common controls, journalists provide 9.7 points more than the general population. Their alignment gap is larger partly because they hold stronger policy views. Comparing senders with equally strong policy views reveals no detectable difference in how positional alignment predicts provision. Their forecasts respond more strongly to the persuasive opportunity created by the assigned fact–receiver pairing. Journalists' individual choices are thus selective, and produce slant, with competition, ownership and audience demand removed.

Experiment 4 shows that receivers facing withheld information are left with substantially less accurate beliefs and perceive little of the selection they face. Each of 1,043 German adults is matched to a sender from Experiment 2 or 3. Receivers whose sender withheld have nearly twice the posterior squared error of receivers receiving the fact. Among fact–receiver pairs selected for provision. Even when a fact arrives, receivers close only about a third of the belief gap available to close. A fact moves receivers' factual beliefs but not detectably their policy views.[3] A quarter of receivers expect equal disclosure rates independent of the fact's alignment with the sender and they underestimate how often senders disclose. Lastly, belief updates after non-receipt do not track the movement implied by receivers' own stated disclosure rates.

The paper makes four contributions. First, observed selectivity bundles several returns outside signaling and reputation motives. Senders value providing information aligned with their own position for its own sake, and they also value the factual correction and the change in political position that receipt would produce. The observed decision trades these returns off at once, so an alignment measure cannot on its own separate the returns behind the choices it describes. Separating them shows that senders select on *whom* as well as on *what*. Provision falls with the political distance and

[3]Notably, senders' forecasts for these receivers anticipate the factual belief updating while overstating the change in policy views.

the elicited returns do not explain it: senders expect more change in political position from distant receivers and the same factual correction. Second, what senders act on depends on the circumstances. When the receiver makes a real donation, the evidence suggests that provision responds more strongly to the expected persuasion, with no detectable change in its response to the expected accuracy gain, while in Experiment 2 the slant of provision is unchanged. Senders appear to value the receiver choosing closer to their own policy views more than the receiver choosing under correct beliefs. Third, journalists' choices produce a supply slanted toward their own positions even without extrinsic incentives such as competition, ownership and audience demand. Fourth, selectivity distorts beliefs downstream without any falsehood, and receivers perceive little of it.

These results bear on the policy debate on distorted political information and media bias in four ways. First, most of the current architecture built against distortion focuses on falsehoods: fact-checking and content labels adjudicate what was said, literacy campaigns train receivers to sort true from false, and accuracy prompts raise the salience of veracity. The selectivity documented operates on true information alone and distorts beliefs. Current instruments do not target it. Second, which return drives selection indicates which instrument could reach it. A consequential receiver choice appears to shift selection toward expected persuasion. Instruments that appeal to senders' concern for correct beliefs act on the return that does not strengthen when the receiver's choice carries real consequences, as it does around elections. Provision also falls with political distance although senders expect the same factual correction from distant receivers, so corrective opportunities go unused when sender–receiver political distance is large. Third, journalists' individual choices are selective, and produce slant, even with competition, ownership and audience demand removed. To the extent such choices shape what outlets publish, remedies that act on market structure alone would not reach them. Fourth, remedies aimed at receivers act on the content they see, e.g., evaluating a claim, checking a source, weighing a label. However, receivers here perceive little of the selection they face, and adopt only part of a true fact when it arrives. An instrument that makes selectivity more visible may plausibly help, though evaluating such an intervention goes beyond this paper's scope.

Related literature. I relate to five strands of literature on distortions in information markets.

First, a literature treats political communication as a means of expressing or managing the speaker's own identity. Expressive acts may provide identity-confirming utility (Hillman 2010), while observable actions may be chosen for what others infer about one's type (Bénabou and Tirole 2006). Experimentally, providing social cover increases willingness to voice stigmatized positions and changes audience inferences and sanc-

tions (Bursztyn et al. 2023a), and making political-attitude reports public shifts them toward socially acceptable positions and makes them less informative (Braghieri 2024). Here, the receiver learns the sender's stated position independently of provision, so disclosure cannot signal it. I study what people value when communicating about the state of the world.

A second literature investigates incentives in the news market as an explanation for slant. Models of profit-maximizing outlets predict slant toward consumers' priors, disciplined by later verification of the state and by the number of independently owned competitors (Gentzkow and Shapiro 2006). Competition need not reduce slant when readers hold opposed priors (Mullainathan and Shleifer 2005), and it can reduce the number of facts reported (Zhu and Dukes 2015). Empirically, consumer demand predicts measured slant (Gentzkow and Shapiro 2010), though political control (Durante and Knight 2012) and ownership (Martin and McCrain 2019, Cagé et al. 2022) also move content, and capture by incumbents weakens government accountability (Besley and Prat 2006, Prat and Strömberg 2013). Experimentally, attention incentives lead to more emotional and negative headlines (Berger 2026). Journalists' own ideology travels with them, though outlet policy views dominate (Boxell and Conway 2022), and most article-level slant variance lies within rather than between outlets (Braghieri et al. 2025). Competition, ownership and audience demand operate together in the field, and Experiment 3 removes them and investigates whether individual choices still produce slant.

A third literature examines what information receivers want and how they respond to it. Individuals seek and avoid information for reasons beyond its instrumental value (Golman et al. 2022), and in politics they disproportionately seek agreeing and avoid disconfirming information (Peterson and Iyengar 2021). Readers punish an outlet for selectively reporting one of two true statistics, but only when the selection runs against their own side (Chopra et al. 2024), strong ideologues reduce their demand for an outlet that shares their views when it is fact-checked (Chopra et al. 2022), and viewers choose opinion programming to inform factual estimates (Bursztyn et al. 2023b). Encountered information is then processed unevenly, with belief-threatening signals given less weight (Eil and Rao 2011, Möbius et al. 2021, Barron 2021) or selectively forgotten (Zimmermann 2020). In politics the trust placed in a message tracks its agreement with the reader's views (Thaler 2024). That work investigates selectivity and valuation within receivers while I focus on senders.

A fourth literature investigates senders' decisions to share or select among true information, and the effect on receivers. In canonical models, senders disclose both favorable and unfavorable information as silence is informative to receivers (Grossman 1981, Milgrom 1981). Unraveling attenuates when the receiver is unsure the sender is informed (Dye 1985, Jung and Kwon 1988) or when disclosure is costly (Verrecchia

1983). In the laboratory disclosure falls short of the benchmark (Jin et al. 2021, Benndorf et al. 2025), and related designs find that senders reliably select the evidence favoring their preferred conclusion (Degan et al. 2023, Burdea et al. 2023). Farina et al. (2026) separate withholding from selection and find that receivers do not fully correct for the selection they face, though their sender faces a single randomly matched receiver, so the object selected is which signal to disclose, never whom to address.[4] When senders pass on only aligned true news, receivers read too little into the resulting silence, and information is imprecise, beliefs polarize although no signal is false, in a model that takes sharing behavior as given (Bowen et al. 2023). The same misperception is formalized in models of receivers who do not fully account for what a sender knows (Eyster and Rabin 2005, Fong et al. 2025). Neither environment here is predicted to unravel fully: the decision is invisible in Experiment 1, and in Experiments 2 and 3 a provided fact arrives with probability one half. Experiment 4 measures receivers' anticipation of selectivity when they know the sender's policy position.

A fifth literature studies remedies against distortion in information supply. Fact-checking reduces engagement with claims rated outright false (Cagé et al. 2025) and lowers the rate at which they are shared (Henry et al. 2022), accuracy nudges improve discernment between true and false headlines (Pennycook et al. 2021), and media literacy produces broader and more persistent reductions in the perceived credibility of false posts (Berger et al. 2025).[5] Fact-checking nonetheless leaves intact the persuasive effect of the falsehoods it corrects (Barrera et al. 2020). Beliefs keep moving after a false signal is rendered uninformative, more for narratives than statistics (Musolff et al. 2026). Comparing remedies within one design, Guriev et al. (2026) find that a content-neutral accuracy prime reduces the sharing of false posts while leaving true posts untouched, whereas offering a fact-check suppresses both. Removing reshared content wholesale cuts exposure to political news and untrustworthy sources, and lowers news knowledge within the experimental sample (Guess et al. 2023). Selection among truths produces a distortion none of these measures targets.

The rest of the paper proceeds as follows. Section 2 presents Experiment 1, which documents selection among facts and the increase in alignment-based selectivity when the receiver's take political action. Section 3 develops a conceptual framework for sender behavior. Section 4 presents Experiment 2, which separates the respone to different returns. Section 5 presents Experiment 3, which takes the same decision to professional journalists. Section 6 presents Experiment 4, which measures the effect of withholding on receivers' belief accuracy. Section 7 discusses the implications and

[4]Cheap talk (Crawford and Sobel 1982) and Bayesian persuasion (Kamenica and Gentzkow 2011) vary the message technology and the sender's commitment power. Manili (2024) adds motivated belief formation on the receiver's side, and Suvorov et al. (2024) join selective supply to its measured cost for ego-relevant information, under motives that are posited rather than elicited.

[5]Lazer et al. (2018) review the evidence and the interventions.

concludes.

2 Experiment 1: Selective Provision of Facts

Experiment 1 provides evidence that senders selectively provide true information, and that downstream political action increases selection on alignment. The design makes several accounts of a slant in what senders provide other than selection on alignment—differential exposure, differential prior knowledge, disbelief, and signaling to the receiver—poor explanations of the pattern.

2.1 Design and Hypotheses

Experimental timeline. The experiment proceeds in three steps (Figure 1). I first elicit senders' prior knowledge about four immigration facts and measure their policy views through a donation decision. I then elicit their beliefs about the persuasiveness of information. Finally, senders make one provision decision per fact, each directed at a specific receiver, and a closing questionnaire records stated motivations, credibility assessments, and demographics.

Facts about immigration. Table 1 presents the four facts, selected from authoritative sources and balanced across policy directions. I validated them in a pre-registered survey ($N = 100$) that tested a larger candidate pool against criteria of veracity, perceived credibility, policy relevance, and directional balance.[6] Each is formulated as an invertible binary comparison, so beliefs are correct or incorrect.

Table 1: Facts Shown to Senders

Direction	Fact
Pro	The crime rate of immigrants is *lower* than that of U.S.-born Americans.
Pro	The labor force participation of immigrants is *higher* than that of U.S.-born Americans
Anti	The average number of unauthorized border crossings is *higher* in the last five years compared to historical averages.
Anti	When comparing what first-generation immigrants use in government services versus what they pay in taxes, the net cost is *higher* than the same calculation for U.S.-born Americans at the state and local levels.

Notes: The facts are those used in Experiment 1, as verbatim claims shown to senders. Direction (Pro) = supports more-permissive immigration policy (Anti) = supports more-restrictive policy. Sourced from statistical offices and research institutes. Senders face all facts in random order. Pre-validation details in Appendix A.1.

[6] Appendix A.1 describes the validation survey and the final selection.

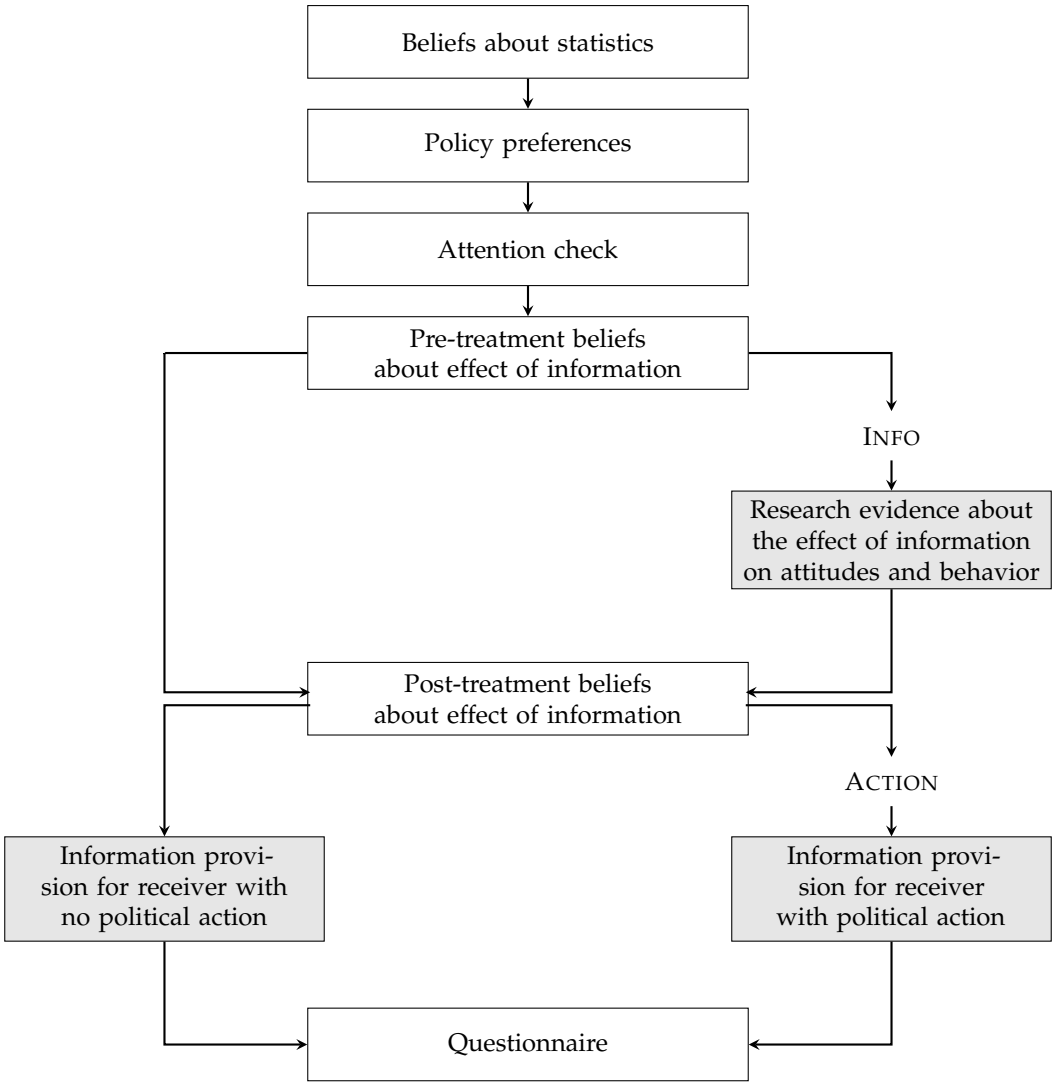


Figure 1: Timeline of Experiment 1

Prior knowledge. I first elicit senders' prior knowledge. They complete each comparative statement, in random order, as "higher," "lower," or "don't know." Responses are incentivized: correct completions receive a bonus, incorrect completions do not, and "don't know" responses receive the bonus with 25% probability. Senders are then told the correct answer for each.

Policy views. I measure senders' policy views in an incentivized donation task: each sender allocates $500 between the *American Immigration Council* (AIC), which advocates for increased immigration, and *NumbersUSA*, which advocates for decreased immigration. Senders are shown each organization's position in the organization's own words before deciding.[7]

[7] Appendix A.2 describes the incentivized prior-knowledge elicitation and the donation task.

Receiver belief states. For each sender, each fact is assigned to exactly one future receiver who will have either completed the comparative statement incorrectly or reported not knowing. The sender observes which case applies before deciding. Senders know they are deciding for receivers who are unaware that a disclosure decision was made. If information is provided, it appears as part of the survey flow. If information is withheld, the receiver does not learn they could have received information. Non-disclosure therefore carries no inferential content about the sender.

Treatments. Table 2 summarizes the four design dimensions. Two vary within sender and two between.

Table 2: Experimental Design and Identifying Variation

Dimension	Variation	Levels
Alignment with statistic	Within-subject	*Aligned* and *Unaligned*
Political action (ACTION)	Between-subject	ACTION = 1 and ACTION = 0
Receiver belief state	Within-subject	*False belief* and *Don't know*
Effect of information (INFO)	Between-subject	INFO = 1 and INFO = 0

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1 (N = 1,200 U.S. adults, Prolific, quota-sampled). Within-subject dimensions: each sender decides on all four statistics, yielding 4 decisions per sender; each statistic's receiver belief state is drawn independently with probability one half. Between-subject dimensions are randomly assigned.

The primary within-sender dimension is alignment. A fact is *aligned* for a sender if the policy side it favors matches their own policy view, and *unaligned* otherwise. As each side has two facts favoring it, a non-indifferent sender faces two of each. Receiver belief state is drawn independently for each fact: each fact is randomly assigned to a receiver who either holds a false belief or reports not knowing. Between senders, the primary dimension is ACTION, under which receivers make the same incentivized donation decision as senders and otherwise complete the experiment without further decisions.[8] A second between-sender treatment, INFO, shows half of the senders the results of an information experiment that shifted attitudes toward immigrants (Haaland and Roth 2020). It is designed to shift their beliefs about how persuasive the facts are. Crossing it with ACTION gives the four cells CONTROL, ACTION, INFO and ACTION × INFO. Where a comparison names a single cell, ACTION and INFO denote the cell with only that treatment. Elsewhere they denote the treatment.

Hypotheses. I pre-registered four hypotheses about how senders provide information.

[8]Through randomization, any difference in alignment-based selectivity is attributable to the downstream political consequence, under the maintained assumption that ACTION operates only through that consequence. ACTION may also shift the salience of the decision and the sender's construal of the task.

Hypothesis 1.0 (Baseline provision). *Provision rates for both aligned and unaligned information exceed the indifference benchmark of* 50% *in* CONTROL.

Hypothesis 1.1 (Alignment-based selectivity). *Senders provide aligned information at strictly higher rates than unaligned information in* CONTROL.[9]

Hypothesis 1.2 (ACTION increase). *The alignment gap in provision is larger in* ACTION *than* CONTROL.

Hypothesis 1.3 (INFO increase). *The alignment gap in provision is larger in* INFO *than* CONTROL.

2.2 Results

2.2.1 Sample, Incentives, and Protocol

The sender experiment was run on Prolific from July 16 to August 12, 2025, quota-sampled on age, gender, ethnicity, and party identification.[10] This study was approved by the Ethics Council of the Max Planck Society under the Generalized Approval of Experiments Following the Protocol that is Standard in Experimental Economics (approval no. 2018_3 Renewal 2024_28) and was pre-registered on AsPredicted (No. 238343). Of 1,257 starters, 57 were excluded for failing the attention check, switching tabs during the fact questions, or timing out, leaving $N = 1{,}200$. The pre-registered screen for automated responses, based on typing speed and keystroke patterns, flagged no participant. Senders took a median of 17.26 minutes and earned \$3.32 on average.[11] Receiver data were collected on Prolific between September 1 and September 10, 2025. 96 receivers took a median of 3 minutes and earned \$0.80 on average. Each receiver was matched to one sender, so about one in twelve senders' decisions was implemented. The experiment was programmed in oTree (Chen et al. 2016).

2.2.2 Prior Knowledge, Policy Views, and Expected Attitude Change

Prior knowledge. I find substantial heterogeneity in senders' factual knowledge.[12] A majority correctly identify the facts on immigrants' crime rates (70.1%), labor force participation (79.4%), and recent border crossings (61.3%), but only 30.5% correctly assess

[9] The pre-registration words this hypothesis in terms of the direction in which senders expect a fact to move the receiver and tests it with the alignment bias. The statement here follows the registered test.

[10] Appendix Table B.1 reports the sample composition.

[11] They receive \$2.50 for participating and can earn a bonus of \$1.50, knowing that the task determining it is drawn at random: the prior-knowledge questions with probability 45%, the persuasiveness beliefs with probability 45%, and the provision task with probability 10%. The provision task pays the bonus whatever the sender decides.

[12] See Appendix Table B.2. The fiscal fact, where prior knowledge is lowest, is rated ex post as credible as the other three (Appendix Table B.3) and provided at comparable rates.

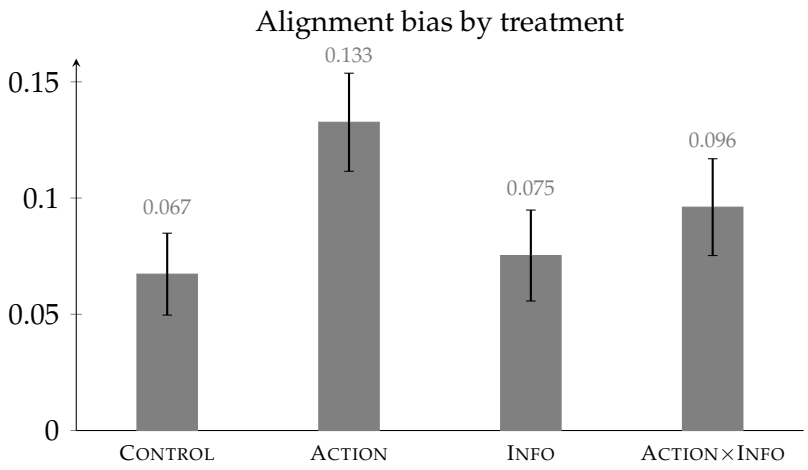


Figure 2: Alignment Bias by Treatment

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1's U.S. adults ($N = 1{,}200$, Prolific, quota-sampled). Alignment bias is the within-sender difference between the provision rate for aligned statistics and the provision rate for unaligned statistics. The figure is restricted to senders with revealed directional preference ($N = 1{,}114$, 93%; donation not an even split). Error bars are standard errors.

the net fiscal impact of first-generation immigrants. Democrats and immigration supporters are more accurate on the pro-immigration facts, Republicans and immigration opponents on the anti-immigration facts (all differences $p < 0.001$).

Policy views. 30.2% of senders allocate the entire endowment to the pro-immigration organization, 14.1% to the anti-immigration one, and 7.2% split evenly (Figure B.2). The split correlates with stated policy views ($r = 0.562$) and with political affiliation (both $p < 0.001$), elicited at the end of the experiment.

Expected attitude change. For each sender i and fact j, I define the expected attitude change $\Delta\text{Attitude}_{i,j} \in [-1, 1]$ as the net share of ten hypothetical receivers whom the sender expects to become more, rather than less, supportive of immigration after receiving fact j. These beliefs are elicited unincentivized before the provision decisions. On average senders expect each fact to move attitudes in the direction of the policy it is hypothesized to support. Among senders not shown the study results, the expected shift is 25.5 percentage points (pp) toward pro-immigration for the crime fact and 20.7 pp for the labor fact, and 29.5 pp toward anti-immigration for the border fact and 26.7 pp for the fiscal fact (all $p < 0.001$).

2.2.3 Selective Provision and the ACTION Increase

Let $y_{i,j}$ equal 1 if sender i provides fact j, and let $AIC_i \in [0, 500]$ denote i's donation to the pro-immigration group (AIC). I consider sender i pro-immigration if $AIC_i > 250$ and anti-immigration if $AIC_i < 250$. A sender's *alignment bias* is the share of their

aligned facts provided minus the share of their unaligned facts provided. It is positive when provision favors the sender's own policy position and zero when it does not.

Senders share accurate information at high rates in all four treatment conditions, including information that cuts against their own position. Unaligned provision rates range from 81.9% (ACTION) to 86.5% (CONTROL), all significantly above 50% ($p < 0.001$, one-sample t-tests).

Result 1.0 (Provision is high, including unaligned information)**.** *Senders share most unaligned facts:* 86.5 *percent in* CONTROL*, above the* 50 *percent benchmark in every treatment, confirming Hypothesis 1.0.*

Figure 2 shows that provision is selective. On average across treatments, senders provide aligned facts 9.3 pp more often than their unaligned facts, and the bias is positive in all four conditions ($p < 0.001$).[13] The bias is defined for the 1,114 senders whose donation leaves them on one side of the issue.

I combine the two into a continuous alignment measure:

$$\text{Align}_{i,j} = \begin{cases} \frac{AIC_i - 250}{250} & \text{if } j \in \{\text{crime, labor}\} \\ \frac{AIC_i - 250}{250} \cdot (-1) & \text{if } j \in \{\text{border, fiscal}\} \end{cases}$$

This measure is bounded in $[-1, 1]$.[14] Its sign records whether fact j's direction matches sender i's policy view, and its magnitude is the intensity of that policy view. Only the sign, not the magnitude, varies within a sender. Thus, the within-sender comparison is between aligned and unaligned facts and the magnitude enters as a between-sender weight. This imposes, rather than tests, the assumption that a fact is more aligned, and the alignment gap correspondingly larger, the more one-sided the sender's position. Appendix Table B.7 shows that the results are robust to dropping this assumption.

I estimate the pre-registered linear probability model:

$$\begin{aligned} y_{i,j} = \beta_0 &+ \beta_1 \,\text{Align}_{i,j} + \beta_2 \,\text{ACTION}_i + \beta_3 \,\text{INFO}_i + \beta_4 \left(\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{ACTION}_i\right) \\ &+ \beta_5 \left(\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{INFO}_i\right) + \beta_6 \left(\text{ACTION}_i \times \text{INFO}_i\right) \\ &+ \beta_7 \left(\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{ACTION}_i \times \text{INFO}_i\right) + \gamma_1 \,\text{PriorKnowledge}_{i,j} + \gamma_2 \mathbf{S}_j + \gamma_3 \mathbf{X}_i + \eta_{i,j}, \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

with standard errors clustered at the sender level. $\text{PriorKnowledge}_{i,j}$ denotes sender i's prior knowledge of fact j (1 if correct, 0.5 if "don't know," and 0 if incorrect, as pre-registered). This control adjusts for prior accuracy under the extreme assumption of no

[13] Controlling for distribution of policy views the difference is +7.6 pp (Appendix B.3).

[14] The pre-registration defined alignment on $[0, 1]$. Re-centering is a one-to-one transformation that leaves all hypothesis tests invariant.

Table 3: Treatment Effects on Information Provision

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.041^{***}	0.036^{***}	0.037^{***}
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
INFO	−0.013	−0.012	−0.012
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.017)
ACTION	−0.002	−0.002	−0.003
	(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.016)
Prior Knowledge	0.043^{***}	0.034^{***}	0.033^{***}
	(0.011)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Align × INFO	0.006	0.004	0.004
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.017)
Align × ACTION	0.041^{**}	0.041^{**}	0.041^{**}
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)
INFO × ACTION	−0.007	−0.007	−0.008
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)
Align × INFO × ACTION	−0.028	−0.027	−0.027
	(0.026)	(0.026)	(0.026)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes
No. of Senders	1200	1200	1200
Num. obs.	4800	4800	4800
R^2	0.030	0.033	0.040
Adj. R^2	0.028	0.031	0.034

Notes: The sample is $N = 1{,}200$ Experiment 1 U.S. adults recruited on Prolific (quota-sampled), with 4,800 sender-statistic observations (4 statistics per sender). The outcome is the binary provision indicator. Align is $\text{Align}_{ij} \in [-1, 1]$, the sender's donation-based policy view signed by the direction of statistic j, as defined in the text. Prior Knowledge is the incentivized prior belief correctness, elicited before senders knew they would make a provision decision. INFO is a between-subject treatment in which the sender receives personalized feedback comparing their prediction to the actual results of Haaland and Roth (2020) (see Appendix A.3). ACTION is a between-subject treatment in which the receiver makes a downstream political donation. Controls are age, gender, education, ethnicity, income, party affiliation, partisanship. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

updating. Column (1) controls only for prior knowledge. Column (2) adds fact fixed effects $\mathbf{S}_j$, and column (3) adds demographic and political controls $\mathbf{X}_i$. β_1 captures baseline alignment-based selectivity (Hypothesis 1.1), β_4 whether alignment matters more when receivers act politically (Hypothesis 1.2), and β_5 whether information about persuasiveness increases selectivity (Hypothesis 1.3). The control γ_1 estimates whether senders who had more accurate priors about the fact provide it at higher rates.

Table 3 reports the results.[15] Across all specifications, provision increases signifi-

[15] As pre-registered, Table B.5 reports the results pooled at the sender level with similar results.

cantly with alignment ($p \leq 0.003$). Senders at half the maximum policy view intensity are 3.6 to 4.1 pp more likely to share aligned facts while senders at maximum policy view intensity are 7.2 to 8.2 pp more likely to share aligned facts.

Result 1.1 (Senders favor aligned information)**.** *Senders favor aligned information: the alignment bias is* 6.7 *pp in* CONTROL*, confirming Hypothesis 1.1, and positive in every condition.*

Political consequences increase alignment-based selectivity, confirming Hypothesis 1.2. Comparing CONTROL with ACTION, the sender-level alignment bias rises from 6.7 to 13.3 pp, an increase of 6.5 pp (one-sided Holm-adjusted $p = 0.045$). The decision-level interaction $\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{ACTION}_i$ is $+0.041$ in every specification ($p \leq 0.025$).[16] Averaging over the independently randomized INFO intervention, the bias rises from 7.1 to 11.4 pp, an increase of 4.3 pp (two-sided $p = 0.037$).

Result 1.2 (ACTION increases alignment-based selectivity)**.** *Political action increases alignment-based selectivity: the alignment bias rises from* 6.7 *to* 13.3 *pp, confirming Hypothesis 1.2.*

Political action also raises the slant of provision, the mean positional alignment of the facts senders provide, which measures how far they favor the sender's own side: averaging over INFO, it rises from 0.031 in CONTROL to 0.053 in ACTION, against a mean of zero among the facts offered (two-sided $p = 0.010$).[17]

Senders provide facts about which they had accurate priors at higher rates (3.3 to 4.3 pp, $p \leq 0.006$). Controlling for prior knowledge does not attenuate the Align $\times$ ACTION interaction.

Hypothesis 1.3 is not confirmed. The INFO treatment raised the expected pro-immigration shift by 5.8 pp for the crime fact and 3.8 pp for the labor fact and did not detectably move it for the two anti-immigration facts, too little to identify effects.[18] Results here are only weakly informative. The pre-registered comparison of CONTROL with INFO gives $+0.8$ pp (one-sided $p = 0.385$), and neither the main effect of INFO nor its interaction with alignment is distinguishable from zero, including when INFO is allowed to act asymmetrically by fact direction.[19]

Result 1.3 (INFO increase not confirmed)**.** *Information about persuasiveness does not detectably change the alignment bias; Hypothesis 1.3 is not confirmed.*

The estimates are unchanged under alternative specifications including sender fixed effects, presentation-position fixed effects, and the unrestricted starter sample. No single fact drives the result (Appendix B.3).

[16] Appendix Table B.6 shows the results are robust to logistic estimation.

[17] With INFO held off, it rises from 0.028 to 0.061 (two-sided $p = 0.010$). Standard errors are clustered by sender.

[18] The first stage is reported in detail by fact in Appendix A.3.

[19] Appendix Table B.8 reports these specifications.

2.2.4 Heterogeneity and Alternative Explanations

Heterogeneity. Appendix B.4 reports pre-registered heterogeneity analyses by partisanship, political affiliation, policy view intensity and receiver belief state. Partisanship and affiliation with a political party increase selectivity in the baseline ($p = 0.001$ and $p = 0.032$) while policy view intensity points the same way ($p = 0.053$). Independents respond more strongly to political consequences, but estimates are imprecise ($p = 0.054$). The alignment-based selectivity does not detectably differ by receiver belief state.

Disbelief and prior knowledge. Selective provision could reflect selective belief: senders might withhold unaligned facts because they doubt them. Prior knowledge, incentivized and elicited before any provision decision, is controlled in every specification, and the alignment effect does not vary with it: the Align$\times$ Prior Knowledge interaction is $+0.009$ ($p = 0.579$), and the alignment coefficient is $+0.031$ for facts the sender had answered incorrectly and $+0.040$ for facts answered correctly. Perceived credibility is elicited unincentivized after the provision task. Although declaring a fact not credible would have been a costless way to rationalize withholding it, senders rate 97.2 percent of facts credible. Credibility is slightly higher for aligned facts (98.3 versus 96.0 percent). Even if every differentially non-credible unaligned fact were withheld purely from disbelief, that channel is bounded at 2.4 pp, against alignment biases of at least 6.7 pp in every treatment.[20]

Stated motives. Senders' own accounts provide descriptive evidence on the motives for their decisions. A closing question asked what considerations drove the decisions. Two in five senders gave a reason referring to the sharing decision. Those senders hold somewhat stronger issue policy views and are somewhat more partisan, yet are 4.0 pp *less* alignment-biased than the rest ($p = 0.043$). Two large language models classify each response under a fixed coding scheme, described in Appendix F.1.

Among senders giving a reason for sharing, correcting the receiver's beliefs is the most common consideration (84.9 percent), followed by influencing the receiver's opinion (7.9 percent) and expressing one's own position (2.6 percent). Appendix Table B.15 regresses each sender's alignment bias on these stated reasons. Senders citing belief correction are 9.9 pp less alignment-biased ($p < 0.001$), and senders citing persuasion or expression are more biased ($p < 0.001$). However, only persuasion is action-conditional: its association with the alignment bias rises when the receiver takes a

[20]The bound covers facts rated outright not credible; a binary rating cannot register weaker doubt about a fact still rated credible. The realized contribution is smaller still: only 41.1 percent of not-credible-labeled unaligned facts are withheld, so disbelief accounts for at most 1.0 pp of either alignment bias. Additional tests are in Appendix B.5.

political action (interaction +0.417, $p = 0.008$), while the expression coefficient is large in both treatments and its interaction with ACTION is negative and imprecise.[21] The belief-correction coefficient likewise does not move with political action. Notably, ACTION changes what senders do without changing what they report considering. The share giving a codable reason and the shares citing each consideration are indistinguishable across treatments, individually and jointly ($F = 0.443$, $p = 0.722$).

Norms. Senders who have a larger alignment bias subsequently express weaker pro-accuracy norms and policy intervention and state facts are less relevant in forming opinions. There is no difference in perceived source of disagreement: values or facts. See Appendix Table B.16 for details.

2.2.5 What Experiment 1 Does Not Identify

Four accounts of the slant in what senders provide fit the observed pattern poorly. Differential exposure cannot generate it: every sender decides over the same four facts, two favoring each side, so no fact is withheld because a sender never encountered it. The alignment effect survives among senders who knew facts on both sides, a restriction that supplies two-sided support rather than balance. A costless disbelief rationalization was available and rarely used. Nor can provision signal the sender's position, because the receiver never learns that a decision was made.

The alignment gap however does not separate expression from persuasion. A sender may value passing on facts that favor their own side, or may expect those facts to move the receiver toward it. Here, senders expect net movement toward their own position for 78.0 percent of aligned facts and 17.2 percent of unaligned ones, a gap of 60.8 pp ($p < 0.001$). A potential return to correcting beliefs is also not fully identified. Every fact goes to a receiver who holds a false belief or reports not knowing, so there is a corrective rationale by construction. Provision does not detectably vary with the receiver's factual need: receivers who have false beliefs versus those who do not know. However, the experiment never elicits the correction a sender expects provision to achieve.

3 A Conceptual Framework for Selective Sharing

Alignment-based selectivity can reflect different motives. I model what a sender gains from passing on a fact, to show *when* observed disclosure and expected returns can tell

[21] Notably, only twelve senders state an expressive reason and thus interpreted carefully. Appendix B.5 reports the cell sizes and the second classifier's replication (Appendix Table B.17).

these motives apart. The motives differ in whether she values what providing does for herself, what receipt does to the receiver, or who the receiver is.

3.1 Motives, Returns, and Utility

Environment. Nature draws a binary state of the world $\omega \in \{0, 1\}$, the sender's and the receiver's policy positions $\pi^s, \pi^r \in \mathbb{R}$, and an indicator $A \in \{0, 1\}$ for whether the receiver goes on to take a political action. The fact is a statement whose content is ω. Once received, it may be discounted, misunderstood, or incorporated imperfectly, and the receiver's belief response is left unrestricted.

Timeline. The sender observes ω, π^s, π^r and A, and then chooses whether to disclose the fact, $d = 1$, or withhold it, $d = 0$. A disclosed fact reaches the receiver, and is taken in, with a fixed arrival probability $\tau \in (0, 1]$, the same for every receiver and whether or not he takes a political action.[22] The sender knows that the receiver observes π^s regardless of her choice. If $A = 1$, the receiver then chooses a political action informed by his beliefs about the world and his policy position.

Motives and returns to disclosure. I divide the motives by whether they depend on the receiver. The *expressive motive* with weight θ_E is *receiver-invariant*. It is the value of providing a fact that validates the sender's own position, whatever it does to the receiver. Let $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ denote the *alignment* of the fact to her political position, the extent to which she perceives it as validating that position. Larger values indicate larger validation, and negative values that she regards the fact as conflicting with her position. For a given sender, alignment, the expressive return, depends only on the fact, not on who receives it or on what he goes on to do.

The other motives are *receiver-dependent*: the first two depend on the receiver's response and the third on who he is. First, the *belief-correction motive* with weight θ_B is the value of moving the receiver's beliefs toward the truth, whichever side the truth favors. Let $\tilde{b}^0$ and $\tilde{b}^1$ denote her subjective forecasts of the receiver's belief, i.e., the probability he assigns to $\omega = 1$, under non-receipt and under receipt, with $\tilde{b}^0, \tilde{b}^1 \in [0, 1]$. Neither need equal the belief he will in fact hold. The *expected gain in belief accuracy* from receipt is

$$\Delta b = |\omega - \tilde{b}^0| - |\omega - \tilde{b}^1| \in [-1, 1],$$

how much closer to the truth she expects him to be once he has the fact. It is positive whenever she expects any movement toward the truth, and negative when she expects

[22] The arrival probability captures everything that stands between sending and being consumed, e.g., an unopened message, a skimmed article, or attention in conversation. Withholding and non-arrival both leave the receiver without the fact.

receipt to move him away from it.

Second, the *persuasion motive* with weight θ_P is the value of moving him toward the sender's own position. Let $\tilde{\pi}^{r,0}$ and $\tilde{\pi}^{r,1}$ denote her forecasts of the receiver's policy position under non-receipt and under receipt. Neither need equal the position π^r she initially observes. The *expected persuasion return* is

$$\Delta\pi = |\pi^s - \tilde{\pi}^{r,0}| - |\pi^s - \tilde{\pi}^{r,1}| \in \mathbb{R},$$

the reduction she expects receipt to produce in the distance between the receiver's position and her own. Thus $\Delta\pi > 0$ means she expects receipt to move the receiver toward her, and $\Delta\pi < 0$ that she expects it to move the receiver away. Correction evaluates beliefs relative to the truth. Persuasion evaluates movement relative to the sender's own position.[23]

Third, the *relational motive* with weight θ_R is the additional value of providing any true information to a more like-minded receiver rather than a more distant one, whatever the fact. Let $\rho = |\pi^s - \pi^r|$ denote the initial political distance between the sender and the receiver.

The three returns and political distance need not move together: alignment is fixed by the fact and her position, while the two forecasts concern a particular receiver. She may expect a fact that validates her position to correct one receiver's belief a great deal without bringing him any closer to her.

Sender utility. Normalizing the utility of withholding to zero, $U(d = 0) \equiv 0$, the sender's net utility from disclosure is

$$U(d = 1) = \tau\,\theta_B(A)\,\Delta b + \theta_E(A)\,\alpha + \tau\,\theta_P(A)\,\Delta\pi - \theta_R(A)\,\rho + \kappa\,A, \tag{2}$$

where the four weights may depend on A. The returns describe what the sender expects provision to cause, and the weights describe how much she values those accomplishments. Finally, $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ shifts the value of disclosing anything when the receiver takes a political action, without changing what any return is worth at the margin. I use this linear benchmark for simplicity: the sender trades the returns at fixed rates. Every sign result below also holds when each determinant enters through its own strictly increasing transformation (Appendix H).

The arrival probability multiplies only the two returns that require the fact to arrive. Alignment and political distance arise from the act of providing and from who is at the

[23] The forecast under non-receipt is a primitive of the sender's problem and may incorporate whatever inference she expects the receiver to draw from not receiving the fact. When $\tau < 1$, non-receipt pools deliberate withholding with non-arrival and need not reveal the disclosure choice. When $\tau = 1$, non-receipt reveals withholding.

other end, not from the receiver's response to what is sent.

Excluded motives. The receiver's response could affect the sender's payoff through his beliefs about the world and his position, or through what he comes to *believe about her*. Equation (2) includes only the former. Because he observes her position in any case, disclosure earns no return from revealing that she holds one. Any discounting of the fact enters through her forecasts of his response, and I assign no separate return to its perceived credibility or to signaling an ability to tell true from false. Returns to how the sender is judged lie outside this analysis (see Braghieri 2024, Bursztyn et al. 2023a, Guriev et al. 2026).[24]

3.2 Disclosure and Selection

Disclosure decision. The sender discloses if and only if this utility exceeds an idiosyncratic shock capturing unmodeled determinants of disclosure, $U(d = 1) > \varepsilon$.

Assumption 1 (Conditional disclosure shocks)**.** *Conditional on A, the disclosure shock ε is distributed with a treatment-specific CDF F_A that does not vary with $(\Delta b, \alpha, \Delta\pi, \rho)$, has full support on $\mathbb{R}$, and has strictly positive density $f_A = F_A'$.*

Write $x = (\Delta b, \alpha, \Delta\pi, \rho)$ for the four determinants and $U_A(x)$ for the utility of disclosure in Equation (2) under A. The probability of disclosure is therefore

$$\Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A) = F_A\big(U_A(x)\big). \tag{3}$$

For a given A, disclosure is more likely the more it is worth to the sender.

Selectivity.

Proposition 1 (Selection)**.** *Fix A. Under Assumption 1, holding the other determinants fixed, the probability of disclosure*

(i) rises with the expected accuracy gain Δb if $\theta_B(A) > 0$,

(ii) rises with alignment α if $\theta_E(A) > 0$,

(iii) rises with the expected persuasion return $\Delta\pi$ if $\theta_P(A) > 0$, and

(iv) falls with political distance ρ if $\theta_R(A) > 0$.

[24] Neither the observed position nor the truth of the fact removes every such inference. A receiver may still read how informed or how selective she is, and which fact she picks may convey how strongly she holds her position. Those inferences are assumed away.

In each case the probability response to a determinant x_j, $f_A(U_A)\,\partial U_A/\partial x_j$, has the sign of its marginal utility $\partial U_A/\partial x_j$.

The relational motive does not depend on the fact. When $\theta_R(A) > 0$, it makes her more willing to disclose to a like-minded receiver. A decline in disclosure with political distance reflects this motive only if distance does not stand in for receiver responses the returns omit. Assumption 1 maintains this.[25]

A higher disclosure rate for aligned facts is consistent with expression, persuasion, or correction. When the facts that validate a sender's position are also those she expects to persuade, as in Section 2, or to correct, she discloses aligned facts more often even if she places no value on alignment itself. Telling the motives apart requires observing each return, and that none moves in lockstep with the others.[26]

Assumption 2 (Separation)**.** *Across disclosure opportunities, conditional on A, none of Δb, α, $\Delta\pi$ and ρ is an exact affine function of the other three.*

3.3 The Effect of Receiver Political Action

When the receiver goes on to take a political action, what he believes and where he stands matter beyond the exchange itself. The model lets political action change how much the sender values the returns that run through the receiver's response.

Restrictions. Comparing disclosure across A reveals a change in how much the sender values a return only if her forecasts stay put. I therefore assume that she expects the same fact to do the same to the receiver's beliefs and position whether or not he later acts. Otherwise, a steeper response to the expected persuasion return under political action could equally come from her expecting the fact to persuade more. Alignment needs no such assumption, since it depends only on the fact and her position. I also assume that political action leaves the value of alignment and of political distance unchanged: action matters through what the receiver's beliefs and position lead to, and neither return runs through them.

Assumption 3 (Invariance)**.** *For the sender, (i) for a given fact and receiver, Δb and $\Delta\pi$ take the same values whether or not the receiver goes on to take a political action; (ii) $\theta_E(A) = \theta_E$; (iii) $\theta_R(A) = \theta_R$.*

[25] Canonical disclosure models let the sender value disclosure only through the receiver's response (Grossman 1981, Milgrom 1981, Dye 1985). In Equation (2), objectives of this kind are the case $\theta_E(A) = \theta_R(A) = 0$.

[26] An alternative is to shift one return experimentally while holding the others fixed. The INFO treatment of Section 2 attempted this and moved expected persuasiveness too little to be informative.

Three cases. Political action may leave the sender's valuations unchanged, $\theta_B(1) = \theta_B(0)$ and $\theta_P(1) = \theta_P(0)$. Under *consequential correction* it raises the value of correction, $\theta_B(1) > \theta_B(0)$. A sender who values the receiver holding accurate beliefs may value them more when he acts on them, because he can then make a more informed choice. This value does not depend on whether the informed choice moves toward or away from her position.

Under *consequential persuasion* it raises the value of persuasion, $\theta_P(1) > \theta_P(0)$. When a political action follows, a sender who prefers actions closer to her own position values the same expected movement more, provided a receiver closer to her position tends to choose actions she prefers. $\theta_P(1)$ then values his position both in itself and for the choice it leads to.

Proposition 2 (Consequentiality)**.** *Under Assumption 3, political action leaves the marginal utilities of alignment and political distance unchanged. It changes the marginal utility of the expected accuracy gain by $\tau[\theta_B(1) - \theta_B(0)]$ and that of the expected persuasion return by $\tau[\theta_P(1) - \theta_P(0)]$. Hence (i) if valuations are unchanged, neither moves; (ii) under consequential correction the first rises; (iii) under consequential persuasion the second rises.*

3.4 What Disclosure Reveals

Proposition 2 compares marginal utilities, but only disclosure is observed. Within a treatment, Proposition 1 links the two: each probability response has the sign of its marginal utility. Across treatments, the response to a determinant x_j, at the same x, changes by

$$f_1(U_1)\,\frac{\partial U_1}{\partial x_j} - f_0(U_0)\,\frac{\partial U_0}{\partial x_j}. \tag{4}$$

If the two densities are equal, this has the sign of the change in marginal utility, but they need not be. A change in disclosure probabilities across treatments therefore describes behavior without revealing a change in what the sender values, and a weight that does not change can still move the response. Two different restrictions each restore the comparison.

Assumption 4 (Location–scale disclosure shocks)**.** *(i) For any A the shock has a known, strictly increasing and differentiable shape G up to a location μ_A and a scale $s_A > 0$: $F_A(u) = G\big((u - \mu_A)/s_A\big)$. (ii) Where index slopes are compared across A, $s_1 = s_0$.*

In other words, political action may change how often senders disclose anything (μ_A) and how noisy their decisions are (s_A); where slopes are compared across treatments, it leaves the noise unchanged. Under part (i), transforming the disclosure probability by G^{-1} gives an index, $(U_A(x) - \mu_A)/s_A$, whose slopes are marginal utilities

divided by the scale. Write $\beta_j(A) = \partial\, G^{-1}\big(\Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A)\big)/\partial x_j$ for the index slope on determinant x_j, and $\beta_B(A)$, $\beta_E(A)$, $\beta_P(A)$ and $\beta_\rho(A)$ for the slopes on Δb, α, $\Delta\pi$ and ρ.

Corollary 1 (Index slopes and ratios)**.** *Under Assumptions 1 and 4(i),* $G^{-1}\big(\Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A)\big) = (U_A(x) - \mu_A)/s_A$*, so the location drops out of every index slope and* $\beta_j(A) = s_A^{-1}\,\partial U_A/\partial x_j$*.*

(i) Under Assumptions 3 and 4(ii), with $s_1 = s_0 = s$*, Proposition 2 carries over to the index up to the positive constant* s^{-1}*.*

(ii) If $\theta_E(A) \neq 0$*, each ratio* $\beta_j(A)/\beta_E(A)$ *is the sender's marginal rate of substitution between* x_j *and alignment, which does not depend on* s_A*. Under the linear benchmark,*

$$\frac{\beta_m(A)}{\beta_E(A)} = \frac{\tau\,\theta_m(A)}{\theta_E(A)} \quad (m \in \{B, P\}), \qquad \frac{\beta_\rho(A)}{\beta_E(A)} = -\frac{\theta_R(A)}{\theta_E(A)}.$$

If Assumption 3 holds as well, $\beta_P(1)/\beta_E(1) - \beta_P(0)/\beta_E(0) = \tau\,[\theta_P(1) - \theta_P(0)]/\theta_E$*, the same holds with* θ_B *in place of* θ_P*, and the distance ratio does not change with* A*.*

The two comparisons rest on different restrictions. The index comparison assumes that political action leaves the scale unchanged. A consequential choice might make decisions more deliberate, but a change in scale multiplies every slope by the same factor and cannot raise the persuasion slope alone. The ratio comparison needs no common scale, since within a treatment the scale divides every slope alike. It assumes instead that political action leaves the expressive weight unchanged. In other words, action does not change the value of validating one's own position, which does not run through the receiver's response. Without this restriction, a higher persuasion ratio still signs a rise in the value of persuasion relative to expression. A change in scale would bias the first comparison but not the second, and a change in the expressive weight would bias the second but not the first. Thus if both point the same way, evidence is likely robust.[27]

4 Experiment 2: The Drivers of Selectivity

Experiment 2 asks what senders select on, and whether that selection changes when the receiver goes on to take a political action. Provision is predicted by how strongly a fact validates the sender's position, by the correction and the persuasion they expect it to achieve, and by how close the receiver's position is to their own. When the receiver

[27] Reading the size of a ratio's change as a change in one weight uses the linear benchmark. Its sign survives increasing transformations of the determinants when the ratios are compared at the same values (Appendix H).

takes a political action, the evidence suggests that senders select more on the expected persuasion return and that provision falls less steeply with distance. Overall the slant of provision does not detectably differ between the treatments.

4.1 Design and Hypotheses

Experimental timeline. Senders first report demographics and two policy view measures (Figure 3). They then make the provision decisions: senders decide whether to share each of five assigned facts, one decision at a time, directed at a receiver whose policy stance is visible. Finally, they give incentivized forecasts of how each fact affects the receiver's belief accuracy and policy position. A post-questionnaire, which also collects the ratings used to measure alignment, closes the study.[28]

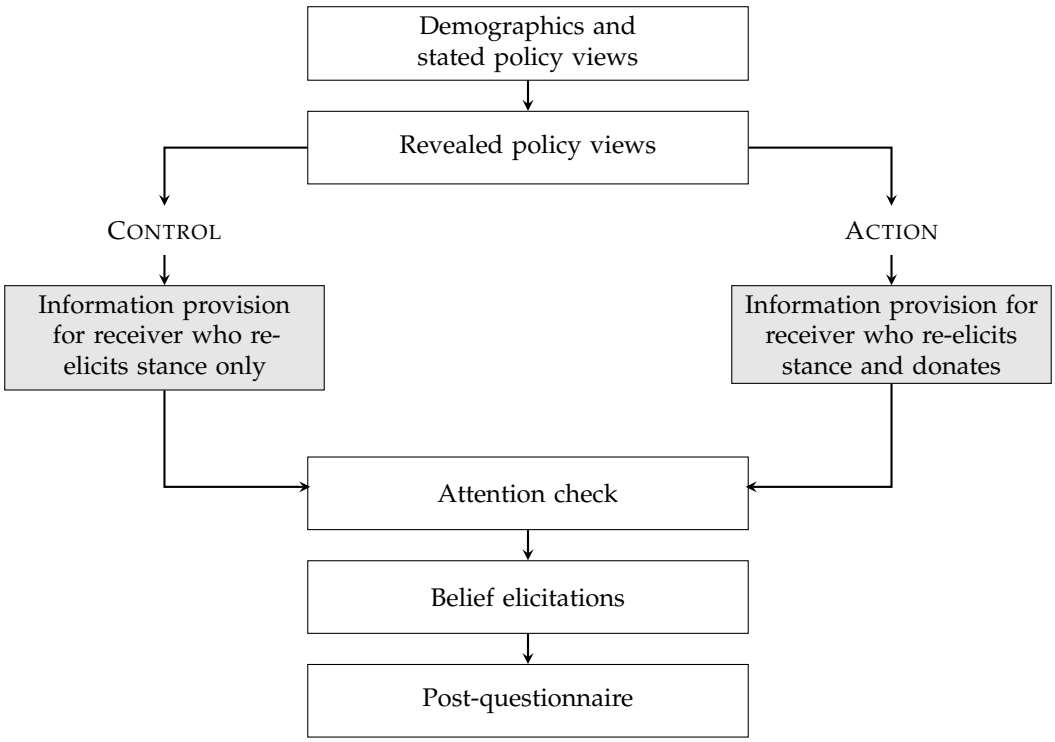


Figure 3: Timeline of Experiment 2

Facts. Table 4 lists the twelve facts, six in each of the two policy domains, immigration and climate. Each is presented as a binary, invertible comparison and sourced from German statistical offices and research institutes. Senders and receivers are told at the outset that every fact is true and sourced. Each sender is randomly assigned to one domain and sees five of its six facts with two for each policy direction plus one drawn

[28] Provision precedes elicitation, so the elicitation cannot prime the provision decision. The forecasts are incentivized for accuracy, and I assume that they are the forecasts senders held when deciding. Comprehension checks precede the provision task, and an attention check follows it.

at random. I pre-validated the facts in a pre-registered survey ($N = 300$) and balanced them for credibility and relevance.[29]

Table 4: Facts Used in Experiments 2 and 3

Direction	Fact
Immigration policy	
Pro	The share of people with a migration background in shortage-occupation fields is *higher* than their population share.
Pro	The absolute increase in employed foreign nationals between 2013 and 2023 was *larger* than for German nationals.
Pro	*More* than half of the persons attending a general integration course for the first time complete it without interruption through the final module.
Anti	Among persons suspected of violent crimes, the share of non-German nationals is *higher* than their population share.
Anti	The share of persons receiving basic income support (*Bürgergeld*) is *higher* among foreign nationals than among German nationals.
Anti	Germany records *more* persons without a valid residence permit per capita than the EU average.
Climate policy	
Pro	In German electricity generation in 2023 and 2024, the share of renewable energies was *higher* than the share of fossil fuels.
Pro	The cost of generating one kilowatt-hour of electricity from new, ground-mounted solar installations is *lower* than from new gas-fired power plants.
Pro	The percentage increase in renewable energy jobs in Germany between 2022 and 2023 was *higher* than the global average.
Anti	Grid fees for household customers are expected to be *more* than double their current level by 2045 due to grid expansion.
Anti	There are *fewer* companies that view the effects of the energy transition positively than companies that view them negatively.
Anti	At higher shares of solar power, *more* price fluctuations are observed in European electricity markets.

Notes: Claims are verbatim as shown to senders in English translation (correct answer in *italics*). Direction (Pro) = supports more-permissive immigration or more-ambitious climate policy; (Anti) = supports more-restrictive or more-cautious policy. Pool of six facts per topic, all from German statistical offices and research institutes. Each sender draws five facts: two pro-policy, two anti-policy, and one random tiebreaker. Topics assigned between subjects. Pre-validation details in Appendix A.4.

Policy views. I measure policy views two ways. Senders place themselves on a five-point policy scale on each of the two issues, and they split €250 between the pro-policy and the anti-policy advocacy organization for their assigned domain in a real donation decision. One donation decision from the study is drawn and implemented with real money. On immigration the organizations are *ProAsyl*, advocating for more permissive immigration policy, and *Republik21*, advocating for more restrictive immigration policy.

[29] Appendix A.4 describes the pre-validation survey.

On climate, *BUND*, supporting more national and less market-based climate policies, and *Stiftung Marktwirtschaft*, supporting less national and more market-based climate policy. Senders see each organization's position in its own words before deciding.[30]

Receivers. Each sender faces five receivers in sequence, one at each position on the five-point scale. Before every decision the sender sees the receiver's stance stated in full, and knows the receiver has been told the sender's position in turn. Receiver positions are presented in randomized order, and facts are randomly assigned to receiver slots, generating within-sender variation in political distance that is unrelated to the fact by design. Senders know they are matched to a real receiver in at least four of ten cases. Conditional on a match, a decision to share is implemented with probability one half and a decision not to share is always implemented. A receiver who sees nothing therefore cannot tell withholding from a failed transmission.

Elicited returns. The final stage elicits the two returns that vary with the receiver. For each receiver–fact pair, senders predict the percentage of receivers holding that stance who would answer the fact's question correctly with and without receipt, with the difference the expected accuracy gain $\widehat{\Delta b}$. Senders also predict these receivers' average policy view on the five-point scale with and without the fact. $\widehat{\Delta \pi}$ is the distance between the sender's own position and the receivers' predicted mean position with the fact, minus that distance without the fact, so it is positive when the sender expects the fact to bring receivers closer. Both predictions are scored under a quadratic scoring rule against matched receivers' realized outcomes.[31] In the post-questionnaire, senders also rate two facts from the domain they were *not* assigned, one hypothesized pro-policy and one hypothesized anti-policy: whether the information *"shows that your opinion is correct,"* and, separately, whether they are convinced it is true, which measures perceived credibility.[32] Because senders hold a stated stance on both issues, these ratings can be grouped by the rater's stance on the domain being rated and supply the stance–fact alignment index $\widehat{\alpha}$ for the senders who provide facts in that domain without rating it themselves.

Treatments and hypotheses. Senders are randomly assigned between subjects to CONTROL or ACTION, as in Experiment 1. In both treatments receivers restate their policy position after possibly receiving a fact. In the ACTION treatment receivers also make a

[30] Appendix A.5 reproduces the organization descriptions shown to senders.

[31] Each forecast concerns all matched receivers who hold that stance rather than a single receiver, so it can be scored against their realized share answering correctly and their average policy view.

[32] Importantly, the instructions ask the rater to judge whether the fact validates their position, not whether their position is correct in the abstract, and not whether the fact would convince anyone else.

real €250 donation decision between the same two organizations, implemented under the same draw. Senders know this when they decide.

I pre-registered three hypotheses, mirroring Experiment 1.

Hypothesis 2.0 (Baseline provision)**.** *Provision rates for unaligned facts exceed the indifference benchmark of* 50% *in each treatment-topic cell.*

Hypothesis 2.1 (Selective provision)**.** *Senders are more likely to provide a fact aligned with their own policy view than one that is not, holding fact and topic fixed.*

Hypothesis 2.2 (ACTION increase)**.** *The alignment gap in provision is larger when the receiver makes a real political donation (*ACTION*) than when the receiver only restates their opinion (*CONTROL*).*

I also pre-registered a secondary analysis relating provision to the expressive return, the expected accuracy gain and the expected persuasion return, and to their interactions with ACTION. Analyses in Section 4.2.4 build on it.

4.2 Results

4.2.1 Sample, Incentives, and Protocol

Data collection ran from May 27 to June 4, 2026 on Bilendi, with quotas that match the German adult population on age, gender, and state. This study was approved by the Ethics Council of the Max Planck Society under the Generalized Approval of Experiments Following the Protocol that is Standard in Experimental Economics (approval no. 2018_3 Renewal 2024_28) and was pre-registered on AsPredicted (No. 293252). Of 1,694 completers, $N = 1{,}548$ senders providing 7,740 decisions form the main sample. Forty were excluded as speeders and 106 because they started before the study was shortened, as Appendix A.6 describes. Senders took a median of 17 minutes and earned €3.06 on average.[33] The experiment was programmed in oTree (Chen et al. 2016).

4.2.2 Policy Views and Measured Returns

Policy views. Senders' stated and revealed policy views correlate at $r = 0.627$ on immigration and $r = 0.503$ on climate; Appendix Figure C.1 shows the distributions of both measures. As pre-registered, each measure is normalized to $[-1, 1]$ and averaged into a policy view index, which spans its full range in both domains.

[33] Senders receive €3 for participating. Twenty-five senders drawn at random can earn a bonus of €10, paid with a probability given by their score on one randomly chosen task, the belief elicitations or the comprehension questions.

Alignment index. Each climate fact is rated by senders who made their provision decisions on immigration, and each immigration fact by senders who decided on climate, according to whether the fact validates the rater's own stated position. A sender's own ratings never enter the index attached to their own decisions. For each fact and each of the five positions, twice the share of raters at that position who say the fact validates their position, minus one, gives the stance–fact alignment index $\hat{\alpha}_{ij} \in [-1, +1]$, and each sender's decisions are assigned the value for their own stated position. This treats the share at a sender's stated position as a measurement of that sender's alignment. The alignment index spans -0.429 to 0.830 and orders facts by their hypothesized direction: at the pro-policy pole, pro-policy facts score $+0.535$ against $+0.304$ for anti-policy facts, and at the anti-policy pole the ordering reverses, $+0.786$ against $+0.272$.

Expected accuracy gain. Senders expect receipt of a fact to improve factual knowledge, but only partly. They put the receiver's chance of answering correctly at 49.3% without the fact and 66.5% with it, an expected accuracy gain averaging 0.172. The elicited object is the share of receivers at the matched receiver's stance who answer correctly, which I use as the sender's forecast of that receiver's belief: the expected frequency of a correct answer at a stance stands in for the probability an individual receiver places on the true state. Expected accuracy gains for facts that favor the sender's side and for facts that cut against it do not detectably differ ($p = 0.245$). Panel A of Appendix Figure C.2 shows the two distributions.

Expected persuasion. The average expected persuasion return is close to zero, because each sender faces receivers at every position and facts pointing both ways. Individual expectations are not: receiver–fact pairs divide almost evenly between expected movement toward the sender (41.7%) and away from them (41.0%), and expected movement toward the sender grows with the distance between them (Appendix C.5). Whether a fact is expected to move the receiver toward the sender therefore depends on the receiver, not only on the fact. Senders expect such movement for 45.6 percent of facts that favor their side and 37.9 percent of facts that cut against it, a gap below 8 pp in each treatment (7.7 in CONTROL, 7.6 in ACTION). In Experiment 1, where every receiver held a false belief and the facts were validated on which way learning them moves policy views, the corresponding gap is 60.8 pp.

Separability and balance. The returns and political distance are nearly uncorrelated. After fact fixed effects, no pair among the alignment index, the expected accuracy gain, the expected persuasion return and political distance correlates above 0.12 in absolute value—the largest is the persuasion return and distance, at 0.117—and no variance

inflation factor exceeds 1.030, so the four are far from the exact affine dependence Assumption 2 rules out. The two elicited forecasts have similar means across treatments (sender-level mean-difference $p = 0.783$ and $p = 0.577$) and standard deviations within 0.015 of each other, consistent with Assumption 3(i).[34] Within fact, positional alignment correlates with the stance–fact alignment index at $r = 0.596$, but with the persuasion return only at $r = 0.084$ and with the expected accuracy gain at $r = 0.010$. These properties allow the returns and political distance to enter one specification.

4.2.3 Selective Provision and the ACTION Interaction

Senders provide unaligned facts well above the indifference benchmark: across the four treatment–topic cells, provision of unaligned facts ranges from 55.5% to 61.2% (one-sample t-tests, all $p < 0.001$). Overall provision is 63.9%.

Result 2.0 (Baseline provision)**.** *Senders share most unaligned facts, above the* 50 *percent benchmark in every treatment–topic cell, confirming Hypothesis 2.0.*

Table 5 reports the pre-registered tests. I estimate the linear probability model

$$y_{i,j} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \,\text{Align}_{i,j} + \beta_2 \,\text{ACTION}_i + \beta_3 \left(\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{ACTION}_i\right) + \mathbf{S}_j + \gamma\, \mathbf{X}_i + \varepsilon_{i,j}, \quad (5)$$

where $\text{Align}_{i,j} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, 1]$ is positional alignment, with Pref_i the sender's policy view index and $\text{Dir}_j = \pm 1$ the fact's pro- or anti-policy direction and $\text{ACTION}_i \in \{0, 1\}$ is an indicator equal to one if sender i is assigned to the ACTION treatment. The unit of observation is a sender–fact pair, and standard errors are clustered at the sender level throughout. β_1 captures alignment-based selectivity in CONTROL (Hypothesis 2.1) and β_3 whether the positional alignment slope is larger in the ACTION treatment (Hypothesis 2.2). Column (1) includes no controls, column (2) adds the fact fixed effects $\mathbf{S}_j$, and column (3) adds the demographic and political controls $\mathbf{X}_i$.

A fact is aligned for a sender if $\text{Align}_{i,j} > 0$ and unaligned if $\text{Align}_{i,j} < 0$, which defines both for the 1,496 senders with a directional policy view. Senders share aligned facts at higher rates in both treatments (Figure 4, Panel (A)): provision runs 68.2% on aligned facts against 56.6% on unaligned facts in CONTROL, and 71.3% against 58.5% in ACTION. The sender-level alignment bias averages 11.6 pp in CONTROL and 12.7 pp in ACTION, and the pre-registered coefficient is $+0.128$ per unit of positional alignment (one-sided $p < 0.001$, column (3)).

[34] Each sender is observed in one treatment only, so this is not a direct test of the assumption. As forecasts are elicited after provision, they may be affected by prior choices. However, there is no evidence for different behavior between treatments and the incentivizes should partially offset such behavior.

Result 2.1 (Selective provision)**.** *Senders favor aligned facts in both treatments, confirming Hypothesis 2.1.*

As in Section 2, the coefficient equals the difference in sharing between aligned and unaligned facts for a sender at half the maximum policy view intensity, because the two differ in positional alignment by twice that intensity. In CONTROL, the estimates imply that the median sender with a directional policy view, whose intensity is 0.52, is 13.3 pp more likely to share an aligned than an unaligned fact, and a sender at the maximum 25.6 pp.[35]

Hypothesis 2.2 is not confirmed. The Align $\times$ ACTION interaction is $+0.014$ (one-sided $p = 0.215$, column (3)).

Result 2.2 (ACTION increase not confirmed)**.** *The data do not show a larger alignment gap when the receiver takes a downstream political action.*

The pre-registered test asks whether the alignment gap widens under political action. Positional alignment depends only on the fact and the sender, whereas the returns that political action could make more valuable, correction and persuasion, also depend on the receiver. The test therefore bears on those returns only to the extent that they move with positional alignment.

4.2.4 The Four Drivers of Provision

Provision moves with all four determinants of Section 3, each in the direction the framework predicts. Within facts, it correlates positively with the stance–fact alignment index ($r = 0.094$, $p < 0.001$), the expected accuracy gain ($r = 0.026$, $p = 0.039$) and the expected persuasion return ($r = 0.026$, $p = 0.034$), and negatively with political distance ($r = -0.218$, $p < 0.001$).[36] Provision varies with what a fact does for the sender and for the receiver, and most strongly with who the receiver is.

The specification. To estimate these responses jointly and on the scale of the framework, I take the shape G in Assumption 4 to be the standard normal, so that the disclosure probability is a probit in the four determinants:

$$\begin{aligned}\Pr(y_{ij} = 1) = \Phi\big(&\beta_0 + \beta_E\, \alpha_{ij} + \beta_B\, \Delta b_{ijk} + \beta_P\, \Delta \pi_{ijk} + \beta_\rho\, \rho_{ijk} + \gamma_A\, \text{ACTION}_i \\ &+ \delta_B\, (\Delta b_{ijk} \times \text{ACTION}_i) + \delta_P\, (\Delta \pi_{ijk} \times \text{ACTION}_i) + \mathbf{S}_j\big), \end{aligned} \tag{6}$$

[35] The construction $\text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j$ imposes this proportionality to intensity. Replacing positional alignment with a binary aligned indicator gives a CONTROL-treatment gap of 12.2 pp. On the probability scale, the pre-registered logit gives $+0.125$, and sender fixed effects give $+0.129$ (Appendix Table C.5). Leave-one-fact and sample-variant ranges are in Appendix C.3.

[36] Because the determinants are nearly uncorrelated with one another, these simple correlations are close to the partial correlations that hold the other three fixed (0.109, 0.022, 0.042 and -0.230).

Table 5: Alignment-Based Selective Provision

	Probability of Fact Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Positional alignment	0.113***	0.127***	0.128***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)
ACTION	0.026**	0.026**	0.023*
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.012)
Positional alignment × ACTION	0.011	0.014	0.014
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes
Num. obs.	7740	7740	7715
R^2	0.025	0.032	0.045
Adj. R^2	0.025	0.030	0.039

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders (Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026), 7,740 sender-fact observations. Each sender makes five provision decisions, one per fact. Column (3) restricts to non-missing demographic controls (7,715 observations). The outcome is a binary provision indicator ($y_{ij} \in \{0, 1\}$). Positional alignment is $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, 1]$. Fact FE is an indicator for each of the 12 facts. Controls are age, gender, education, Bundesland, voting intention, left-right self-placement. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

where $\rho_{ijk} = |\text{Stance}_i - \text{Stance}_k|$ is the political distance between sender i and the receiver k of fact j, and $\mathbf{S}_j$ are fact fixed effects, which absorb each fact's direction, topic and other fact-level appeal. I refer to this as the four-determinant specification. By Corollary 1, each slope is a marginal utility divided by the scale, so its sign is the sign of the corresponding weight. The interactions δ_B and δ_P measure how the correction and persuasion slopes change under political action. With a common scale across treatments, a positive δ_P is the observable counterpart of consequential persuasion, $\theta_P(1) > \theta_P(0)$ (Proposition 2). Columns (1)–(2) pool the treatments, and column (3) adds the interactions, so its main effects are CONTROL-treatment slopes. Standard errors are clustered by sender.[37]

What senders select on. Provision rises with what a fact does for the sender and for the receiver. Pooling the treatments (column (2)), moving the alignment index from

[37]The interactions of ACTION with the alignment index and with distance are set to zero, which maintains Assumption 3(ii)–(iii) together with a common scale; freeing the alignment-index interaction is reported with the robustness checks. The treatment indicator shifts the propensity to disclose anything and carries no information about the weights; with a common scale, $\gamma_A = (\kappa - \mu_1 + \mu_0)/s$. Reading signs as weights treats $\hat{\alpha}$ and the elicited forecasts as measures of the sender's alignment and forecasts. Distance enters linearly, as in the framework; distance indicators fit better ($\chi^2(3) = 20.5$, $p < 0.001$) but move no return coefficient by more than 0.009 (Appendix Table C.8). One-sided p-values are reported where the framework signs a case; the pre-registration does so only for its two confirmatory hypotheses.

Table 6: Determinants of Provision: Index Coefficients and Average Marginal Effects

	Provision of the Fact		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel A: index coefficients			
Stance–fact alignment index	0.489***	0.490***	0.490***
	(0.053)	(0.053)	(0.053)
Expected accuracy gain	0.086*	0.085*	0.131*
	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.069)
Persuasion	0.061***	0.061***	0.030
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.024)
Political distance	−0.250***	−0.250***	−0.250***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)
ACTION		0.070*	0.081**
		(0.036)	(0.040)
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION			−0.086
			(0.096)
Persuasion × ACTION			0.061*
			(0.035)
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Senders	1,548	1,548	1,548
Observations	7,740	7,740	7,740
Panel B: average marginal effects by treatment, from column (3)			
	CONTROL	ACTION	Difference
Stance–fact alignment index	0.175	0.171	−0.004
Expected accuracy gain	0.047	0.016	−0.031
Persuasion	0.011	0.032	0.021
Political distance	−0.089	−0.087	0.002

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders (Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026), with 7,740 sender–fact observations in every column. The outcome is an indicator equal to one if the sender provides the fact. All columns are probit regressions with fact fixed effects and enter the stance–fact alignment index, the expected accuracy gain, the expected persuasion return and the political distance between sender and receiver. Column (2) adds the ACTION indicator, and column (3) interacts the expected accuracy gain and the expected persuasion return with ACTION, so its main effects are CONTROL-treatment slopes. The interactions rest on the randomization of ACTION; the main effects are within-sender associations. Panel B reports, for each treatment, the average marginal effect of each determinant from column (3); inference is read from Panel A. Standard errors, clustered by sender, are in parentheses. Stars are two-sided; the text reports one-sided p-values where the framework signs a case. After Holm adjustment for the two pre-registered interactions with the elicited returns, the persuasion interaction has one-sided $p = 0.078$. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

its fifth to its ninety-fifth percentile raises predicted provision by 17.1 pp. The same move raises it by 6.6 pp for the expected persuasion return ($p < 0.001$) and by 3.6 pp for the expected accuracy gain (one-sided $p = 0.039$). Because the receiver learns the sender's position whichever fact arrives, the alignment-index association does not reflect signaling which side the sender is on. Canonical models of voluntary disclosure give the sender an objective that runs entirely through the receiver's beliefs, the special case $\theta_E = \theta_R = 0$ of Equation (2). Under Assumption 1, the estimates do not fit that

case.

Whom senders inform. The largest contrast concerns who the receiver is. Moving the receiver from the sender's own position to four points away lowers predicted provision by 36.4 pp. Facts are assigned to receivers at random, so this decline is causal. Senders' choices across distance also change the slant of what arrives. Because a provided fact arrives with probability one half whatever it says, the slant of arrival equals the slant of provision in expectation. The slant of provision is 0.070 for receivers at the sender's own position and 0.156 for receivers four points away, rising by 0.027 per point (sender-clustered $p = 0.003$). Distant receivers get fewer facts, and more slanted ones. Reading the decline as the relational motive, a preference over whom one informs, requires Assumption 1: the design elicits forecasts of only the receiver's belief and position, so a sender who anticipates other responses from distant receivers, such as hostility, judgment of the sender or futility, would produce the same decline.

Result 2.3 (What senders select on)**.** *Pooling the treatments, provision rises with the alignment index, the expected persuasion return and, more weakly, the expected accuracy gain, and falls with political distance.*

Political action. The evidence suggests that political action shifts selection toward persuasion and toward distant receivers, while the slant of provision does not detectably change. Provision is 65.2% under ACTION and 62.6% in CONTROL ($p = 0.038$). The correlation of provision with the expected persuasion return rises from 0.007 to 0.051 ($p = 0.064$), while those with the alignment index, the expected accuracy gain and positional alignment differ by at most 0.025 (all $p > 0.3$). The slant of provision is 0.0707 in both treatments ($p = 0.999$). Provision falls less steeply with political distance under ACTION ($p = 0.043$). On the probability scale, the smaller decline with distance can reflect a change in the relational weight, a different density of the shock at the two treatments' margins (Equation (4)), or the rise in the persuasion response itself.

On the index, the two comparisons of Section 3.4 point the same way. With a common scale, the persuasion slope is higher under ACTION, $\delta_P = +0.061$ (one-sided $p = 0.039$), raising the probability response to the expected persuasion return from $+1.1$ to $+3.2$ pp per unit.[38] Appendix Table C.10 reports the ratios. With the expressive weight held fixed, the persuasion slope relative to the alignment-index slope, estimated within treatment, is higher under ACTION by 0.095. The correction interaction is not distinguishable from zero, $\delta_B = -0.086$ ($p = 0.371$). A change in scale would steepen

[38] Inference on this interaction is marginal. With standard errors clustered by both sender and fact, or with the wild cluster bootstrap, it loses conventional significance. Appendix C.3 reports it in full, across clustering, randomization inference and the specification set.

every slope alike, and the forecasts are balanced across treatments, so neither a more deliberate task nor changed expectations fits a rise in the persuasion slope alone.

Within senders, the smaller decline with distance under political action persists, and the persuasion interaction is directionally consistent but smaller. With five decisions per sender, a probit with one fixed effect per sender is inconsistent, so this check uses the linear probability model with sender and fact fixed effects. In it, the persuasion interaction is $+0.013$ (one-sided $p = 0.170$) against $+0.023$ without sender fixed effects, and adding the interaction of ACTION with distance gives $+0.018$ ($p = 0.059$). Part of the pooled persuasion estimate therefore rests on differences between senders. The persuasion interaction is otherwise robust to the choice of link, the sample definition and the specification.[39]

Result 2.4 (Motives and consequentiality)**.** *Under political action, the evidence suggests that senders select more on the expected persuasion return, but not detectably more on the expected accuracy gain, and, on the probability scale, provide relatively more to distant receivers. The slant of provision does not detectably differ between the treatments.*

This explains why the pre-registered Align $\times$ ACTION test was unlikely to detect the change. Within facts, positional alignment correlates with the expected persuasion return at only $r = 0.084$, so the linear-probability persuasion interaction ($+0.023$) implies an Align $\times$ ACTION coefficient of $+0.003$, six percent of that test's minimum detectable effect of 0.049. The arithmetic is a diagnostic for this design and assumes a linear mapping, which fails for the most distant receivers. Where the alignment index and the persuasion return enter jointly, as in the four-determinant specification, their shared variance is absorbed; the problem is specific to an interaction test with a single proxy.[40]

4.2.5 Heterogeneity and Alternative Explanations

Heterogeneity. Appendix C.4 reports the pre-registered heterogeneity analyses by the political distance between sender and receiver, political polarization, issue extremity and voting for a party of the political center. None of them detectably changes how strongly senders favor aligned facts. The one difference that survives correction for multiple testing is that senders at the ends of the five-point scale respond to the stance–fact alignment index about three times as strongly as other senders.

[39] A correlated-random-effects probit, which keeps the index scale, gives a within-sender persuasion interaction of $+0.034$ (one-sided $p = 0.193$). Under a logistic, an asymmetric and a heavy-tailed link, one-sided p lies between 0.025 and 0.053. Appendix C reports the pre-registered alternative sample definitions, the comprehension ladder, the flexible distance profile and the three-return linear form. Freeing the alignment-index interaction gives $+0.082$ (Wald $p = 0.418$), so setting it to zero costs little, though the data do not validate it.

[40] Substituting positional alignment for $\hat{\alpha}$ moves the correction, persuasion and distance coefficients by at most 0.01 and leaves δ_P at $+0.062$ (Appendix Table C.4).

Disbelief. As in Experiment 1, disbelief does not explain selective provision. Holding fixed how credible other senders at the same stance find each fact, the positional alignment coefficient falls only from 0.365 to 0.331 ($p < 0.001$), as Appendix Table C.9 shows. The stance–fact alignment index, which comes from the same rating task as the credibility rating, falls further, from 0.490 to 0.253 ($p < 0.001$).[41]

5 Experiment 3: Selectivity Among Journalists

Experiment 3 asks whether journalists' select on alignment absent the market incentives often used to explain slant. Journalists' provision rises with how strongly a fact validates their position and with the correction and the persuasion they expect it to achieve, and falls with the receiver's distance from their own position. Journalists provide more than the general population, and their responses to each determinant do not detectably differ from those of the general population.

5.1 Design and Hypotheses

Protocol. Experiment 3 runs the ACTION treatment of Experiment 2 with professional journalists, using its facts, provision task and incentivized forecasts (Figure 3). Every journalist is matched to a real receiver. The attention check is omitted. The post-questionnaire here elicits outlet type, reach, role and editorial autonomy. Journalists rate no facts from the other domain, so the general-population stance–fact alignment index is assigned.

Hypotheses. I pre-registered the two hypotheses (AsPredicted No. 292902). The firs mirrors Hypothesis 2.0: baseline provision above 50%. The second mirrors Hypothesis 2.1: alignment-based selective provision.

5.2 Results

5.2.1 Sample, Incentives, and Protocol

Journalists were recruited through the mailing lists of the Deutscher Journalisten-Verband (German Federation of Journalists) and the Deutsche Journalistinnen- und Journalisten-Union (German Union of Journalists). 309 journalists participated between May 25 and

[41]The believability item in the pre-registered control set was lost when the instrument was shortened (Appendix A.6). The cell-level credibility rating, elicited without incentives from senders deciding on the other topic, is the closest available proxy.

August 11, 2026.[42] The study was approved by the Ethics Council of the Max Planck Society under the same Generalized Approval. Journalists took a median of 22 minutes and earned €15.39 on average.[43] The sample is younger and more educated, has a higher share of females, and it overrepresents online outlets than the general German journalist population (Loosen et al. 2023).

5.2.2 Policy Views and Measured Returns

Policy views. Journalists' policy views are more intense than that of the general population, with mean of 0.689 compared with 0.541. In particular, the sample leans left.[44] On immigration, 58.6% of journalists favor more permissive policy, while 66.1% of the general population favors more restrictive policy. On climate, 83.7% favor expanded policy, compared with 52.8%.

Elicited returns. Journalists expect facts to correct receivers more than the general population does. They put the receiver's chance of answering correctly at 44.7% without the fact and 76.9% with it, an expected accuracy gain of 0.322, against 0.172. For journalists, the facts that favor their side are also more often the ones they expect to move the receiver toward them: they expect such movement for 51.2% of facts that favor their side and 24.0% of facts that cut against it. The gap of 27.2 pp lies between the general population's 7.6 pp in the ACTION treatment and Experiment 1's 60.8 pp. Their forecasts also respond more strongly to the persuasive room created by the random assignment of facts to receivers (0.100 against 0.015 per scale point), and their provision follows; Appendix D.3 reports the estimates.

Separability. The four determinants remain weakly correlated among journalists. After fact fixed effects, the largest correlation is again between the persuasion return and political distance, at 0.230, and no variance inflation factor exceeds 1.068. Within facts, positional alignment correlates with the persuasion return at $r = 0.192$, against 0.083 in the general population's ACTION treatment.

5.2.3 Selective Provision

Journalists share most unaligned facts: 64.4% in climate and 67.9% in immigration, above the 50 percent benchmark (one-sample t-tests, both $p < 0.001$). Overall provi-

[42] One journalist completed the study seven times, identified by the payout details they submitted, and another twice, identified by the name they submitted. Only each first participation is retained. One journalist who started during the soft launch, before the instrument revision of 27 May 2026, is excluded.

[43] Journalists receive €15 for participating. Ten journalists drawn at random can earn a bonus of €30, determined as in Experiment 2.

[44] Mean left–right (0–10) self-placement is 3.2 against general population's 5.0. This is consistent with other studies (Steindl et al. 2017, Loosen et al. 2023).

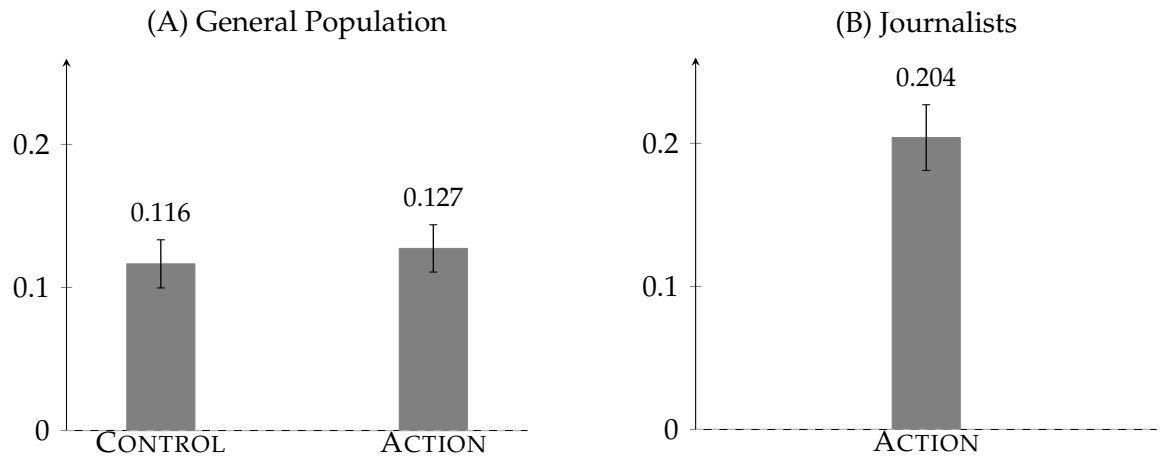


Figure 4: Alignment Bias in the General Population and Among Journalists

Notes: The sample is Experiments 2 and 3. The bias is the within-sender difference between provision rates for aligned and unaligned facts, averaged across senders. Panel (A) shows the general population ($N = 1{,}496$ senders; Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026). Panel (B) shows professional journalists ($N = 299$), who face the ACTION treatment only. The sample is senders with a directional policy view ($\text{Pref}_i \neq 0$), so that positional alignment is defined; 52 general-population and 10 journalist senders are excluded. Positional alignment is $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, +1]$. Error bars are standard errors of the sender-level mean. Both panels use the same vertical scale.

sion is 12.5 pp higher than in the general population.

Result 3.0 (Baseline provision)**.** *Journalists share most unaligned facts, above the* 50 *percent benchmark in both topics.*

Table 7, columns (1)–(3), reports the pre-registered tests, Equation (5) without the ACTION terms. Journalists provide 86.6% of aligned facts against 66.2% of unaligned ones, a sender-level alignment bias of 20.4 pp ($p < 0.001$), against 12.7 pp in the general population's ACTION treatment.

Result 3.1 (Selective provision among journalists)**.** *Journalists favor aligned facts.*

The journalist bias is larger, while the slope does not detectably differ: in the pooled specification the journalist difference is -0.028 ($p = 0.168$; column (6)), and the 95 percent interval rules out a journalist slope more than about a tenth steeper. The bias is larger partly because journalists hold stronger policy views.

5.2.4 The Four Determinants of Provision

Table 8 estimates Equation (6) without the ACTION terms, on journalists in column (1) and on the general population's ACTION treatment in column (2).

What journalists select on. As in the general population, provision rises with what a fact does for the sender and for the receiver. Moving the alignment index from its fifth

Table 7: Selective Provision: Journalists and the Pooled Comparison with the General Population

	Journalists			Pooled: general population and journalists		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Positional alignment	0.142***	0.126***	0.129***	0.126***	0.123***	0.124***
	(0.015)	(0.020)	(0.020)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)
ACTION				0.026**	0.023*	0.023*
				(0.013)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Positional alignment × ACTION				0.005	0.008	0.017
				(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.017)
Journalist				0.114***	0.097***	0.096***
				(0.016)	(0.019)	(0.019)
Positional alignment × Journalist						−0.028
						(0.020)
Clustered SE	Journalist	Journalist	Journalist	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Sample	Journalists	Journalists	Journalists	Pooled	Pooled	Pooled
Num. obs.	1545	1545	1540	9285	9255	9255
R^2	0.062	0.077	0.137	0.045	0.099	0.099
Adj. R^2	0.062	0.069	0.098	0.044	0.093	0.093

Notes: The sample in cols. (1)–(3) is the $N = 309$ Experiment 3 journalists, 1,545 journalist-fact observations, all in the ACTION treatment (no between-subject ACTION variation among journalists); col. (3) has 1,540 observations from 308 journalists after covariate availability. The sample in cols. (4)–(6) pools Experiment 2 general-population senders ($N = 1{,}548$; both treatments; 7,740 observations) and Experiment 3 journalists ($N = 309$; ACTION treatment only; 1,545 observations); col. (4) $N = 9{,}285$, cols. (5)–(6) $N = 9{,}255$ after covariate availability. The outcome is a binary provision indicator ($y_{ij} \in \{0,1\}$), linear probability model, sender–fact observations; no sampling weights. Positional alignment is $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1,1]$ (pre-registered measure), defined identically in both samples. Journalist is an indicator for Experiment 3 participants (all in the ACTION treatment; reference category: general-population senders); ACTION is an indicator for the ACTION treatment (reference: CONTROL). Col. (6)'s Positional alignment × Journalist term tests whether the positional-alignment slope differs between the pools; identified because general-population senders supply ACTION= 1, Journalist= 0 observations. Controls in col. (3) are the pre-registered demographic, political and journalist-background controls: age, gender, education, Bundesland, left-right self-placement, voting intention, medium type, reach, main role and editorial autonomy (broadcaster type, asked only of broadcast journalists, is omitted). Controls in cols. (5)–(6) are sender-receiver ideological distance, age, gender, education, Bundesland, left-right self-placement, and closest-party affiliation—the demographic variables measured in both samples. All specifications except col. (1) include fact fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at journalist level (cols. 1–3) or sender level (cols. 4–6). The pre-registered test is the one-sided test of positional alignment > 0 in column (3); its p-value is reported in the text. The pooled cols. (4)–(6) were not pre-registered and are exploratory. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

to its ninety-fifth percentile raises predicted provision by 12.7 pp ($p = 0.002$). The same move raises it by 11.4 pp for the expected persuasion return (one-sided $p = 0.003$) and by 10.0 pp for the expected accuracy gain ($p = 0.027$).[45] Selection on the alignment index thus persists with competition, ownership and audience demand removed.

Whom journalists inform. The largest contrast again concerns who the receiver is. Moving the receiver from the journalist's own position to four points away lowers predicted provision by 25.6 pp ($p < 0.001$). Facts are assigned to receivers at random, so this decline is causal.

Result 3.2 (What journalists select on)**.** *Journalists' provision rises with the alignment index, the expected persuasion return and the expected accuracy gain, and falls with political distance.*

Comparison with the general population. Journalists provide 11.4 pp more than the general population's ACTION treatment, and 9.7 pp more with political distance and demographic and political characteristics held constant (both $p < 0.001$; Table 7, columns (4)–(6)). Their responses to the determinants do not detectably differ. Because each probit sample has its own latent scale, Panel B of Table 8 compares the two in

[45] Percentiles are those of the journalists and the general population's ACTION treatment combined, so each move is the same in the two samples.

Table 8: Determinants of Provision: Journalists and the General Population (ACTION Treatment)

	Provision of the Fact		
	Journalists	General population (ACTION treatment)	Difference
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel A: index coefficients			
Stance–fact alignment index	0.466***	0.517***	
	(0.151)	(0.074)	
Expected accuracy gain	0.299**	0.049	
	(0.135)	(0.067)	
Persuasion	0.137***	0.088***	
	(0.050)	(0.025)	
Political distance	−0.218***	−0.228***	
	(0.032)	(0.019)	
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	
Senders	309	793	
Observations	1,545	3,965	
Mean provision	0.764	0.651	
Panel B: average marginal effects			
Stance–fact alignment index	0.130	0.182	−0.051
			(0.046)
Expected accuracy gain	0.084	0.017	0.066
			(0.044)
Persuasion	0.038	0.031	0.007
			(0.016)
Political distance	−0.061	−0.080	0.019*
			(0.011)

Notes: The samples are Experiment 3 journalists in column (1) and Experiment 2 general-population senders in the ACTION treatment in column (2). All journalists face the ACTION treatment. The estimator is a probit with fact fixed effects, the four-determinant specification of Table 6, estimated separately in each sample; standard errors clustered by sender in parentheses. The outcome is a binary provision indicator. The regressors are the stance–fact alignment index $\hat{\alpha}_{ij}$, assigned to journalists from general-population raters at the same stance; the incentivized expected accuracy gain $\widehat{\Delta b}_{ijk}$ and expected persuasion return $\widehat{\Delta \pi}_{ijk}$; and political distance ρ_{ijk}. Panel A reports index coefficients, comparable within a column but not across columns, since each sample carries its own latent scale. Panel B reports average marginal effects, in probability units per unit of each determinant. Column (3) is their difference, with a sender-cluster bootstrap standard error (1,000 replications, senders resampled within each sample). Differences in probability responses also reflect each sample's provision level and are not differences in motive weights. Appendix Table D.4 reports the ratios to the coefficient on the stance–fact alignment index. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

probability units: per unit of each determinant, the average marginal effects differ by −0.051 for the alignment index ($p = 0.262$), +0.066 for the expected accuracy gain ($p = 0.134$) and +0.007 for the expected persuasion return ($p = 0.647$), and provision falls somewhat less steeply with distance among journalists (+0.019, $p = 0.073$).[46] The

[46]These differences also reflect journalists' higher provision level and are not differences in motive weights. In the pooled probit index the journalist level effect is +0.271 ($p = 0.004$), and a joint test of the four journalist interactions does not reject ($p = 0.148$); that test assumes a common latent scale, and its interactions are imprecisely estimated. The ratios to the alignment-index coefficient, which are free of

intervals are wide, so moderate differences cannot be ruled out.

Result 3.3 (A level difference; no detected slope difference)**.** *Journalists provide more than the general population, and their responses to the determinants do not detectably differ.*

5.2.5 Heterogeneity and Alternative Explanations

Heterogeneity. In the pre-registered heterogeneity analysis, by political distance, polarization, issue extremity and journalist background, one interaction survives correction for multiple testing: the positional alignment slope rises with the receiver's distance. So journalists favor aligned facts more strongly when the receiver is politically distant. Appendix Table D.2 shows that medium type, broadcaster type, reach, role and editorial autonomy do not detectably moderate alignment-based selectivity.

Stated motives and norms. Journalists' stated reasons and norms, recorded after the task, are coherent with their choices: those who cite correcting the receiver's beliefs show a smaller alignment bias, those who cite influencing the receiver's opinion a larger one, and those who agree that one should pass on true information contradicting one's own position a weaker positional alignment slope.

6 Experiment 4: The Epistemic Cost of Withholding

Experiment 4 asks how selective provision affects receivers. Each receiver is matched to a sender from Experiment 2 or 3. A receiver whose sender withheld a fact ends with nearly twice the belief error of one shown it. Receivers underestimate how often senders disclose and perceive little of how disclosure depends on sender–fact alignment.

6.1 Design and Outcomes

Experimental timeline. Receivers first report demographics and their positions on climate and immigration policy, and then their prior belief about a single fact, before senders are mentioned (Figure 5). They then receive the instructions and the comprehension checks, and either see the fact or learn that they will not receive it. Receivers next report their policy position again and make a donation if matched to an ACTION-treatment sender. They then report their posterior belief on the same scale as the prior, and finally what they believe about how senders in their cell disclosed.

each sample's scale, show no cross-sample difference distinguishable from zero (Appendix Table D.4).

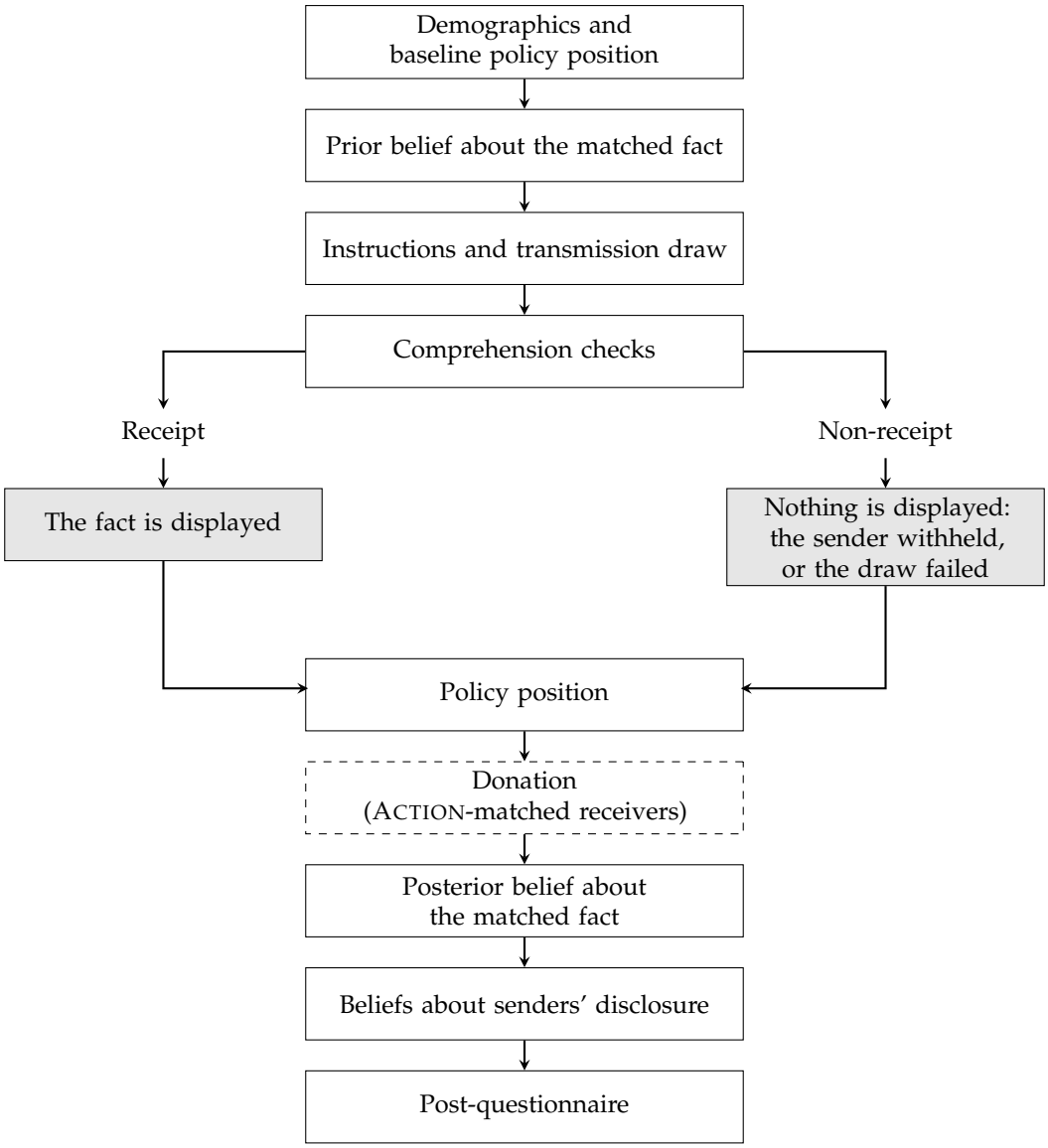


Figure 5: Timeline of Experiment 4

Reception. Each receiver is matched to a sender from Experiment 2 or 3 who decided whether to share the fact with a receiver at the receiver's policy stance. A shared fact reaches the receiver with probability one half. Each receiver therefore ends in one of three states: the sender shared the fact and it arrived (receipt, R), the sender shared it and it did not arrive (failed transmission, F), or the sender withheld it (withholding, W). The two causes of non-receipt look the same: a receiver who sees no fact cannot tell whether the sender withheld it or the random draw stopped it. Receivers know that both are possible. They are told the sender's stance, that the sender knew theirs, and that a coin decides whether the sender's decision is implemented.[47]

[47]Two comprehension questions on this point precede reception, and each permits two bonus-eligible attempts.

Belief accuracy. Receivers report their belief about the fact twice, before senders are mentioned and after reception, as the probability they attach to each of two completions of the fact's sentence, one of which is correct. The second elicitation uses the same slider, with the earlier answer neither shown nor used to position it, and both are incentivized by a quadratic scoring rule.[48] I measure belief accuracy against ground truth by the squared loss $L = (1 - b)^2$, where b is the probability placed on the correct completion.

Policy views and donations. Receivers report their policy views on a five-point scale, the item senders answer, at the start for both topics and again after reception for the matched topic. Receivers matched to ACTION-treatment senders also split €250 between the two organizations of that topic; one decision, drawn from the pooled sender and receiver donations, is implemented.

Beliefs about senders. Receivers estimate how many of up to ten real senders passed a fact on, once supposing for each potential correct completion. These rates are the perceived disclosure rates $\hat{\sigma}_1$, for the correct completion, and $\hat{\sigma}_0$, for the other. Their difference $\hat{\sigma}_1 - \hat{\sigma}_0$ is perceived selectivity: how far receivers believe disclosure depends on sender–fact alignment. Estimates are scored against real sender decision by a quadratic rule. Receivers do not know which completion is correct, so both estimates can be read as incentivized.[49]

6.2 Results

6.2.1 Sample, Incentives, and Protocol

Data collection ran from August 17 to 19, 2026 on Bilendi, with quotas that match the German adult population on age, gender, and state (Appendix Table E.1). This study was approved by the Ethics Council of the Max Planck Society under the Generalized Approval of Experiments Following the Protocol that is Standard in Experimental Economics (approval no. 2018_3 – Renewal 2024_28) and was pre-registered on AsPredicted (No. 306857). 1,081 receivers completed the study and I exclude 38 speeders leaving $N = 1{,}043$ receivers for the main analysis: 358 in receipt, 368 in failed transmission and 317 in withholding. Receivers took a median of 8.1 minutes and earned €2.21 on average.[50] The experiment was programmed in oTree (Chen et al. 2016).

[48] The slider layout is randomized across participants, and the stored probability does not depend on it (Appendix E).

[49] Receivers shown the fact are asked about a different fact of the same topic at the same stances. The actual disclosure rate for the correct completion is the share of senders in the cell who passed the fact on (median of 36 decisions).

[50] Receivers are paid €2.15 for participating. Ten receivers drawn at random can earn a bonus of €10, paid with a probability given by their score on one randomly chosen task: the prior belief, the

6.2.2 The Cost of Withholding

Table 9 reports results of the primary specification,

$$L_r^{\text{post}} = \beta_0 + \beta_W W_r + \beta_F F_r + \gamma L_r^{\text{prior}} + \mathbf{S}_{j(r)} + \varepsilon_r, \tag{7}$$

where receipt is the omitted state, $\mathbf{S}_{j(r)}$ are fact fixed effects, and standard errors are HC3. Mean posterior loss is 0.307 under withholding against 0.166 after receipt (Figure 6). Holding prior loss and the fact fixed, a receiver whose sender withheld the fact is left with $\beta_W = 0.128$ more posterior squared loss than a receiver shown it ($p < 0.001$, column (1)).

Table 9: Reception State, Belief Accuracy, and Downstream Outcomes

	Belief accuracy		Downstream outcomes	
	Squared loss (1)	Absolute error (2)	Policy view (3)	Donation (4)
Withholding (W)	0.128***	0.158***	-0.065	-5.55
	(0.018)	(0.020)	(0.053)	(9.14)
Failed transmission (F)	0.126***	0.152***	-0.058	-9.40
	(0.018)	(0.019)	(0.045)	(8.13)
$\beta_W - \beta_F$	0.001	0.006	-0.007	3.85
	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.052)	(8.68)
Baseline outcome	0.478***	0.454***	0.852***	
	(0.035)	(0.034)	(0.020)	
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Demographic controls	No	No	Yes	Yes
Observations	1043	1043	1043	664

Notes: The sample is the N = 1,043 Experiment 4 receivers (317 withholding, 368 failed transmission, 358 receipt); column (4) restricts to the 664 receivers matched to ACTION-treatment senders. The estimates are OLS estimates of equation (7); receipt is the omitted state. The outcomes are (1) posterior squared loss, pre-registered primary; (2) posterior absolute error, pre-registered robustness outcome, with prior squared loss as the control, which the filing leaves open; (3) policy view on the matched topic, signed by the fact's direction, controlling for the intake view; (4) signed split of €250. Columns (3)–(4) add demographic controls; their specifications are not registered. HC3 standard errors in parentheses, as filed for column (1). $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Result 4.0 (Less accurate beliefs under withholding)**.** *Receivers whose sender withheld a fact hold less accurate beliefs than receivers shown it: their posterior squared loss against ground truth is nearly twice as large.*

Non-receipt is costly. After failed transmission, receivers are left with $\beta_F = 0.126$

comprehension questions, the posterior belief or the estimates about senders.

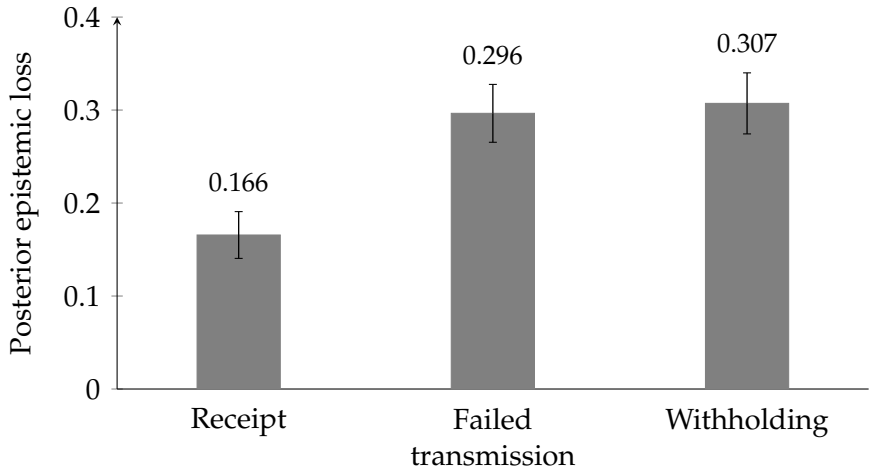


Figure 6: Posterior Epistemic Loss by Reception State

Notes: The sample is the canonical Experiment 4 sample, $N = 1{,}043$: 358 in receipt, 368 in failed transmission, 317 in withholding.

more posterior squared loss than receivers shown it ($p < 0.001$). This cause of non-receipt does not detectably differ from withholding in belief accuracy.[51]

Withheld facts score 0.360 lower in positional alignment than facts whose transmission failed ($p < 0.001$), so a receiver who knew how senders disclose could infer the truth from non-receipt. However, given the difference in rates at which senders actually disclose, inference is limited: Bayes' rule would lower expected loss after non-receipt by 0.002, less than two percent of the cost of withholding.[52] Selectivity thus raises belief error through the withholding it causes.

Receipt corrects beliefs only in part. Although the fact reveals the correct answer, receivers shown it close about a third of the distance between their prior and certainty (32.9 percent). Policy views and donations do not detectably differ between receipt and non-receipt (Table 9, columns (3)–(4)).

Senders anticipated the effect on knowledge but overestimated the effect on views. General-population senders expected receipt to raise the share of receivers who answer correctly by 17.0 pp, and it rose by 20.1. They expected views to move by 0.661 points on the five-point scale, more than four times the 0.154 points by which receivers shown the fact changed their views.[53]

6.2.3 Perceived Selectivity and Responses to Non-Receipt

Receivers underestimate how often senders disclose. On average, they believe 57.1 percent of the senders in their sender-fact-receiver combination passed the fact on, against an actual 67.7 percent ($p < 0.001$). Their estimates barely respond to how the actual

[51] Bounds that trim for differential completion (Lee 2009) leave this unchanged (Appendix Table E.2).
[52] Appendix H.2 derives the benchmark.
[53] Journalists expected 30.5 pp, against 28.1, and 0.539 points, against 0.352.

rate depends on sender-fact-receiver combination: a ten-point higher actual rate raises the perceived rate by less than one point.

Receivers also perceive little of the selection. Perceived selectivity, the difference between the disclosure rates receivers attribute to the two answers, barely moves with actual selectivity in their cell. The slope is 0.066. Correcting for sampling error in the cell rates raises it only to 0.085.[54] Figure 7 illustrates why. A quarter of receivers perceive no selection at all, and those who perceive some are almost as likely to get its direction wrong (35.2 percent of receivers) as right (39.7 percent).

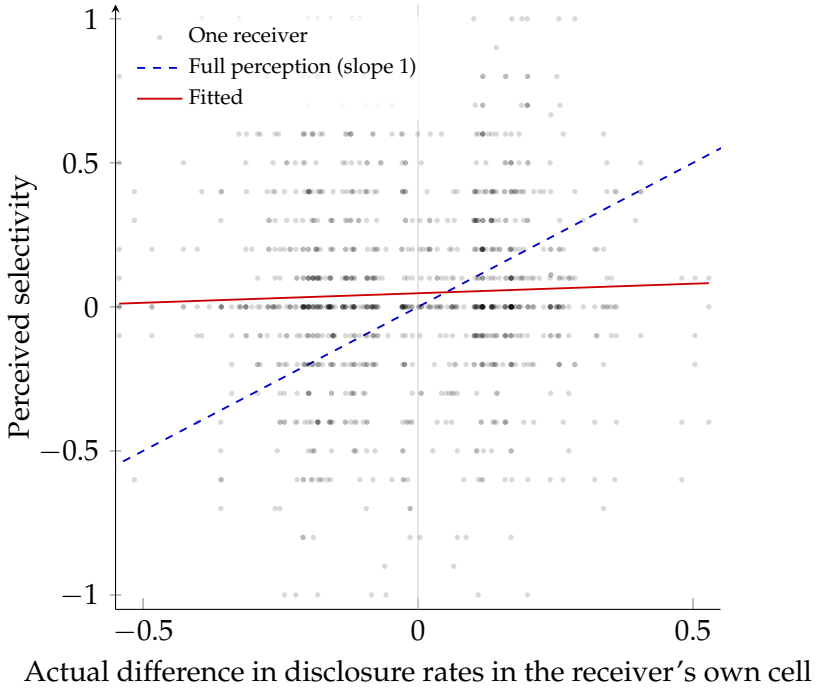


Figure 7: Perceived and Actual Selectivity in Sender Disclosure

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}043$ Experiment 4 receivers. One point per receiver. Each receiver estimates how many senders in their own cell of sender stance, receiver stance, topic and fact passed the fact on under each of the two possible correct answers; the difference between those two estimates is their perceived selectivity. The actual difference on the horizontal axis is the corresponding difference among the Experiment 2 and 3 senders who faced that cell, with the counterfactual state constructed from the opposite-direction facts of the same topic at the same stances. The dashed line is the 45-degree benchmark a receiver who perceived selectivity in full would trace, and the solid line is the fitted relation, whose slope is 0.066. Both axes are drawn on the same scale. Perceived selectivity is elicited as a difference of counts and therefore takes discrete values; the actual difference does not.

Given what they perceive, receivers should move little after non-receipt: at their own stated rates, Bayes' rule prescribes an average change of 2.3 points on the 0–100 scale. Their belief changes do not track even this. Regressed on the prescribed change, belief change has a slope of -0.180. Thus, I reject updating consistent with perceived selectivity ($p < 0.001$). The registered log-odds version gives the same answer, and none of these results depends on whether the fact supports the receiver's view (Ap-

[54] Appendix E describes the correction.

pendix Table E.3).

Result 4.1 (Receivers perceive little of the selection)**.** *Receivers underestimate how often senders disclose and perceive little of the selection. Their belief changes after non-receipt do not track what their own perceptions imply.*

7 Discussion and Concluding Remarks

This paper asks who shares what with whom when everything there is to share is true. In three experiments, senders decide whether to pass political facts to receivers assigned to them; in a fourth, receivers are matched to those decisions. Senders, including professional journalists, provide facts that support their own position more often than facts that cut against it, and where they see the receiver's position, they provide less the further the receiver stands from their own. Receivers whose sender withheld a fact are left with less accurate beliefs than receivers shown it, and they perceive little of the selection.

What do senders select on? In Experiment 1, senders provide facts that support their position more often, even with prior knowledge held fixed and although they rate almost all facts credible. But most aligned facts are also the ones senders expect to move the receiver toward their position, and few unaligned facts are, so the alignment gap cannot tell a sender who values voicing their side from one who wants to persuade. Experiments 2 and 3 therefore elicit what senders expect each fact to do to each receiver, which makes these returns separately estimable. In Experiment 2, provision rises with the stance–fact alignment index, with the persuasion and, more weakly, the correction a fact is expected to produce, and it falls steeply with the receiver's political distance. In canonical disclosure models, the sender cares only about how the receiver responds (Grossman 1981, Milgrom 1981). Here, alignment predicts provision even with the expected persuasion and correction held fixed, which is consistent with senders valuing aligned facts as such. Senders also select on whom as well as on what: distant receivers get fewer facts. What reaches them is also more slanted toward the sender's side.

What senders act on responds to circumstances. When the receiver goes on to make a real political donation, senders tend to select more strongly on the persuasion they expect a fact to produce and provide relatively more to distant receivers, while selection on the expected correction and on alignment shows no detectable change. What a consequential choice adds, it appears, is the receiver choosing as the sender prefers, not the receiver choosing under correct beliefs. In Experiment 2, where a fact's positional alignment and the direction senders expect it to move the receiver barely overlap, political action does not detectably raise alignment-based selectivity, and the slant of

provision is unchanged. In Experiment 1, where the two largely coincide, political action raises both.[55] This suggests that the increase in Experiment 1 operated through the persuasive component.

Here, journalists' choices produce a supply slanted toward their own positions even without extrinsic incentives. In a task that removes competition, ownership and audience demand, their responses to each determinant do not detectably differ from the general population's, and their alignment bias is larger, partly because they hold stronger political positions. They differ in two respects: they provide more overall, and they pass on more of the facts that challenge the receiver's view, which their forecasts say will persuade. Journalists who, after the task, strongly endorse passing on information that contradicts their own position select on positional alignment about half as much as those who merely agree.

Selectivity distorts beliefs downstream, and those it falls on perceive little of it. Senders disproportionately withhold the facts that cut against their own position, so what a receiver does not hear tends to be evidence against the sender's side. Withholding leaves receivers with less accurate beliefs. Receivers underestimate how often senders disclose and perceive little of the selection. Their beliefs after non-receipt do not move as their own perception of how senders disclose implies. Senders expect a fact to move views far more than it does, so they gain little of what they seek, while the receivers they withhold from bear the cost in what they know.

Several accounts outside the framework predict patterns the data do not show. If senders withheld facts they doubt (Thaler 2024, Eil and Rao 2011), selection would follow disbelief. However, in Experiment 1 senders rate almost every fact credible, and in Experiments 2 and 3 positional alignment still predicts provision when the credibility rating of senders at the same position is held fixed. If senders selected to signal their own policy view (Bénabou and Tirole 2006, Bursztyn et al. 2023a, Braghieri 2024, Guriev et al. 2026), alignment should not matter where provision cannot reveal it. Yet, it matters in Experiment 1, where the receiver never learns that a decision was made, and in Experiments 2 and 3, where the receiver learns the sender's position whatever arrives. If senders shared what will be well received (Serra-Garcia 2026) or withheld to spare the receiver an unwelcome belief (Mol et al. 2025), they would favor facts that agree with the receiver's view, but the general population does not, and journalists do the opposite.

Experimenter demand and social desirability work against the finding of selectivity. Participants could expect a study of information sharing to reward impartiality, so both pressures push toward less selectivity (de Quidt et al. 2018, Bursztyn et al. 2025), and for journalists the press code's duties of truthfulness and balance push the same way

[55] Notably, senders' persuasion forecasts predict provision when the receiver donates and not detectably otherwise (Appendix Table B.10).

(Deutscher Presserat 2025). Between 82.2 and 87.5 percent of participants perceived no political bias in the study, and few identified its research question.

Ideally, each return would be shifted experimentally while the others are held fixed. I randomize political action and whom senders face, so political distance causally lowers provision. Shifting the returns themselves is harder: preferences, and with them alignment, cannot be assigned, and the information treatment in Experiment 1 moved expected persuasiveness too little to be informative. Experiments 2 and 3 therefore elicit the returns. Comparing each sender's choices across facts and receivers holds fixed everything stable about the sender and the fact, and the framework guides a reading of the associations as motives. Stated motives and norms, recorded after the task, line up with these choices.

The least precise result is the shift toward persuasion under political action. It keeps its sign under alternative inference and sample restrictions, and because a receiver moved toward the sender may also give more to the sender's side, it reflects the value of both. Experiment 2 cannot exclude a moderate rise in the value of aligned facts under political action, which would also account for the increase in Experiment 1. Experiment 3 has no CONTROL treatment, so how political action changes the response to expected persuasion rests on the general population.

The pattern holds across two countries, two policy domains, three samples and two disclosure regimes. The general-population samples are quota samples, and the journalists are professionals working in the field. Which facts people find, verify or produce, and how selection among truths compares with the supply of falsehoods, are questions for other designs. The journalists decide privately for one receiver, so the results describe their individual choices, not how much such choices contribute to slant in published media.

The typical response to distorted political information checks and labels what was said, and it finds nothing to correct here: the distortion arises from selection among true facts, and receivers perceive little of it. Remedies that act on supply also appear insufficient on their own. Appeals to accuracy target the return that does not strengthen when the receiver's choice has real consequences, remedies that act on market structure leave journalists' own selection untouched, and rules that mandate balance, as the Fairness Doctrine did for U.S. broadcasters until 1987 (Federal Communications Commission 1987), govern which facts are supplied, while senders also select whom they inform. An effective policy would have to reach the allocation itself, which requires observing which facts were available, which were passed on, and to whom. The evidence suggests a broader conclusion: political information can be distorted without any false statement, through the choice of which facts to pass on and to whom.

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A Experimental Design Details

Experimental instructions and interface screenshots are available upon request.

A.1 Fact Selection and Validation Survey (Experiment 1)

I selected statistics for the main experiment from a larger pool of candidates using a pre-registered validation survey ($N = 100$, AsPredicted No. 232064) conducted on Prolific between June 10 and June 21, 2025. The survey evaluated eight candidate statistics (four hypothesized as pro-immigration and four as anti-immigration) against three survey-measured criteria (perceived credibility, policy relevance, and perceived political direction). Facts were selected by the following rule: within each direction, the two statistics with the highest policy relevance among those with adequate perceived credibility were selected, subject to the constraint that the final set contains two pro-immigration and two anti-immigration statistics. The registration (AsPredicted No. 232064) governs fact selection. It also lists a belief-accuracy outcome, two order conditions, correlations of initial beliefs with the ratings, a pre–post attitude test, and five exclusion rules.

Candidate facts and selection criteria. Table A.1 reports the eight candidate statistics with their survey-measured scores. Four criteria were operationalized as follows:

Veracity was established through source verification. Each selected statistic is supported by multiple independent, authoritative sources: peer-reviewed academic publications, federal statistical agencies, or nonpartisan research institutions. Source documentation is provided below.

Policy relevance was measured by asking respondents: "How relevant do others consider the statistic when forming immigration policy positions?" (1 = completely irrelevant, 5 = extremely relevant).

Perceived credibility was measured by asking respondents: "How credible is the statistic?" (1 = not at all, 5 = entirely).

Perceived political direction was measured through two items: *usability* ("For whom would the statistic be most useful in a policy debate?"; 1 = exclusively supporting expansive immigration, 5 = exclusively supporting restrictive immigration) and *opinionability* ("How does learning about the statistic change someone's immigration policy views?"; 1 = convince to support expansion, 5 = convince to support limitation). These directional measures serve the classification of statistics as pro- or anti-immigration and the balance criterion.

Table A.1: Candidate Facts: Survey-Measured Indicators

	Policy	Perceived	Perceived Direction	
Statistic	Relevance	Credibility	Usability	Opinionability
Pro-immigration				
Crime Rate†	3.74 (1.18)	3.50 (0.97)	2.23 (1.06)	2.36 (1.11)
Labor†	3.64 (1.04)	3.81 (1.02)	2.40 (1.09)	2.57 (1.23)
Entrepreneurship	3.12 (1.08)	3.54 (1.00)	2.09 (1.05)	2.18 (1.15)
Healthcare	3.28 (1.03)	3.59 (1.07)	2.03 (1.05)	2.19 (1.15)
Anti-immigration				
Border Crossings†	3.85 (1.14)	3.97 (0.90)	3.94 (1.14)	4.08 (1.11)
Fiscal Impact†	3.79 (1.01)	3.55 (0.93)	3.68 (1.15)	3.73 (1.01)
Poverty Rate	3.41 (1.01)	3.93 (0.93)	3.40 (1.13)	3.52 (1.11)
Wage Inequality	3.35 (0.95)	3.53 (0.90)	3.41 (1.06)	3.43 (0.99)

Notes: The sample is the $N = 100$ respondents of the Experiment 1 validation survey. Cells report means with standard deviations in parentheses. Selected statistics are marked with †. Policy relevance: 1 = completely irrelevant, 5 = extremely relevant. Perceived credibility: 1 = not at all credible, 5 = entirely credible. Usability and opinionability: 1 = supports expansive immigration, 5 = supports restrictive immigration. One-sample t-tests against the neutral midpoint of 3 reject the null for all eight statistics on both directional measures ($p < 0.001$ for all selected statistics; see text).

Final selection. The selection rule applied within each direction independently. Among the four pro-immigration candidates, Crime Rate (3.74) and Labor Force Participation (3.64) had the highest policy relevance scores, both with adequate perceived credibility (≥ 3.50). Among the four anti-immigration candidates, Border Crossings (3.85) and Fiscal Impact (3.79) had the highest policy relevance, again with adequate credibility. The one rejected statistic with notably high credibility—Poverty Rate (3.93)—scored lower on policy relevance (3.41) than both selected anti-immigration statistics. Perceived direction does not detectably differ across Democrats, Republicans and Independents for the four selected statistics (one-way ANOVA).

Direction validation. I classify Crime Rate and Labor Force Participation as pro-immigration and Border Crossings and Fiscal Impact as anti-immigration. This classification is validated by the survey's directional measures. For usability and opinionability respectively, the pro-immigration statistics score below the neutral midpoint of 3 (Crime: 2.23, 2.36; Labor: 2.40, 2.57) and the anti-immigration statistics score above it (Border: 3.94, 4.08; Fiscal: 3.68, 3.73). One-sample t-tests against the midpoint of 3 reject the null of no directional content for all four selected statistics on both measures: Crime ($t = -7.25$ and $t = -5.74$), Labor ($t = -5.50$ and $t = -3.49$), Border Crossings

($t = 8.21$ and $t = 9.75$), and Fiscal Impact ($t = 5.89$ and $t = 7.20$), all $p < 0.001$.

Source documentation. Each selected statistic is supported by multiple independent, authoritative sources. I report the specific values shown to participants, the primary source for each, and corroborating evidence. All sources were available at the time of the experiment (July–August 2025).

Crime Rate. Participants were shown violent crime *arrest* rates per 100,000 residents in Texas (2012–2018): 213.0 for U.S.-born citizens, 185.3 for legal immigrants (13% lower), and 96.2 for undocumented immigrants (55% lower). These figures are from Light et al. (2020), who analyze felony arrests recorded in the Texas Computerized Criminal History database cross-referenced with Department of Homeland Security immigration status checks.[56] Another analysis uses Texas Department of Public Safety conviction data over a longer period (2013–2022) and reports homicide conviction rates of 3.0 per 100,000 for native-born Americans, 2.2 for unauthorized immigrants (26% lower), and 1.2 for legal immigrants (61% lower).[57]

Labor Force Participation. Participants were shown 2023 annual average labor force participation rates: 66.6% for the foreign-born population and 61.8% for the native-born population (4.8 pp higher).[58]

Border Crossings. Participants were shown two figures computed from U.S. Customs and Border Protection (CBP) enforcement statistics:[59] a historical average of 890,435 apprehensions per year over fiscal years 1970–2019, and a recent five-year average of 1,584,573 encounters per year over fiscal years 2020–2024 (78% higher). The comparison requires combining two CBP reporting series: "apprehensions" (reported through FY2019) and "encounters" (reported from FY2020 onward, which combine apprehensions and expulsions under Title 42 and Title 8 processing).[60] The statistic reflects data available at experiment time (July–August 2025).

Fiscal Impact. Participants were shown that first-generation immigrant households

[56] Published in *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*; data and replication materials available at https://www.openicpsr.org/openicpsr/project/124923.

[57] Cato Institute Policy Analysis no. 977; available at https://www.cato.org/policy-analysis/illegal-immigrant-murderers-texas-2013-2022.

[58] The annual report is available at https://www.bls.gov/news.release/pdf/forbrn.pdf. At the time of writing, the 2024 edition (released May 2025) reports 66.5% versus 61.7%, confirming the same pattern. The same data are available through the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis FRED database, Current Population Survey Table A-7, https://fred.stlouisfed.org/release/tables?rid=50&eid=1736. The foreign-born participation rate has exceeded the native-born rate in every year of the BLS series.

[59] CBP historical data available at https://www.cbp.gov/newsroom/stats/cbp-enforcement-statistics.

[60] Beginning in March 2020, CBP shifted from reporting apprehensions to reporting "encounters," a broader category. The historical series (1970–2019) uses the apprehension metric; the recent series (2020–2024) uses the encounter metric. Since encounters $\geq$ apprehensions by construction, the 78% comparison is an upper bound—i.e., it may slightly overstate the increase by comparing a narrower historical measure to a broader recent measure.

generate $57.4 billion more in annual state and local government costs than they contribute in taxes, based on 2011–2013 data. This figure is from the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine comprehensive report on the economic and fiscal consequences of immigration, which remains a comprehensive fiscal analysis of immigration in the United States.[61]

A.2 Belief Elicitation and Donation Task (Experiment 1)

Prior-knowledge elicitation. Senders complete each comparative statement by choosing "higher," "lower," or "don't know." Correct completions receive a bonus, incorrect completions do not, and "don't know" responses receive the bonus with 25% probability.

Donation task. Senders allocate $500 between the *American Immigration Council* (AIC), which advocates for increased immigration, and *NumbersUSA*, which advocates for decreased immigration. I briefly describe the stated goals of each organization and present their missions in their own words, with the display order randomized. Participants are informed that one donation decision from the experiment will be randomly selected and implemented, and they receive a verification link to confirm the donation was placed.

A description text and part of both mission statements are reproduced verbatim below. Senders saw the two organizations side by side as bulleted lists, with their left–right order randomized.

> *Description text.* American immigration organizations range from those advocating for more open policies to those pushing for greater restrictions. The *American Immigration Council* champions seeing immigrants as valuable contributors who deserve stronger protections and family-friendly policies. In contrast, *NumbersUSA* advocates for reduced immigration levels to prevent overcrowding and promotes stricter enforcement of limitations.
>
> Below, you will find a brief description of each organization in their own words.
>
> **American Immigration Council (AIC)**
>
> - The American Immigration Council envisions a nation where immigrants are embraced, communities are enriched, and justice prevails for all.

[61] National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine (2017); the state and local fiscal impact analysis is in Chapter 8. Available at https://www.nationalacademies.org/read/23550/chapter/14.

- We strive to create a society that values immigrants as vital contributors to our nation [...].
- Our immigration system and the way it treats immigrants often fail to live up to our highest values and ideals.
- Not only have we failed, in many cases, to afford basic due process rights, but in countless ways, our outdated immigration laws and policies do not respect the family unit, discourage innovation, and turn away those in need of protection.

NumbersUSA

- NumbersUSA advocates for sensible immigration policies that ensure Americans' safety and promote economic fairness while protecting the environment and quality of life.
- The current system creates endless "chain migration," of distant relatives, with backlogs, frustration, and a level of immigration that is incompatible with conservation and economic justice.
- The current system displaces qualified Americans with exploitable foreign workers.
- The current system raffles away green cards and puts tourists who give birth in the U.S. on a path to citizenship.

A.3 Information Condition Implementation (Experiment 1)

The persuasiveness elicitation proceeds in three stages: study presentation and elicitation (all senders), information feedback (INFO = 1 only), and expected attitude change elicitation (all senders). I describe each stage and reproduce the text shown to participants.

Stage 1: Study presentation and elicitation (all senders). All senders read the following description of the Haaland and Roth (2020) study:

> A recent study published in the prestigious academic journal, *Journal of Public Economics*, examined how people form political opinions.
>
> The researchers surveyed more than 3,000 Americans that are representative of the US population.
>
> People were told about a 1980 event when 55,000 Cuban immigrants unexpectedly arrived in Miami, increasing the city's workforce by 8% almost overnight. They were asked how this affected the wages and employment of U.S.-born workers.
>
> Then, half of the participants learned that research found this wave of immigration had virtually no effect on the wages or unemployment for U.S.-born workers, because the new immigrants increased demand for goods and services, which created more jobs.
>
> The other half of the participants received no information.

Senders then make two incentivized predictions:

1. *Behavioral effect (continuous):* "By what percentage did learning about the research findings change people's petition signing rates?" Senders enter a percentage (positive or negative).

2. *Differential updating (categorical):* "After learning about the research findings, who do you think changed their attitudes toward immigration more?" Senders choose among: (a) people who initially believed immigration harmed U.S.-born workers, (b) people who initially believed immigration did not harm U.S.-born workers, or (c) both groups changed about the same amount.

Each question is equally likely to be selected for the bonus payment. For the continuous estimate, the probability of receiving the bonus is 100% if the estimate equals the true value (69%) and decreases linearly to 0% at a deviation of 20 percentage points or more. For the categorical estimate, the probability is 100% if correct and 0% otherwise. Senders are instructed not to search for the answers and tab-switching is monitored to enforce compliance; senders who switched tabs during this stage were excluded as pre-registered.

Stage 2: Information feedback (INFO = 1 only). Senders in the INFO condition receive personalized feedback comparing their predictions to the actual results. Senders in the no-INFO condition proceed directly to Stage 3. The feedback screen displays the following:

Petition Signatures

The percentage of people who signed the White House petition actually increased by **69%**.

You estimated that the percentage of people who signed the White House petition changed by ***[participant's estimate]%***.

That means ***you [underestimated/overestimated] the change by [participant-specific gap] percentage points***.

Effect on Attitudes toward Immigration

Actual Result: People who initially believed immigration harmed U.S.-born workers changed their attitudes toward immigration **significantly more** than those who already held correct beliefs.

Your Answer: ***[participant's answer]***.

The feedback is accompanied by a bar chart that displays the sender's estimate and the true value (69%) side by side, with bar heights scaled proportionally. The sender's categorical prediction is marked as correct or incorrect with a color-coded indicator. A summary reiterates the two key findings: (i) receiving information strongly changed behavior and (ii) the effect was strongest for participants who initially held false beliefs.[62]

Stage 3: Expected attitude change elicitation (all senders). All senders then predict how receiving each of the four immigration statistics would shift the attitudes of hypothetical receivers. For each statistic j, senders allocate 10 hypothetical participants—described as holding the receiver belief state realized for that statistic (false belief or "don't know")—among three categories: those who become *more supportive* of immigration, those who become *less supportive* of immigration, and those whose opinions *do not change*. The allocations must sum to 10. This procedure generates the expected attitude change measure $\Delta\text{Attitude}_{i,j}$ defined in Section 2.2.2, which provides within-sender variation in perceived persuasiveness across statistics, and between-sender variation across receiver belief states.

[62]The gap between the participant's estimate and the true value is computed individually and displayed dynamically in the experimental interface. Senders who estimated the effect exactly see a confirmation message rather than a deviation.

> You will estimate how ten participants who hold **false beliefs** or **do not know the answer** would change their attitudes about immigration if they **are provided with research findings**.
>
> In particular, you will estimate how many of them…
>
> - become less supportive of immigration.
> - don't change their opinion.
> - become more supportive of immigration.

The interface displays 10 person icons to make the allocation task concrete. Senders complete this task four times: once for each of the four statistics, with the hypothetical receivers described by the belief state of the receiver group matched to that statistic. The order of statistics is randomized across senders.

Senders' beliefs and the INFO first stage. Senders believe the information in Haaland and Roth (2020) moved policy views, with roughly 90 percent expecting it to raise petition signatures, though they underestimate the size of the effect it had (Figure B.1). Senders shown the Haaland and Roth (2020) results expect a larger pro-immigration shift from the crime fact (+5.8 pp, $p = 0.002$) and from the labor fact (+3.8 pp, $p = 0.033$). For the two anti-immigration facts the changes are not distinguishable from zero (Table **??**). As pre-registered, a pooled regression of the absolute belief change on INFO with topic fixed effects, prior beliefs and demographic controls, clustered by sender, shows that INFO raises the absolute belief change by about 9 percent of its mean without the information ($p < 0.001$). In the forecast that bears on selectivity—expected movement toward the sender's own side—the induced shift is +0.034 per unit of alignment ($p = 0.032$), against a range of 0.55 in mean expected persuasiveness across the four facts.

A.4 Fact Selection and Pre-Validation Survey (Experiments 2 and 3)

I selected facts for Experiments 2 and 3 from a larger candidate pool using a pre-registered pre-validation survey (AsPredicted #290989) conducted on the Bilendi panel in Germany in May 2026. The survey evaluated 36 candidate facts. Six were hypothesized as pro-policy and six as anti-policy in three domains: immigration, climate, redistribution. They were evaluated against four criteria, and additionally validated the domain-specific advocacy organizations used in the ACTION treatment.

Criteria and selection rule. Four criteria were applied to each candidate fact. *Prior knowledge* was elicited via an incentivized fill-in-the-blank completion of the fact state-

ment with a confidence slider from 50 to 100. The probabilistic prior knowledge score is PK $=$ confidence$/100$ for correct completions and $1 -$ confidence$/100$ for incorrect completions. *Directional consistency* was measured by a 5-point rating (1 = strongly pro-policy, 5 = strongly anti-policy). A fact counts as directional if more respondents rate it in its assigned direction than in the opposite one. The registration set this criterion at 60 percent of all respondents. Prior-knowledge balance was also checked on the registered binary correct rate, on which the selected sets differ by 0.21 (immigration) and 0.23 (climate), within the bound of 0.25. *Policy relevance* and *perceived credibility* were each measured on a 1–5 scale.

The selection rule chose the top three facts by policy relevance within each topic and direction cell among those passing directional consistency, subject to balance constraints across the pro and anti sets for credibility and policy relevance.

The ACTION treatment organizations were additionally validated against two criteria: (i) at least 50% of respondents correctly recognize each organization as representing the pro-policy or anti-policy position respectively, and (ii) a positive Spearman correlation between topic-specific attitude and hypothetical donation to the pro-organization, restricted to respondents with directional attitudes.

Domain selection. The redistribution domain failed on both grounds and is excluded. All six redistribution anti-direction candidate facts failed the directional consistency criterion, and the redistribution anti-organization had a recognition rate of 33.3%, well below the 50% threshold. Immigration passed all fact and organization criteria (anti-organization recognition: 93.6%; Spearman $r = 0.571$). Climate passed the organization correlation criterion ($r = 0.566$); the climate anti-organization fell marginally below the recognition threshold (42.6% vs. 50%). Since climate's organization failure was marginal while redistribution's failures were compounding, climate was retained and this deviation is noted here.

Deviations from algorithmic fact selection. *Immigration.* The algorithm selected *Bildungsabschluss* (correct rate 0.78), which produced a pro–anti gap in the correct rate of 0.29, exceeding the 0.25 balance threshold. It was replaced by *Illegale Aufenthalte* (correct rate 0.55), closing the gap to 0.21 while satisfying all other balance constraints.

Climate. The pro set was revised to *Erneuerbare Energien*, *Stromgestehungskosten*, and *Grüne Beschäftigung* for higher directional consistency. *Netzausbaukosten* (anti) was reformulated between the pre-validation survey and the main experiment; directional ratings in Table A.2 reflect the pre-reformulation version, which failed the consistency criterion (17.5% consistent vs. 42.1% inconsistent). The reformulated version is what was fielded in the main experiment. Excluding this fact leaves the estimates unchanged (positional alignment $+0.130$; persuasion interaction $+0.071$).

Selected facts and pre-validation ratings. Table A.2 reports the 12 selected facts with their pre-validation survey scores. Table A.3 reports the balance check.

Table A.2: Selected Facts: Pre-Validation Ratings

Fact	Dir.	Relevance	Credibility	PK	% Consistent
Immigration					
Fachkräftemangel	Pro	3.79	3.65	0.52	45.8
Beschäftigungswachstum	Pro	3.43	3.45	0.55	38.8
Integrationskurs	Pro	3.61	3.29	0.37	32.1
Kriminalität	Anti	4.04	3.76	0.70	90.0
Bürgergeld‡	Anti	3.98	3.74	0.67	78.7
Illegale Aufenthalte	Anti	3.69	3.45	0.51	76.5
Climate policy					
Erneuerbare Energien	Pro	3.67	3.61	0.52	51.0
Stromgestehungskosten	Pro	3.46	3.51	0.56	61.4
Grüne Beschäftigung	Pro	3.28	3.46	0.57	47.8
Netzausbaukosten†	Anti	3.84	3.53	0.72	17.5
Energiekosten Industrie	Anti	4.09	3.60	0.81	35.8
Preisvolatilität	Anti	3.73	3.36	0.66	33.9

Notes: The sample is the $N \approx 300$ respondents of the pre-validation survey for the facts used in Experiments 2 and 3. Policy relevance and perceived credibility: 1 = lowest, 5 = highest. PK is the confidence-weighted prior knowledge probability (see text). % Consistent is the share of respondents whose directional rating matches the assigned fact direction. † Reformulated after pre-validation; ratings are pre-reformulation and failed the consistency criterion. ‡ Relabeled from *Arbeitslosigkeit*; underlying statistic unchanged.

Table A.3: Balance Check: Selected Facts by Domain

Domain	ΔRelevance	ΔCredibility	ΔPK	Passes
Immigration	0.29	0.19	0.15	Yes
Climate	0.42	0.03	0.18	Yes

Notes: The table compares the facts selected for Experiments 2 and 3 by domain. Δ is the absolute difference between mean pro-direction and mean anti-direction facts. Thresholds: ΔRelevance $\leq$ 1.0, ΔCredibility $\leq$ 1.0, ΔPK $\leq$ 0.25. The ΔPK row uses the confidence-weighted score. On the binary correct rate the gaps are 0.21 and 0.23. Climate ΔPK uses pre-reformulation statistics for *Netzausbaukosten*.

A.5 Donation Task Organizations (Experiments 2 and 3)

Senders allocate €250 between the two advocacy organizations for their assigned domain. For immigration these are *ProAsyl*, which advocates a more open migration

and asylum policy, and *Republik21*, which advocates a stricter one; for climate, *BUND*, which advocates strict national climate targets for individual economic sectors, and *Stiftung Marktwirtschaft*, which opposes them. Senders first see a description sentence naming both organizations, then each organization's positions in its own words, presented side by side as bulleted lists with the left–right order randomized within sender.

The task was administered in German and the text below is translated. The description text is reproduced for the immigration domain and for a sender who saw *ProAsyl* on the left; the alternative order reverses the two clauses and the two blocks without altering any wording.

> *Description text.* The following two organizations hold different positions on immigration. On one side is *ProAsyl*, which advocates a more open migration and asylum policy. On the other side is *Republik21*, which advocates a stricter migration and asylum policy.
>
> Below you will find some statements from the two organizations in their own words.
>
> **ProAsyl**
>
> - Refugee protection is a human right.
> - The sealing of borders, refusals of entry without individual case assessment, and political measures that in effect hollow out the right to asylum are to be critically examined and rejected.
> - Refugees should be given access to education, work, counseling, and participation in society.
>
> **Republik21**
>
> - Immigration policy should take into account not only the well-being of immigrants but also the interests of the native population.
> - The inflow of refugees is to be reduced in order to end the overburdening of institutions.
> - In cases of refusal to integrate, criminal conduct, extremist views, or holiday travel to the country of origin, refugees' residence permits should lapse.
>
> **BUND**
>
> - The barriers currently holding back the environmentally compatible expansion of renewable energy must fall.

- Turn off the money tap for oil, gas, and coal by abolishing climate-damaging subsidies such as preferential tax treatment for diesel and kerosene and ending support for new gas infrastructure.
- Climate action requires binding commitments: the Federal Climate Action Act must firmly set annual climate targets for all economic sectors.

Stiftung Marktwirtschaft

- Germany's energy transition is uniquely expensive, the security of its energy supply is not assured over the longer term, the CO_2 savings achieved are modest, and the promised "green economic miracle" has failed to materialize.
- The domestic energy supply should be expanded in a technology-open manner in order to ensure a secure, clean, and affordable energy supply beyond solar, wind, and hydro(gen) power.

A.6 Instrument Revision During Fielding (Experiment 2)

Experiment 2 had to be shortened two days into fielding. Senders who started before the revision took a median of 29.4 minutes, against the fifteen agreed with the panel provider. One module was removed. An instruction page and four pages on which senders estimated how people sharing their position would perceive facts from the other topic. After the revision the median was 17.1 minutes. The donation task, the five provision decisions, both incentivized belief elicitations, the cross-domain rating task and the post-questionnaire were unchanged. AsPredicted #293252, filed on 27 May 2026, supersedes #292898 and states the removal and its reason; the provision task, outcome, positional alignment measure, estimating equations and exclusion rules are word for word identical in both. Every sender in the main sample began after it was filed.

The removed pages carried the perceived-believability control of the pre-registered column (2). The 106 senders who started before the revision ran a different instrument. They are excluded from the main sample by a start-time threshold fixed before any outcome was examined. Adding them back leaves every sign unchanged and weakens the interaction of persuasion with ACTION, which sits near the conventional threshold (Appendix Table C.13, column (3)).

B Experiment 1: Supplementary Results

B.1 Sample Characteristics

Table B.1: Sample Characteristics and Treatment Balance

	Population (1)	Sample (2)	CONTROL (3)	ACTION (4)	INFO (5)	ACTION×INFO (6)
Gender						
Female	0.509	0.502	0.507	0.490	0.503	0.510
Male	0.491	0.478	0.470	0.477	0.477	0.487
Ethnicity						
White	0.578	0.587	0.577	0.590	0.587	0.593
Black	0.121	0.129	0.137	0.120	0.140	0.120
Hispanic	0.187	0.182	0.180	0.183	0.177	0.187
Asian	0.059	0.058	0.063	0.063	0.057	0.050
Other	0.055	0.044	0.043	0.043	0.040	0.050
Political Affiliation						
Democrat	0.386	0.388	0.377	0.393	0.393	0.387
Independent	0.310	0.308	0.323	0.303	0.303	0.300
Republican	0.304	0.298	0.297	0.297	0.300	0.300

Notes: The sample is $N = 1{,}200$ U.S. adults recruited on Prolific (quota-sampled) for Experiment 1. Column (1) reports 2020 U.S. Census population proportions. Column (2) reports full sample proportions. Columns (3)–(6) report proportions by treatment cell.

B.2 Additional Summary Statistics

Table B.2: Prior Knowledge of the Four Immigration Facts

	Share of Responses		
	Correct	False	Don't know
Crime	0.700	0.223	0.076
Labor	0.794	0.141	0.065
Border	0.612	0.317	0.071
Fiscal	0.304	0.553	0.143

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ Experiment 1 senders. The beliefs were elicited before senders were informed they would make provision decisions. Correct means the stated belief matches the verified fact direction; False means the stated belief contradicts the fact; Don't know is an explicit non-answer.

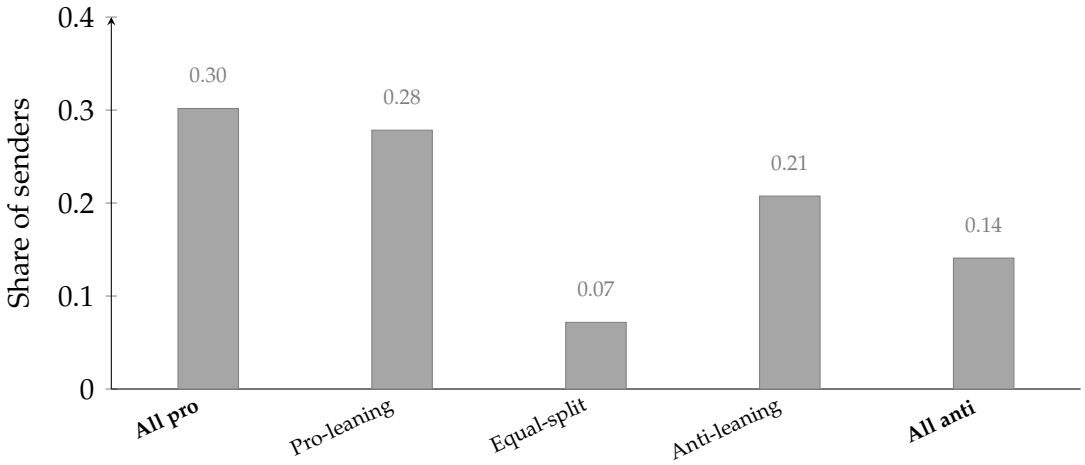


Figure B.2: Distribution of Senders' Donation Allocations to the Advocacy Groups

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ senders of Experiment 1. The horizontal axis shows the allocation to the pro-immigration group collapsed into five categories ("All pro = \$500, "Pro-leaning = \$251–499, "Equal-split = \$250, "Anti-leaning = \$1–249, "All anti = \$0) from a total \$500 stake. The vertical axis shows the proportion of senders.

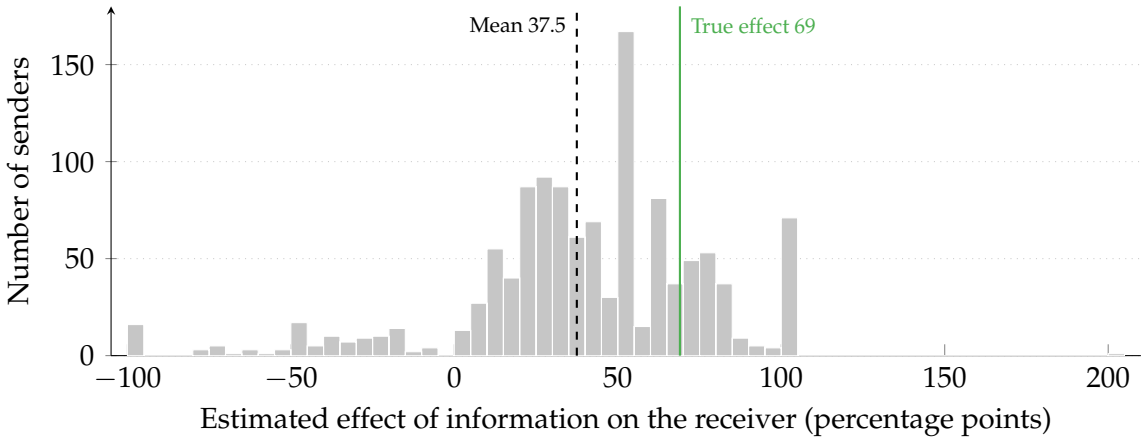


Figure B.1: Senders' Beliefs About the Persuasive Effect of Information

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ Experiment 1 senders. The figure shows the distribution of senders' estimates of the effect of providing information on the receiver's likelihood of signing a petition, elicited before the provision task (pre-treatment); bins are 5 percentage points wide. The dashed line marks the sample mean (37.5); the solid green line marks the true effect of 69% from Haaland and Roth (2020).

B.3 Robustness of Main Results

Demeaning by fact. The sender-level alignment bias of Section 2.2.3 is 9.3 pp, averaged over the four treatments. It does not hold fact baselines fixed, and the facts differ in how often they are provided: the two pro-immigration facts by 6.6 pp more than the two anti-immigration ones. A sender's aligned facts are the pair matching their position, and 62.5 percent of senders are pro-immigration, so this difference raises the average bias. Subtracting each fact's mean provision, the non-parametric counterpart of the fact fixed effects of Table 3, leaves 7.6 pp. Because the fact means include the ma-

Table B.3: Perceived Credibility of Facts by Political Affiliation

	Percentage Perceiving Statistic as Credible			
	All	Democrats	Independents	Republicans
Crime	0.962	0.996	0.949	0.933
Labor	0.978	0.998	0.965	0.964
Border	0.978	0.985	0.976	0.972
Fiscal	0.968	0.981	0.962	0.958

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ Experiment 1 senders. Credibility is assessed post-provision. Values shown are the share of senders rating each statistic as credible (1 = credible, 0 = not credible).

jority's own aligned provision, the demeaned figure is the conservative one. Averaged over INFO, the ACTION increase is 4.3 pp raw and 4.5 pp demeaned.

Logistic regression. Table B.6 re-estimates specification (1) using logistic regression. All results replicate: the Align $\times$ ACTION interaction is positive and significant across all specifications ($p \leq 0.011$), and the Align $\times$ INFO interaction remains null.

Table B.4: Expected Effects of Information on Political Preferences with Controls

	Expect Effect of Information on Political Preferences			
Statistic	Crime (1)	Labor (2)	Border (3)	Fiscal (4)
Panel (A): INFO				
Constant	0.236***	0.033	−0.336***	−0.259***
	(0.067)	(0.071)	(0.073)	(0.080)
INFO	0.055***	0.035*	−0.034	0.028
	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.023)
Estimated Effect Size	0.000	0.001***	0.001***	0.001***
	(0.000)	(0.000)	(0.000)	(0.000)
Prior Knowledge	0.116***	0.133***	0.003	0.129***
	(0.023)	(0.027)	(0.024)	(0.026)
Panel (B): Receiver Belief State				
Constant	0.249***	0.043	−0.347***	−0.255***
	(0.068)	(0.071)	(0.074)	(0.080)
Receiver Belief False	0.014	0.006	−0.000	0.018
	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.023)
Estimated Effect Size	0.000	0.001***	0.001***	0.001***
	(0.000)	(0.000)	(0.000)	(0.000)
Prior Knowledge	0.116***	0.134***	0.001	0.129***
	(0.023)	(0.027)	(0.024)	(0.026)
Clustered SE	No	No	No	No
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Panel (A): R^2	0.049	0.054	0.047	0.076
Panel (B): R^2	0.042	0.051	0.044	0.075
Panel (A) Adj. R^2	0.031	0.036	0.029	0.058
Panel (B) Adj. R^2	0.025	0.033	0.027	0.058
Num. obs.	1200	1200	1200	1200

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ senders of Experiment 1. The outcome is the expected effect of each statistic on receivers' immigration policy preferences, $[-1, 1]$ (positive = pro-immigration shift). In Panel (A) the regressor is the INFO indicator. In Panel (B) the regressor is Receiver Belief False (= 1 if the matched receiver holds an incorrect prior; = 0 if the receiver reports not knowing). Estimated Effect Size is the sender's incentivized estimate of the Haaland & Roth (2020) treatment effect. Prior Knowledge is the incentivized prior knowledge (1 correct, 0.5 "don't know," 0 incorrect). Controls are demographic covariates. Standard errors are not clustered. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Binary alignment. Table B.7 re-estimates specification (1) with a binary aligned indicator in place of the continuous alignment measure. Because $\text{Align}_{i,j}$ is the product of the sender's policy views and the statistic's direction, its magnitude is the sender's policy view intensity and is constant across that sender's four statistics. The continuous specification therefore imposes that the provision gap is proportional to intensity rather than testing it. The binary coding drops that restriction, and the coefficient be-

Table B.5: Treatment Effects on Alignment Bias

	Alignment Bias	
	(1)	(2)
Intercept	0.067***	−0.026
	(0.021)	(0.071)
Treatment: ACTION	0.065**	0.066**
	(0.029)	(0.029)
Treatment: INFO	0.008	−0.000
	(0.029)	(0.029)
Treatment: ACTION×INFO	0.029	0.024
	(0.029)	(0.029)
Controls	No	Yes
R^2	0.005	0.048
Adj. R^2	0.003	0.029
Num. obs.	1114	1114

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}114$ Experiment 1 senders with revealed directional policy preference ($AIC_i \neq 250$). The outcome is sender-level alignment bias (mean aligned minus mean unaligned provision rate). The reference is CONTROL (no-ACTION, no-INFO). Treatment ACTION is ACTION only; Treatment INFO is INFO only; Treatment ACTION×INFO is ACTION and INFO. Column (2) adds age, gender, education, ethnicity, and party identification. Standard errors are not clustered. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

comes the aligned–unaligned contrast itself, identical for every sender. Every conclusion is unchanged: alignment and its ACTION interaction are significant in all three columns (+5.0 pp, $p = 0.007$, and +6.4 pp, $p = 0.024$, in column 3), and every term involving INFO remains null.

Power for Hypothesis 1.3. INFO raises the expected movement toward the sender's side by +0.034 per unit of alignment ($p = 0.032$), and provision rises by +0.079 per unit of that forecast ($p < 0.001$, sender and fact fixed effects). Together they imply an Align × INFO interaction of +0.0027, 6.3 percent of the one-sided 80 percent-power minimum detectable effect of 0.043; the estimated interaction is +0.004 ($p = 0.831$). The calculation applies to this design under a linear mapping.

Alternative information provision specification. Table B.8 allows asymmetric INFO effects by fact direction to accommodate the asymmetric belief-shifting effect documented in Table **??**. The additional terms $\text{INFO}_i \times \text{PROSTAT}_j$ and $\text{Align}_{i,j} \times \text{INFO}_i \times \text{PROSTAT}_j$ are not statistically significant in the specifications with fact fixed effects. Wald tests on column (3) fail to reject that INFO changes how provision responds to alignment for pro-immigration facts ($p = 0.403$) or for anti-immigration facts ($p = 0.606$), and fail to reject that INFO changes overall provision for pro-immigration facts

Table B.6: Treatment Effects on Information Provision: Logit

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.460***	0.416***	0.430***
	(0.133)	(0.134)	(0.137)
INFO	−0.126	−0.126	−0.126
	(0.183)	(0.184)	(0.188)
ACTION	0.173	0.172	0.167
	(0.195)	(0.196)	(0.200)
Prior Knowledge	0.399***	0.308***	0.317***
	(0.103)	(0.114)	(0.113)
Align × INFO	0.005	−0.009	−0.010
	(0.177)	(0.177)	(0.183)
Align × ACTION	0.535**	0.538**	0.553***
	(0.210)	(0.209)	(0.214)
INFO × ACTION	−0.234	−0.233	−0.241
	(0.259)	(0.260)	(0.268)
Align × INFO × ACTION	−0.434	−0.425	−0.433
	(0.270)	(0.270)	(0.277)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes
No. of Senders	1200	1200	1200
AIC	3258.054	3247.312	3248.924
BIC	3316.341	3325.029	3449.691
Log Likelihood	−1620.027	−1611.656	−1593.462
Deviance	3240.054	3223.312	3186.924
Num. obs.	4800	4800	4800

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ senders of Experiment 1 (4,800 sender-statistic observations). The estimator is logistic regression; coefficients are log-odds. Column structure matches Table 3: column (1) controls for prior knowledge only; column (2) adds statistic fixed effects; column (3) adds statistic fixed effects and demographic controls. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

($p = 0.517$). The core result—Align × ACTION—is unchanged.

Leave-one-fact-out robustness. Table B.9 re-estimates the main specification (Table 3, column 3) four times, each time dropping one of the four statistics. Both coefficients are stable in magnitude across all four runs—Align stays within 0.031–0.043 (full sample: 0.037) and its largest p across runs is 0.028; Align × ACTION stays within 0.039–0.044 (full sample: 0.041) and its largest p across runs is 0.068. No single statistic drives either result.

Table B.10 replaces positional alignment with senders' own forecast of how far each fact moves receivers toward their position, elicited before any provision decision. The

Table B.7: Treatment Effects on Information Provision (Binary Alignment)

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Aligned	0.056***	0.050***	0.050***
	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.019)
INFO	−0.017	−0.014	−0.014
	(0.026)	(0.026)	(0.025)
ACTION	−0.046*	−0.045*	−0.048*
	(0.027)	(0.027)	(0.027)
Prior Knowledge	0.047***	0.036***	0.035***
	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.013)
Aligned × INFO	0.009	0.004	0.004
	(0.027)	(0.027)	(0.027)
Aligned × ACTION	0.065**	0.064**	0.064**
	(0.028)	(0.028)	(0.028)
INFO × ACTION	0.028	0.025	0.024
	(0.038)	(0.038)	(0.038)
Aligned × INFO × ACTION	−0.047	−0.042	−0.041
	(0.041)	(0.041)	(0.041)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes
No. of Senders	1114	1114	1114
Num. obs.	4456	4456	4456
R^2	0.028	0.032	0.041
Adj. R^2	0.026	0.030	0.034

Notes: The sample is the 1,114 Experiment 1 senders with a directional policy preference, 4,456 sender-statistic observations. The model is a linear probability model. *Aligned* is an indicator equal to one if the statistic's policy direction matches the sender's own position, replacing the continuous alignment measure of Table 3. The binary coding imposes no proportionality between the provision gap and preference intensity, so the coefficient is the aligned–unaligned contrast. Senders who split the donation evenly have no aligned statistic and are excluded. Column structure matches Table 3: column (1) controls for prior knowledge only; column (2) adds statistic fixed effects; column (3) adds statistic fixed effects and demographic controls. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

forecast predicts provision when the receiver makes a donation (+0.066, $p < 0.001$) and does not detectably predict it otherwise (+0.024, $p = 0.158$). Entered together with alignment, the two cannot be separated, because they largely coincide ($r = 0.581$; Section 2.2.5).

B.4 Heterogeneity

Table B.11 reports the pre-registered heterogeneity of selective provision by partisanship, party affiliation and policy view intensity, at the decision level with a binary aligned indicator and fact fixed effects. Table B.12 interacts positional alignment and

Table B.8: Treatment Effects on Information Provision: INFO Effects by Fact Direction

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.041***	0.037***	0.037***
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.013)
INFO	−0.034*	−0.018	−0.018
	(0.019)	(0.020)	(0.020)
ACTION	−0.002	−0.002	−0.003
	(0.016)	(0.016)	(0.016)
Prior Knowledge	0.038***	0.035***	0.034***
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Align × INFO	−0.015	−0.009	−0.011
	(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.022)
Align × ACTION	0.041**	0.041**	0.041**
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)
INFO × ACTION	−0.007	−0.007	−0.008
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)
Align × INFO × ACTION	−0.027	−0.027	−0.027
	(0.026)	(0.026)	(0.026)
INFO × PROSTAT	0.038***	0.005	0.005
	(0.015)	(0.020)	(0.020)
Align × INFO × PROSTAT	0.025	0.025	0.029
	(0.023)	(0.023)	(0.025)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	No	Yes
No. of Senders	1200	1200	1200
Num. obs.	4800	4800	4800
R^2	0.032	0.034	0.041
Adj. R^2	0.030	0.031	0.034

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ Experiment 1 senders (4,800 sender-statistic observations). The table extends Table 3 with asymmetric INFO effects by statistic direction. ProStat is a binary indicator for pro-immigration statistics (Crime and Labor). Column structure matches Table 3. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

both treatments with the receiver's belief state; no interaction with the belief state is distinguishable from zero.

B.5 Disbelief, Stated Motives, and Norms

Stated-motive cell sizes and the second classifier. Table B.15 regresses each sender's alignment bias on the considerations their closing account was classified as invoking. Twelve of 1,102 senders state an expressive reason, four in CONTROL and eight under

Table B.9: Leave-One-Fact-Out Robustness of the Alignment Effect and the ACTION Increase

Coefficient	Sign-positive	Min β	Max β	Max p
Align	4/4	0.031	0.043	0.028
Align × ACTION	4/4	0.039	0.044	0.068
Statistics FE		Yes		
Controls		Yes		
Clustered SE		Sender		

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1 senders. Each coefficient is re-estimated four times in the main specification (Table 3, column 3; statistic fixed effects, full demographic and political controls, sender-clustered standard errors), each time dropping one of the four statistics (crime, labor, border, fiscal). Columns report the number of leave-one-out estimates with a positive coefficient, the minimum and maximum coefficient across the four runs, and the largest p-value observed. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.10: Alignment and Expected Persuasion in Experiment 1

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.038***		0.043***
	(0.009)		(0.011)
Align × ACTION	0.028**		0.024
	(0.013)		(0.016)
Expected persuasion		0.023	−0.013
		(0.016)	(0.021)
Expected persuasion × ACTION		0.042*	0.013
		(0.024)	(0.030)
ACTION	−0.006	−0.007	−0.006
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Prior knowledge	0.034***	0.050***	0.034***
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
INFO control	Yes	Yes	Yes
Senders	1,200	1,200	1,200
Observations	4,800	4,800	4,800

Notes: Linear probability estimates for the Experiment 1 senders, pooled across the INFO treatment, which enters as a control; column (1) therefore differs from Table 3, which interacts it. The outcome is the provision decision. Expected persuasion is the net share of ten hypothetical receivers whom the sender expects to move toward the sender's own position after receiving the fact, elicited without incentives before any provision decision. Standard errors clustered by sender in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.11: Heterogeneity in Selective Provision with Binary Alignment

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Aligned	−0.008	0.083***	0.004
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.033)
Aligned × ACTION	0.075**	0.021	−0.011
	(0.035)	(0.033)	(0.048)
Aligned × Partisanship	0.123***		
	(0.038)		
Aligned × ACTION × Partisanship	−0.056		
	(0.059)		
Aligned × Independent		−0.071**	
		(0.033)	
Aligned × Republican		−0.006	
		(0.035)	
Aligned × ACTION × Independent		0.096*	
		(0.050)	
Aligned × ACTION × Republican		−0.031	
		(0.050)	
Aligned × Preference intensity			0.082*
			(0.042)
Aligned × ACTION × Preference intensity			0.069
			(0.061)
Moderator	Partisanship	Political party	Pref. intensity
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes
No. of Senders	1114	1114	1114
Num. obs.	4456	4456	4456
R^2	0.041	0.040	0.044
Adj. R^2	0.036	0.033	0.038

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1 senders with a directional policy preference. The heterogeneity analysis is pre-registered exploratory. Partisanship is the distance of the sender's political orientation from the scale midpoint, rescaled to $[0, 1]$; policy view intensity is $|\text{Pref}_i|$. Each column interacts a binary aligned indicator, the ACTION treatment, and one moderator, with statistic fixed effects and demographic controls. Reference category for political party is Democrat. Alignment enters as a binary indicator rather than the continuous measure, and the specification includes statistic fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

ACTION, and the coefficient is significant at the one percent level within each treatment taken on its own. Any estimated difference between the treatments is thus imprecise. The persuasion-by-ACTION interaction rests on the 23 senders citing persuasion in the ACTION treatment. Table B.17 reports the second classifier, which gives a smaller but same-signed estimate on the 30 such senders it identifies.

Table B.12: Heterogeneous Treatment Effects of Receiver Beliefs

	Probability of Statistic Provision	
	(1)	(2)
Intercept	0.863***	0.894***
	(0.018)	(0.045)
Align	0.026*	0.025*
	(0.014)	(0.014)
INFO	−0.034	−0.034
	(0.021)	(0.022)
ACTION	−0.021	−0.022
	(0.020)	(0.021)
Receiver Belief False	−0.025	−0.024
	(0.018)	(0.018)
Prior Knowledge	0.035***	0.034***
	(0.012)	(0.012)
Align × INFO	0.025	0.025
	(0.023)	(0.023)
Align × ACTION	0.053**	0.054**
	(0.024)	(0.024)
INFO × ACTION	0.014	0.014
	(0.030)	(0.031)
Align × Receiver Belief False	0.019	0.020
	(0.022)	(0.022)
INFO × Receiver Belief False	0.043	0.043
	(0.027)	(0.027)
ACTION × Receiver Belief False	0.034	0.034
	(0.026)	(0.026)
Align × INFO × ACTION	−0.050	−0.051
	(0.035)	(0.035)
Align × INFO × Receiver Belief False	−0.042	−0.042
	(0.032)	(0.032)
Align × ACTION × Receiver Belief False	−0.020	−0.022
	(0.033)	(0.033)
INFO × ACTION × Receiver Belief False	−0.041	−0.043
	(0.038)	(0.038)
Align × INFO × ACTION × Receiver Belief False	0.047	0.048
	(0.045)	(0.045)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	Yes
No. of Senders	1200	1200
R^2	0.034	0.041
Adj. R^2	0.030	0.033
Num. obs.	4800	4800

Notes: The sample is N = 1,200 Experiment 1 senders, 4,800 sender-statistic observations. The outcome is a binary provision indicator. The model is the full four-way interaction of Align, ACTION, INFO, and Receiver Belief False (= 1 if the matched receiver holds a factually incorrect prior belief; = 0 if the receiver reports not knowing). Column (2) adds demographic controls. Statistic fixed effects and sender-clustered standard errors throughout. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.13: The Alignment Effect by Sender Beliefs

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.031*	0.052	0.044
	(0.016)	(0.048)	(0.049)
Prior Knowledge	0.035***	0.024**	0.026**
	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.012)
Credibility		0.253***	0.253***
		(0.063)	(0.063)
Align × Prior Knowledge	0.009		0.015
	(0.016)		(0.015)
Align × Credibility		−0.021	−0.025
		(0.047)	(0.047)
Align × ACTION	0.041**	0.044**	0.044**
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)
Align × INFO	0.004	0.007	0.007
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.017)
Align × INFO × ACTION	−0.027	−0.032	−0.032
	(0.026)	(0.025)	(0.025)
Clustered SE	Subject	Subject	Subject
Statistics FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes
No. of Senders	1200	1200	1200
Num. obs.	4800	4800	4800
R^2	0.040	0.058	0.058
Adj. R^2	0.034	0.052	0.052

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}200$ senders of Experiment 1 (4,800 sender-statistic observations). Each column is specification (1) with statistic fixed effects and demographic controls, augmented by an interaction between alignment and one of the two belief measures. *Prior Knowledge* is the sender's incentivized prior about the statistic, elicited before any provision decision (1 correct, 0.5 "don't know," 0 incorrect). *Credibility* is the sender's unincentivized rating of the statistic, elicited after the provision task. The two interactions carry different weight: prior knowledge varies across the full sample, whereas 97.2% of statistics are rated credible, so the credibility interaction is identified from 136 decisions and its confidence interval is several times the alignment effect. The main effect of alignment in each column is the alignment effect at zero on the interacted measure. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.14: Selective Provision Among Facts the Sender Knew

	Probability of Statistic Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Align	0.025**	0.024**	
	(0.011)	(0.012)	
Align × ACTION	0.040**	0.037**	
	(0.018)	(0.018)	
Aligned (binary)			0.041**
			(0.019)
Aligned (binary) × ACTION			0.045
			(0.029)
Statistics FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Sender FE	No	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	No	No
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender
No. of Senders	673	673	673
Num. obs.	1952	1952	1952

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1 decisions on statistics the sender answered correctly in the incentivized prior elicitation, restricted to senders who did so for at least one aligned and one unaligned statistic ($N = 673$ senders, 1,952 decisions). Every statistic in the sample is one the sender had answered correctly. Prior knowledge is not a regressor here because it is constant by construction. Column (1) is specification (1) restricted to alignment and its ACTION interaction, with statistic fixed effects and the full control set; column (2) replaces the controls with sender fixed effects; column (3) repeats column (2) with a binary aligned indicator, which imposes no proportional scaling in preference intensity. Standard errors clustered at the sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.15: Self-Reported Motivations and Alignment Bias

	Alignment Bias		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Intercept	0.109***	0.091***	0.094***
	(0.014)	(0.017)	(0.019)
Belief correction	−0.099***	−0.099***	−0.084***
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.022)
Expression	0.636***	0.630***	0.753***
	(0.105)	(0.105)	(0.129)
Persuasion	0.276***	0.276***	0.056
	(0.084)	(0.083)	(0.118)
Other stated reason	−0.000	0.001	0.001
	(0.129)	(0.131)	(0.130)
ACTION		0.036*	0.029
		(0.020)	(0.028)
Persuasion × ACTION			0.417***
			(0.156)
Expression × ACTION			−0.224
			(0.191)
Belief correction × ACTION			−0.022
			(0.033)
Receiver Action	No	Yes	Yes
Num. obs.	1102	1102	1102
R^2	0.099	0.102	0.115
Adj. R^2	0.096	0.098	0.109

Sample: $N = 1{,}102$ senders with a revealed directional policy preference ($AIC_i \neq 250$), Experiment 1. *Outcome:* sender-level alignment bias (mean aligned minus mean unaligned provision rate). *Regressors:* indicators for each motive the sender's open-ended decision reason was coded as citing, by `claude-sonnet-5` under frozen coding scheme v4.4 (Appendix F.1); the omitted reference is a sender whose response was coded as citing none of the listed motives. *Register:* exploratory. The reasons are unincentivized and were recorded after the provision task, so the estimates are associations between what senders said and what they did, not measurements of motives. Categories are not mutually exclusive, so the indicators are not a partition. *Belief correction* marks direction-blind truth-telling or the receiver's right to accurate information; *Expression* marks reasons citing the fact's fit with the sender's own position; *Persuasion* marks receiver-directed reasons. ACTION is the receiver political-action treatment. Column (3) interacts each coded motive with ACTION, so each channel carries its own treatment slope; *Other stated reason* is a residual category and is not interacted. The *Belief correction* indicator is affirmed for 364 senders (177 in CONTROL, 187 in ACTION), the *Expression* indicator for 12 (4 and 8), and the *Persuasion* indicator for 43 (20 and 23). Heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.16: Stated Accuracy Norms and Alignment Bias

	Correct false beliefs	Facts matter for opinions	Platforms should fact-check	Disagreement is about facts
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Alignment bias	-0.214^{***}	-0.138^{**}	-0.252^{**}	-0.090
	(0.066)	(0.064)	(0.101)	(0.090)
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
No. of Senders	1114	1114	1114	1114
R^2	0.031	0.021	0.089	0.023
Adj. R^2	0.020	0.010	0.079	0.013
Num. obs.	1114	1114	1114	1114

Notes: The sample is Experiment 1 senders with a directional policy preference. The dependent variable is agreement with one post-task statement about accurate information, on a five-point scale; column (4) is reverse-coded so that higher values indicate the pro-accuracy pole on every item. Behavior is the regressor: *Alignment bias* is the share of aligned statistics provided minus the share of unaligned statistics provided. The items were elicited after the provision task. The estimates are coherence evidence and identify no causal channel. The sender's overall provision rate is not held fixed, and the two are negatively correlated ($r = -0.423$): provision averages roughly 89%, which mechanically compresses the feasible alignment bias of a high-provision sender, so the coefficient carries the level of provision as well as the selection on alignment. All columns include demographic and political controls and treatment indicators. Heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table B.17: Self-Reported Motivations and Alignment Bias: Secondary Classifier

	Alignment Bias		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Intercept	0.112***	0.093***	0.097***
	(0.014)	(0.017)	(0.019)
Belief correction	−0.099***	−0.100***	−0.091***
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.023)
Expression	0.628***	0.620***	0.757***
	(0.092)	(0.093)	(0.113)
Persuasion	0.187***	0.187***	0.028
	(0.070)	(0.069)	(0.086)
Other stated reason	−0.045	−0.048	−0.046
	(0.053)	(0.053)	(0.053)
ACTION		0.037*	0.026
		(0.020)	(0.028)
Persuasion × ACTION			0.335**
			(0.132)
Expression × ACTION			−0.320*
			(0.189)
Belief correction × ACTION			−0.010
			(0.033)
Receiver Action	No	Yes	Yes
Num. obs.	1102	1102	1102
R^2	0.078	0.081	0.092
Adj. R^2	0.075	0.077	0.085

Sample: N = 1,102 senders with a revealed directional policy preference ($AIC_i \neq 250$), Experiment 1. *Outcome:* sender-level alignment bias (mean aligned minus mean unaligned provision rate). *Regressors:* indicators for each motive the sender's open-ended decision reason was coded as citing, from the *secondary* classifier (`gpt-5.6-terra`) applied to the same frozen prompt and the same 1,200 responses as the primary classifier of Table B.15 (Appendix F.1); the omitted reference is a sender whose response was coded as citing none of the listed motives. Categories are not mutually exclusive. ACTION is the receiver political-action treatment. Heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

C Experiment 2: Supplementary Results

C.1 Policy Views of Senders

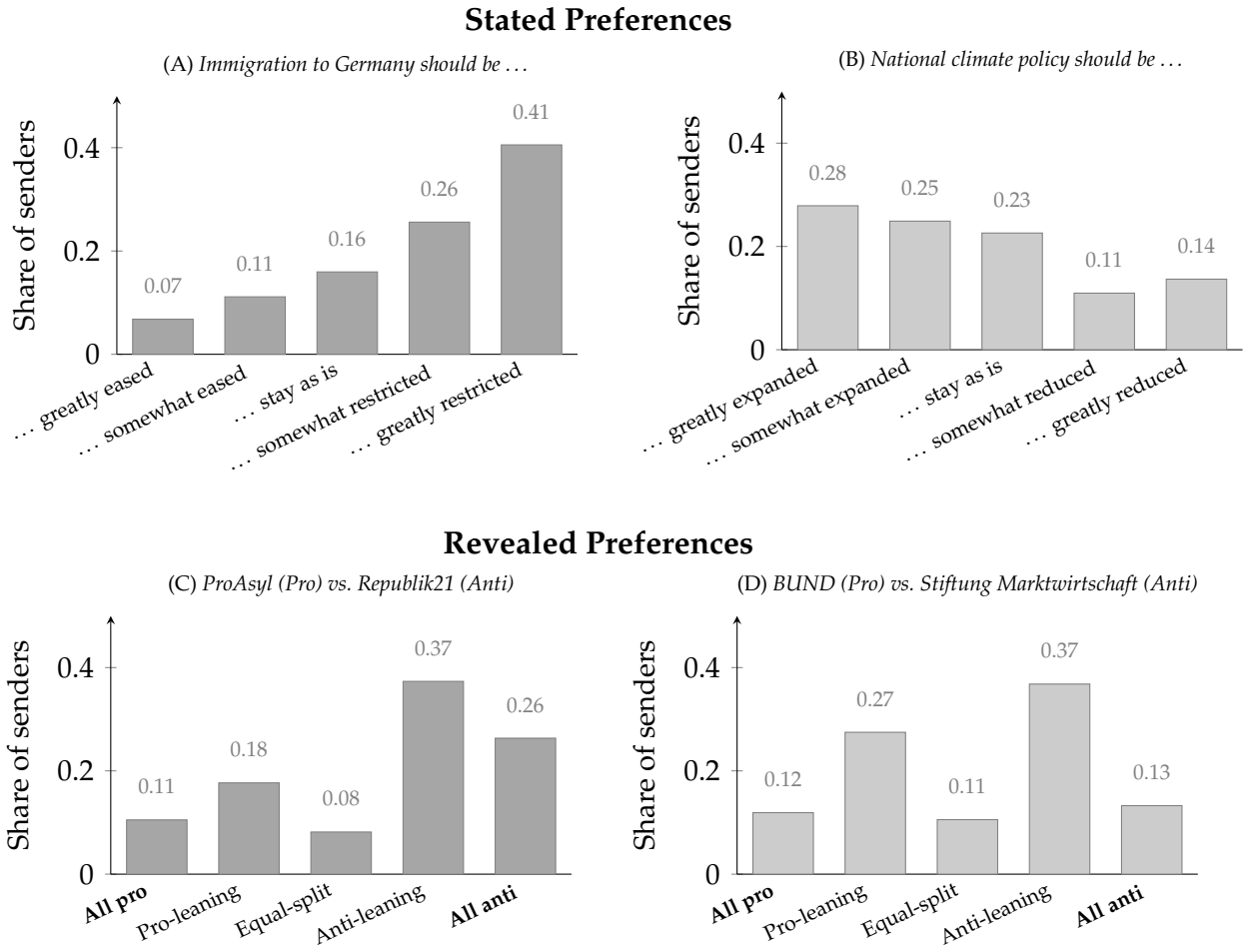


Figure C.1: Distribution of Policy Preferences Among Senders

Notes: The sample is the Experiment 2 senders (N = 1,548). The top row (Panels A–B) shows stated preferences from the 5-point Likert item; tick labels complete the stance statement shown in the panel title (e.g., *Immigration to Germany should be … greatly eased*). The bottom row (Panels C–D) shows revealed preferences from the real donation task, grouped into five buckets from All pro (€250 to the pro-policy organization) to All anti (€0), displayed pro-to-anti left to right. The left column shows immigration senders (N = 809) and the right column climate senders (N = 739).

C.2 Controls and Additional Provision Estimates

Demographic controls are omitted from columns (1) and (2) of the main-text provision table because positional alignment varies within sender and ACTION is randomized. Adding them leaves the pre-registered tests and the three-return reduced form of Table C.2 stable (Tables C.1 and C.3).

Table C.5 re-estimates the pre-registered confirmatory specification in logistic form. The positional alignment coefficient is unchanged, so selection on alignment holds within sender. The ACTION interaction is small and imprecise in all three columns.

Table C.1: Provision Decisions with Demographic Controls

	Probability of Fact Provision	
	(1)	(2)
Positional alignment	0.110***	0.128***
	(0.013)	(0.013)
ACTION	0.021*	0.023*
	(0.012)	(0.012)
Positional alignment × ACTION	0.014	0.014
	(0.017)	(0.018)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	No	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes
Num. obs.	7715	7715
R^2	0.085	0.045
Adj. R^2	0.080	0.039

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders, both treatments, with 7,715 observations with non-missing controls. The outcome is the binary provision indicator. Positional alignment is $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, +1]$. Column (1) includes sender–receiver ideological distance, age, gender, education, Bundesland, closest-party affiliation and left–right self-placement, without fact fixed effects. Column (2) is column (3) of Table 5: fact fixed effects and the pre-registered controls (age, gender, education, Bundesland, voting intention and left–right self-placement). Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.6 replaces continuous positional alignment, which imposes a gap proportional to policy view intensity, with a binary aligned indicator, which imposes a constant gap, on identical samples in all three experiments. Experiment 1's ACTION increase is $+0.064$ ($p = 0.023$) against $+0.041$ continuous, and Experiment 2's is not detectably different from zero under either measure. Bin-wise gaps do not reject the proportional form in any experiment ($p = 0.474$, 0.771 and 0.555).

Table C.7 rebuilds positional alignment from each of its two policy view measures alone. Both coefficients are smaller than the composite ($+0.100$ and $+0.102$ against $+0.128$), as expected if averaging reduces measurement noise. Across every construction the coefficient is positive and its interaction with ACTION is not detectably different from zero.

C.3 Robustness of the Motive-Channel Estimates

Table C.8 relaxes the four-determinant specification with a flexible distance profile and a freed expressive interaction with ACTION; neither moves the returns. A two-step bootstrap that rebuilds the stance–fact alignment index from resampled raters before resampling senders (500 replications) leaves inference on every coefficient unchanged. Table C.9 adds the credibility rating to the specification in both samples.

Table C.2: Provision and the Three Returns: Linear Probability Reduced Form

	Probability of Fact Provision		
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Stance–fact alignment index	0.148***	0.148***	0.138***
	(0.020)	(0.020)	(0.028)
Expected accuracy gain	0.034*	0.034*	0.053**
	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.025)
Persuasion	0.008	0.009	−0.004
	(0.007)	(0.007)	(0.009)
ACTION		0.026**	0.024
		(0.013)	(0.020)
Stance–fact alignment index × ACTION			0.020
			(0.037)
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION			−0.036
			(0.034)
Persuasion × ACTION			0.025*
			(0.013)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Num. obs.	7740	7740	7740
R^2	0.014	0.015	0.016
Adj. R^2	0.012	0.013	0.013

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. The dependent variable is the binary provision decision ($y_{ij} \in \{0,1\}$). It is the three-return linear probability reduced form, with the interaction of the stance–fact alignment index and ACTION estimated freely. Coefficients are linear-probability coefficients; the probit average marginal effects of the three-return form agree with them to within 0.001, and Table 6, Panel B, reports the four-determinant average marginal effects. Column (1) regresses provision on the stance–fact alignment index and the two elicited returns. Column (2) adds the ACTION main effect. Column (3) interacts each return with ACTION. Main effects are pooled across treatments in columns (1) and (2) and are CONTROL-treatment slopes in column (3). All columns include fact fixed effects; standard errors are clustered at the sender level (in parentheses). A joint test of the three interactions does not reject ($\chi^2 = 4.87$, $p = 0.18$). $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Inference on the persuasion interaction. The interaction of ACTION with the persuasion return is marginal throughout. Logit gives one-sided $p = 0.036$, and fact-level dependence is the least favorable case (Table C.11; wild-cluster bootstrap over the twelve facts, two-sided $p = 0.118$). On the three-return linear form, randomization inference over sender-level reassignment gives one-sided $p = 0.024$, and the interaction is positive in all 84 non-redundant specifications, 1 percent of them significant at conventional two-sided levels. It stays positive when $\Delta\pi_{ijk}$ is winsorized at the ninetieth percentile and when senders with small returns, senders who provide every fact, or the least aligned facts are dropped; keeping only the sign of $\Delta\pi_{ijk}$ gives -0.005. Sender fixed effects attenuate it from $+0.023$ to $+0.013$. Table C.14 drops each fact in turn; no determinant changes sign.

Table C.3: Three-Return Reduced Form with Demographic Controls

	Probability of Fact Provision	
	(1)	(2)
Stance–fact alignment index	0.138***	0.139***
	(0.028)	(0.028)
Expected accuracy gain	0.053**	0.066***
	(0.025)	(0.024)
Persuasion	−0.004	−0.003
	(0.009)	(0.009)
ACTION	0.024	0.021
	(0.020)	(0.020)
Stance–fact alignment index × ACTION	0.020	0.023
	(0.037)	(0.037)
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION	−0.036	−0.046
	(0.034)	(0.034)
Persuasion × ACTION	0.025*	0.023*
	(0.013)	(0.013)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	Yes	Yes
Controls	No	Yes
Num. obs.	7740	7715
R^2	0.016	0.029
Adj. R^2	0.013	0.022

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders, both treatments; column (1) has 7,740 observations and column (2) 7,715 with non-missing controls. The outcome is the binary provision indicator. The stance–fact alignment index is the cross-domain behavioral rating $\alpha_{ij} \in [-1, +1]$. Persuasion is the incentivized expected movement of the receiver toward the sender's position $\Delta\pi_{ijk}$ (positional reading). Expected accuracy gain is the incentivized expected correction of the receiver's factual belief $\Delta b_{ijk} \in [-1, 1]$. Column (1) reproduces the three-return reduced form of Table C.2; column (2) adds demographic controls (age, gender, education, Bundesland, closest-party affiliation, left-right self-placement). Sender-receiver ideological distance is excluded as a heterogeneity variable. All specifications include fact fixed effects. Standard errors clustered at sender level. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Sample definition. Table C.12 compares the sample with population benchmarks and across treatments. Table C.13 adds back the speeders and the early starts of Appendix A.6, and drops the three quality-check groups the pre-registration retains, none of which differs across treatments. No sign changes; the persuasion interaction attenuates as speeders and early starts are added back (one-sided p up to 0.119).

C.4 Heterogeneity

Tables C.15 and C.16 report the pre-registered heterogeneity analyses: positional alignment and ACTION in the linear-probability battery, and the motive channels in the four-determinant index. Of the twenty interaction terms in the distance, polarization

Table C.4: Motive Channels with Positional Alignment Substituted for the Stance–Fact Alignment Index

	Probability of Fact Provision			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Stance–fact alignment index	0.490***		0.448***	
	(0.053)		(0.073)	
Positional alignment		0.365***		0.339***
		(0.027)		(0.036)
Expected accuracy gain	0.131*	0.129*	0.130*	0.128*
	(0.069)	(0.070)	(0.069)	(0.070)
Persuasion	0.030	0.025	0.032	0.027
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)
Political distance	−0.250***	−0.240***	−0.250***	−0.240***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)
ACTION	0.081**	0.078**	0.052	0.080**
	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.054)	(0.040)
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION	−0.086	−0.074	−0.085	−0.072
	(0.096)	(0.097)	(0.096)	(0.097)
Persuasion × ACTION	0.061*	0.062*	0.058*	0.059*
	(0.035)	(0.035)	(0.035)	(0.035)
Stance–fact alignment index × ACTION			0.082	
			(0.101)	
Positional alignment × ACTION				0.053
				(0.049)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Distance form	Linear	Linear	Linear	Linear
Alignment measure	Index	Positional	Index	Positional
Alignment measure × ACTION	Restricted	Restricted	Freed	Freed
Num. obs.	7740	7740	7740	7740
Pseudo R^2	0.049	0.060	0.049	0.059

Notes: The sample is the N = 1,548 Experiment 2 senders (Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026), 7,740 sender–fact observations. The estimator is a probit; coefficients are index coefficients, matching the four-determinant specification of Table 6. The outcome is a binary provision indicator. The four-determinant specification is estimated twice: once with the stance–fact alignment index α_{ij}, assigned from cross-domain raters' validation judgments, and once with positional alignment $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, +1]$, the pre-registered confirmatory measure, in its place. Columns (1)–(2) set the interactions of ACTION with the alignment measure of that column and with distance to zero, which maintains Assumption 3(ii)–(iii) together with a common scale across treatments (Assumption 4(ii)); columns (3)–(4) free the interaction of ACTION with the alignment measure. All specifications include linear political distance, fact fixed effects and sender-clustered standard errors. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

and party-group analyses, nine fall below $p = 0.10$ against two expected under the null, and none survives Benjamini–Hochberg control (smallest $q = 0.17$). In the family of twenty-seven terms that adds issue extremity, $|\text{stance} - 3|$, one survives ($q = 0.01$): per unit of the stance–fact alignment index, provision rises by 0.30 for senders at either end of the scale, against 0.10 and 0.12 at the other two levels. Positional alignment does not vary with issue extremity ($p = 0.499$).

Provision falls by 9.4 pp per Likert unit of sender–receiver distance ($p < 0.001$), and by 9.0 pp within sender, a slope that does not vary with sender extremity ($p = 0.906$). The positional alignment slope does not vary with distance (+0.001), polarization (+0.007) or party group. Supporters of extreme parties and non-affiliates provide 4.5 and 9.3 pp less than center voters. By topic, the persuasion interaction with AC-

	(1) Linear probability (pre-registered)	(2) Logit (scaled logit)	(3) Sender fixed effects
Positional alignment (Hyp. 2.1)	0.128***	0.125***	0.129***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)
Positional alignment × ACTION (Hyp. 2.2)	0.014	0.018	0.005
	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Sender fixed effects	No	No	Yes
Demographic controls	Yes	Yes	Absorbed
Senders	1,543	1,543	1,543
Observations	7,715	7,715	7,715

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. The dependent variable is the binary provision decision ($y_{ij} \in \{0,1\}$). All three columns estimate the pre-registered confirmatory specification—provision on positional alignment, ACTION, and their interaction—on the same estimation sample. Column (1) reproduces column (3) of Table 5. Column (2) is the pre-registered logistic specification, reported as coefficients scaled by the sample mean of $p(1-p)$, so that magnitudes are comparable with the linear columns. Column (3) adds sender fixed effects, so the positional alignment coefficient is identified only from each sender's own comparisons across facts; the ACTION main effect is absorbed, and the demographic controls with it. Standard errors clustered at the sender level (in parentheses). $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.5: Specification Robustness of the Treatment Effects

Table C.6: Positional Alignment Measured Continuously and as a Binary Indicator

	Experiment 1		Experiment 2		Experiment 3	
	Continuous (per unit) (1)	Binary (gap) (2)	Continuous (per unit) (3)	Binary (gap) (4)	Continuous (per unit) (5)	Binary (gap) (6)
Positional alignment	+0.037***	+0.050***	+0.128***	+0.122***	+0.129***	+0.170***
	(0.012)	(0.019)	(0.013)	(0.017)	(0.020)	(0.029)
Positional alignment × ACTION	+0.041**	+0.064**	+0.014	+0.025	—	—
	(0.018)	(0.028)	(0.018)	(0.023)		
Observations	4,456	4,456	7,455	7,455	1,490	1,490
Fact/topic FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: The models are linear probability models, and the dependent variable is provision. Controls are prior knowledge (Experiment 1); the pre-registered demographic and political controls (Experiment 2); and the pre-registered journalist controls of Table 7, column (3) (Experiment 3). Continuous positional alignment is $\text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1,+1]$; the binary indicator is $\mathbf{1}(\text{Align}_{ij} > 0)$. Observations with $\text{Align}_{ij} = 0$ are excluded from both columns of each pair rather than classified as unaligned, so the two specifications are estimated on identical samples. A continuous coefficient is a per-unit slope; the implied aligned–unaligned gap is twice the coefficient times the sender's preference intensity. A binary coefficient is that gap directly. Experiment 1 retains the INFO treatment structure of Table 3. Experiment 3 is a single-condition journalist sample with no randomised ACTION treatment, so no interaction is estimable. Standard errors clustered at the sender level in parentheses. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

TION is +0.095 in immigration ($p = 0.043$) and +0.024 in climate ($p = 0.644$); the two do not detectably differ ($p = 0.302$).

C.5 The Elicited Returns

Figure C.2 shows the distributions of the two elicited returns. The expected accuracy gain is flat in sender–receiver distance ($p = 0.419$) and negative for a quarter of fact–receiver pairs. The expected persuasion return is about zero at distance zero and, from distance 2 onward, closes a near-constant share of the sender–receiver gap (5.6, 5.8 and 5.9 percent at distances 2, 3 and 4; equality $p = 0.981$); the rise persists among receivers at interior stances, where the bounded scale does not force it. A directional analog, the predicted change in the receiver's stance signed toward the sender's side, correlates

Table C.7: Provision and Positional Alignment Under Alternative Preference Measures

	(1) Composite (registered)	(2) Revealed only	(3) Stated only	(4) Excluding zero index	(5) Excluding offsetting
Positional alignment	$+0.128^{***}$	$+0.100^{***}$	$+0.102^{***}$	$+0.128^{***}$	$+0.129^{***}$
	(0.013)	(0.012)	(0.012)	(0.013)	(0.013)
Positional alignment × ACTION	+0.014	+0.009	+0.009	+0.014	+0.014
	(0.018)	(0.017)	(0.016)	(0.018)	(0.018)
Observations	7,715	7,715	7,715	7,455	7,650
Senders	1,548	1,548	1,548	1,496	1,535
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. Linear probability models of provision on positional alignment, its interaction with ACTION, and the pre-specified controls (age, gender, education, state, vote intention, left–right placement), with fact fixed effects and standard errors clustered at the sender level. Column (1) is the pre-registered specification, in which the sender's policy preference is the average of the revealed measure from the €250 donation split and the stated measure from the five-point stance item. Columns (2) and (3) rebuild alignment from each component alone. Column (4) drops the 52 senders whose composite preference is exactly zero; column (5) drops only the 13 of those who state a position at one pole of the scale and donate against it. Stars denote two-sided significance: $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table C.8: The Four-Determinant Specification Under Relaxations: Distance Functional Form and the Expressive Interaction

	Four-determinant	Flexible distance	Freed expressive interaction
Stance–fact alignment index	0.490^{***}	0.481^{***}	0.448^{***}
	(0.053)	(0.053)	(0.073)
Expected accuracy gain	0.131^{*}	0.128^{*}	0.130^{*}
	(0.069)	(0.069)	(0.069)
Persuasion	0.030	0.033	0.032
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)
Political distance	-0.250^{***}		-0.250^{***}
	(0.013)		(0.013)
ACTION	0.081^{**}	0.081^{**}	0.052
	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.054)
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION	−0.086	−0.084	−0.085
	(0.096)	(0.096)	(0.096)
Persuasion × ACTION	0.061^{*}	0.060^{*}	0.058^{*}
	(0.035)	(0.035)	(0.035)
Stance–fact alignment index × ACTION			0.082
			(0.101)
Distance form	Linear	Indicators	Linear
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Senders	1,548	1,548	1,548
Observations	7,740	7,740	7,740

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. Column (1) is column (3) of Table 6, the four-determinant specification: linear distance, the interactions of ACTION with the expressive return and with distance restricted to zero. Column (2) replaces linear distance with distance indicators; a likelihood-ratio test favors the flexible form ($\chi^2(3) = 20.5$, $p < 0.001$). Column (3) frees the expressive interaction with ACTION; a likelihood-ratio test does not reject the restriction ($\chi^2(1) = 0.724$, $p = 0.395$). The freed interaction tests equality of index coefficients across treatments. Same sample, estimator, fixed effects, and clustering as Table 6. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.9: Alignment Measures and the Credibility Rating

	General population (Experiment 2)				Journalists (Experiment 3)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Stance–fact alignment index	0.490***	0.253***			0.466***	0.192		
	(0.053)	(0.076)			(0.151)	(0.218)		
Positional alignment			0.365***	0.331***			0.421***	0.393***
			(0.027)	(0.037)			(0.070)	(0.078)
Credibility rating		0.898***		0.264		0.937*		0.236
		(0.191)		(0.184)		(0.478)		(0.374)
Expected accuracy gain	0.131*	0.126*	0.129*	0.128*	0.299**	0.300**	0.345***	0.340**
	(0.069)	(0.069)	(0.070)	(0.070)	(0.135)	(0.133)	(0.133)	(0.133)
Expected persuasion	0.030	0.031	0.025	0.025	0.137***	0.135***	0.092*	0.093*
	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.050)	(0.050)	(0.050)	(0.050)
Political distance	−0.250***	−0.246***	−0.240***	−0.240***	−0.218***	−0.221***	−0.208***	−0.209***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.032)	(0.032)	(0.032)	(0.032)
ACTION	0.081**	0.084**	0.078**	0.080**				
	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.040)				
Expected accuracy gain × ACTION	−0.086	−0.084	−0.074	−0.074				
	(0.096)	(0.097)	(0.097)	(0.097)				
Expected persuasion × ACTION	0.061*	0.058*	0.062*	0.061*				
	(0.035)	(0.035)	(0.035)	(0.035)				
Fact fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Senders	1,548	1,548	1,548	1,548	309	309	309	309
Observations	7,740	7,740	7,740	7,740	1,545	1,545	1,545	1,545

Notes: Probit estimates of the four-determinant specification: column (1) is column (3) of Table 6 and column (5) is column (1) of Table 8. Columns (2) and (6) add the credibility rating, the share of senders at the same stance who rate the fact convinced to be true, from the same cross-domain rating task and page as the stance–fact alignment index. Columns (3)–(4) and (7)–(8) measure expression by positional alignment, built from the sender's own donation and stated position. Standard errors clustered by sender in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.10: Within-Treatment Ratios to the Stance–Fact Alignment Index Coefficient

	Ratio to the stance–fact alignment index coefficient		
	CONTROL	ACTION	Difference
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Persuasion	0.075	0.171	0.095
	[-0.032, 0.205]	[0.062, 0.306]	[-0.065, 0.258]
Expected accuracy gain	0.277	0.094	−0.183
	[0.009, 0.603]	[-0.154, 0.384]	[-0.577, 0.247]
Political distance	−0.592	−0.441	0.151
	[-0.883, -0.433]	[-0.608, -0.331]	[-0.083, 0.447]

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders (Table 6). Each entry is the ratio of a determinant's probit index coefficient to the stance–fact alignment index coefficient, estimated separately in each treatment, so that each treatment's latent scale cancels (Corollary 1(ii)). Column (3) is the difference between treatments. Brackets are 95% percentile intervals from 1,000 sender-cluster bootstrap replications. The ratios of the two returns carry the units of the elicited measures, and the intervals do not reflect sampling error in the alignment index (Appendix C.3).

with $\Delta\pi_{ijk}$ at $r = 0.740$ within fact and gives the same sign of the ACTION interaction (one-sided $p = 0.050$). The stance–fact alignment index varies within sender: a sender's highest and lowest cell values differ by 0.68 on average, and it separates the two fact directions at every stance, including the midpoint (+0.13 against +0.44).

Table C.11: Inference Robustness: Clustering and Wild Bootstrap

	(1) Sender SE	(2) Two-way SE (Sender + Fact)
Stance–fact alignment index	0.173^{***}	0.173^{***}
	(0.019)	(0.016)
Expected accuracy gain	0.030^{*}	0.030
	(0.017)	(0.019)
Persuasion	0.011	0.011
	(0.009)	(0.009)
Political distance	-0.090^{***}	-0.090^{***}
	(0.005)	(0.005)
Persuasion × ACTION	0.022^{*}	0.022
	(0.012)	(0.014)
ACTION	0.024^{*}	0.024^{*}
	(0.013)	(0.012)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender + Fact
Fact FE	Yes	Yes
Wild bootstrap p (fact, exact 2^{12})	—	0.118
Num. obs.	7,740	7,740

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders, with 7,740 sender-fact observations. Both columns are linear probability models, because the wild bootstrap imposes the null through a continuous pseudo-outcome. Both columns estimate the four-determinant specification (*Stance–fact alignment index*, *Expected accuracy gain*, *Persuasion*, *Political distance*, *Persuasion* × ACTION, ACTION) with fact fixed effects. Column (1): standard errors clustered at the sender level. Column (2): two-way clustering by sender and fact (Cameron–Gelbach–Miller; $K = 12$ fact clusters, asymptotic standard errors indicative only). The wild bootstrap is an exact enumeration of all $2^{12} = 4{,}096$ Rademacher sign patterns at the fact level (impose-null variant), and reports the p-value for *Persuasion* × ACTION. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.12: Sample Characteristics and Population Benchmarks

	Population (1)	Sample (2)	CONTROL (3)	ACTION (4)
Gender				
Female	0.499	0.481	0.501	0.462
Male	0.501	0.517	0.497	0.536
Diverse	—	0.003	0.003	0.003
Age band				
18–29	0.179	0.197	0.199	0.195
30–39	0.178	0.176	0.177	0.175
40–49	0.170	0.160	0.150	0.169
50–59	0.193	0.200	0.188	0.212
60–75	0.279	0.267	0.286	0.248
Bundesland				
Baden-Württemberg	0.134	0.129	0.135	0.122
Bayern	0.159	0.156	0.144	0.166
Berlin	0.045	0.042	0.040	0.044
Brandenburg	0.030	0.032	0.036	0.029
Bremen	0.008	0.010	0.011	0.010
Hamburg	0.023	0.023	0.021	0.024
Hessen	0.075	0.072	0.068	0.076
Mecklenburg-Vorpommern	0.019	0.023	0.023	0.024
Niedersachsen	0.095	0.099	0.102	0.096
Nordrhein-Westfalen	0.216	0.215	0.204	0.226
Rheinland-Pfalz	0.050	0.050	0.046	0.054
Saarland	0.012	0.010	0.016	0.005
Sachsen	0.047	0.048	0.050	0.047
Sachsen-Anhalt	0.025	0.032	0.029	0.034
Schleswig-Holstein	0.035	0.031	0.041	0.021
Thüringen	0.025	0.028	0.034	0.021
School-leaving qualification				
Hauptschulabschluss or none	0.297	0.265	0.277	0.253
Mittlerer Abschluss (Realschule)	0.314	0.293	0.270	0.315
Fachhochschul-/Hochschulreife or higher	0.390	0.442	0.453	0.431

Notes: The Experiment 2 sample is $N = 1{,}548$ German adults recruited on Bilendi (quota-sampled). Column (1) reports German population proportions. For gender, age band, and Bundesland, the benchmark is the population aged 18–75 as of 31 December 2024 (Bevölkerungsfortschreibung on the Zensus-2022 basis; Statistisches Bundesamt, Statistischer Bericht 12411, tables 12411-06 and 12411-09). No registry benchmark exists for "Diverse." For school-leaving qualification, the benchmark is the Mikrozensus 2023 (Statistisches Bundesamt, Bildungsstand der Bevölkerung), persons aged 15 and over excluding those still in school—a broader base than the sample's 18–75. Column (2) reports full-sample proportions. Columns (3)–(4) report proportions by treatment.

	Sample additions				Quality-check exclusions		
	Canonical	+ Speeders	+ Early starts	+ Both	Attention failers	Any tab switching	Comprehension attempts > 2
Positional alignment (Hyp. 2.1)	0.128^{***}	0.131^{***}	0.123^{***}	0.125^{***}	0.135^{***}	0.132^{***}	0.147^{***}
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.012)	(0.015)	(0.014)	(0.018)
Positional alignment $\times$ ACTION (Hyp. 2.2)	0.014	0.012	0.015	0.013	0.007	0.006	0.007
	(0.018)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.020)	(0.019)	(0.023)
Stance–fact alignment index (α_{ij})	0.489^{***}	0.483^{***}	0.477^{***}	0.472^{***}	0.551^{***}	0.523^{***}	0.462^{***}
	(0.053)	(0.052)	(0.050)	(0.049)	(0.061)	(0.057)	(0.071)
Expected accuracy gain (Δb_{ijk})	0.086^{*}	0.076	0.087^{*}	0.077^{*}	0.136^{**}	0.082	0.058
	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.047)	(0.046)	(0.057)	(0.054)	(0.064)
Persuasion ($\Delta \pi_{ijk}$)	0.061^{***}	0.061^{***}	0.055^{***}	0.056^{***}	0.081^{***}	0.053^{***}	0.072^{***}
	(0.018)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.021)	(0.020)	(0.025)
Persuasion $\times$ ACTION	0.060^{*}	0.054	0.044	0.039	0.071^{*}	0.033	0.095^{**}
	(0.035)	(0.034)	(0.034)	(0.033)	(0.041)	(0.038)	(0.048)
Senders	1548	1588	1654	1694	1156	1277	860
Observations (confirmatory)	7715	7910	8245	8440	5760	6365	4285
Observations (motive specifications)	7740	7940	8270	8470	5780	6385	4300

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders under alternative sample definitions, and the dependent variable is the binary provision decision ($y_{ij} \in \{0, 1\}$). Canonical: the main analysis sample (no speeders, no pre-launch starts). + Speeders: adds completers faster than $0.25\times$ the median completion time. + Early starts: adds participants who started before the revised instrument went live on 27 May 2026, at 09:00 UTC (Appendix A.6). + Both: adds both groups. Columns (5)–(7) drop, in turn, the three groups the pre-registration retains in the primary analysis and names for robustness: senders failing the attention check (administered in Experiment 2 only), senders who switched a browser tab at any point, and senders needing more than two attempts at the comprehension checks. None of the three differs across treatments (all $p > 0.30$). The table reports two estimators, each matching the specification it belongs to. Rows (1)–(2) are the pre-registered confirmatory specification and are estimated by linear probability, which is the form the pre-registration names: provision on positional alignment, ACTION, their interaction, demographic controls (age, gender, education, Bundesland, voting intention, left–right), and fact fixed effects. Rows (3)–(6) are the motive specification of Table 6 and are *probit index coefficients*, which carry Proposition 2 under Assumptions 3 and 4(ii) (Corollary 1(i)); rows (3)–(5) enter the stance–fact alignment index, the two elicited returns and political distance with fact fixed effects and row (6) adds the Persuasion $\times$ ACTION interaction to that specification. Rows (3)–(6) report index coefficients; rows (1)–(2) report linear-probability coefficients. The two observation rows differ because the confirmatory specification drops observations with missing demographic controls (25 observations from five senders in the canonical column). Standard errors clustered at the sender level (in parentheses). $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.13: Sample-Inclusion Robustness of the Estimates

Table C.14: Leave-One-Fact-Out Robustness of the Motive Channels

Determinant	Sign-positive	Min β	Max β	Max p
Stance–fact alignment index	12/12	0.471	0.511	0.000
Expected accuracy gain	12/12	0.057	0.108	0.262
Persuasion	12/12	0.052	0.070	0.005
Political distance	0/12	-0.257	-0.245	0.000
Fact FE		Yes		
Clustered SE		Sender		

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. Each determinant is re-estimated twelve times in the four-determinant specification of column (1) of Table 6 (*Stance–fact alignment index*, *Expected accuracy gain*, *Persuasion*, *Political distance*), each time dropping one of the twelve facts; fact fixed effects, sender-clustered standard errors. Coefficients are *probit index* coefficients and are not probability-scale effects. Columns report the number of leave-one-out estimates with a positive coefficient, the minimum and maximum coefficient across the twelve runs, and the largest p-value observed.

Table C.15: Heterogeneity by Sender Profile: Positional Alignment and ACTION

	Probability of Fact Provision				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Moderator	Distance	polarization	Pol. group		
Topic	Pooled	Pooled	Pooled	Immigration	Climate
Positional alignment	0.119***	0.115***	0.124***	0.119***	0.143***
	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.021)	(0.017)	(0.020)
ACTION	−0.006	0.040**	0.004	0.026	0.026
	(0.017)	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.017)
Positional alignment × ACTION	−0.018	0.002	0.008	0.050**	−0.042
	(0.027)	(0.026)	(0.028)	(0.022)	(0.029)
Receiver distance	−0.094***				
	(0.007)				
Positional alignment × Distance	0.001				
	(0.008)				
ACTION × Distance	0.019**				
	(0.009)				
Positional alignment × ACTION × Distance	0.020*				
	(0.012)				
Sender polarization		0.010*			
		(0.006)			
Positional alignment × Polarization		0.007			
		(0.009)			
ACTION × Polarization		−0.010			
		(0.009)			
Positional alignment × ACTION × Polarization		0.007			
		(0.012)			
Extremes (ref: center)			−0.045**		
			(0.020)		
Others (ref: center)			−0.093***		
			(0.026)		
Positional alignment × Extremes			0.001		
			(0.028)		
Positional alignment × Others			0.024		
			(0.040)		
ACTION × Extremes			0.024		
			(0.027)		
ACTION × Others			0.067*		
			(0.037)		
Positional alignment × ACTION × Extremes			0.016		
			(0.038)		
Positional alignment × ACTION × Others			−0.007		
			(0.052)		
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Moderator	Distance	Polarization	Pol. group	—	—
Topic	Pooled	Pooled	Pooled	Immigration	Climate
Spec	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Num. obs.	7740	7740	7715	4045	3695
R^2	0.079	0.033	0.035	0.035	0.030
Adj. R^2	0.077	0.030	0.032	0.033	0.028

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders (Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026). Columns (1)–(2) use 7,740 sender-fact observations. Column (3) uses 7,715 (non-missing political group). Columns (4)–(5) are topic subsamples (immigration: $N = 809$ senders; climate: $N = 739$ senders). The outcome is a binary provision indicator. Positional alignment is $\text{Align}_{ij} = \text{Pref}_i \times \text{Dir}_j \in [-1, 1]$ (pre-registered confirmatory measure). Receiver distance is $|\text{sender_likert} - \text{recv_stance}| \in \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$. Sender polarization is the absolute left-right distance from center. For political group, Extremes = AfD, Linke, BSW; Others = other/no vote; Center = CDU/CSU, SPD, Grüne, FDP (reference). Columns (1)–(3) include the moderator and all interactions; columns (4)–(5) are subsample estimates with no moderator. All specifications include fact fixed effects and sender-clustered standard errors. For multiple testing, the exploratory heterogeneity family spans twenty interaction terms across this table and Table C.16; Benjamini–Hochberg-adjusted q-values within that family are between 0.17 and 0.21 for every interaction significant at raw $p < 0.10$. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table C.16: Heterogeneity by Sender Profile: Motive Channels

	Probability of Fact Provision		
	(1) Distance	(2) Polarization	(3) Political group
Stance–fact alignment index	0.525***	0.429***	0.465***
	(0.083)	(0.074)	(0.080)
Persuasion	0.045	−0.010	−0.018
	(0.045)	(0.033)	(0.037)
ACTION	−0.017	0.102**	0.002
	(0.055)	(0.050)	(0.054)
Persuasion × ACTION	−0.048	0.072	0.136***
	(0.062)	(0.048)	(0.052)
Receiver distance	−0.265***	−0.251***	−0.249***
	(0.025)	(0.013)	(0.013)
Stance–fact alignment index × Distance	−0.023		
	(0.042)		
Persuasion × Distance	−0.005		
	(0.019)		
ACTION × Distance	0.046*		
	(0.027)		
Persuasion × ACTION × Distance	0.049*		
	(0.026)		
Sender polarization		0.023	
		(0.023)	
Stance–fact alignment index × Polarization		0.041	
		(0.036)	
Persuasion × Polarization		0.028*	
		(0.017)	
ACTION × Polarization		−0.025	
		(0.025)	
Persuasion × ACTION × Polarization		−0.010	
		(0.023)	
Extremes (ref: center)			−0.156**
			(0.072)
Others (ref: center)			−0.274***
			(0.087)
Stance–fact alignment index × Extremes			0.087
			(0.117)
Stance–fact alignment index × Others			0.030
			(0.142)
Persuasion × Extremes			0.063
			(0.053)
Persuasion × Others			0.111*
			(0.067)
ACTION × Extremes			0.076
			(0.078)
ACTION × Others			0.182*
			(0.103)
Persuasion × ACTION × Extremes			−0.104
			(0.075)
Persuasion × ACTION × Others			−0.179*
			(0.103)
Clustered SE	Sender	Sender	Sender
Fact FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Moderator	Distance	Polarization	Political group
Spec	(1)	(2)	(3)
Num. obs.	7740	7740	7715
Deviance	9580.042	9575.748	9531.625
Log Likelihood	−4790.021	−4787.874	−4765.812
Pseudo R^2	0.050	0.050	0.050

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}548$ Experiment 2 general-population senders (Bilendi panel, Germany, 2026); 7,740 sender-fact observations in columns (1)–(2), 7,715 in column (3) (non-missing political group). The estimator is probit; coefficients are index coefficients from the four-determinant specification of Table 6, extended with the moderator and its interactions, and are on the probit index scale (Corollary 1). The outcome is a binary provision indicator. The stance–fact alignment index is the cross-domain behavioral rating α_{ij}, assigned from validation judgments elicited post-provision on a different topic. Persuasion is the incentivized expected preference shift $\Delta\pi_{ijk}$ toward the sender's position. Receiver distance is $|\text{sender_likert} - \text{recv_stance}| \in \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$. Sender polarization is the absolute left-right distance from center. Political group has Extremes = AfD, Linke, BSW; Others = other/no vote; Center = CDU/CSU, SPD, Grüne, FDP (reference). All specifications include fact fixed effects and sender-clustered standard errors. For multiple testing, the exploratory heterogeneity family spans twenty interaction terms across this table and Table C.15; Benjamini–Hochberg-adjusted q-values within that family are between 0.17 and 0.21 for every interaction significant at raw $p < 0.10$. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

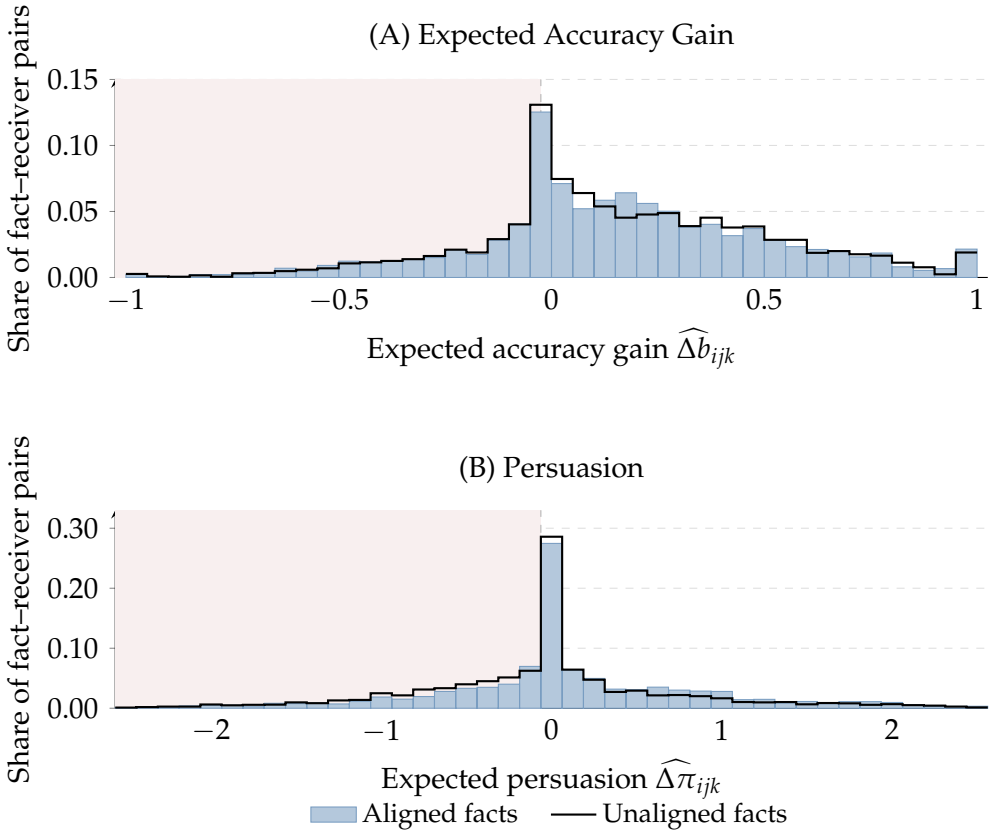


Figure C.2: Elicited Returns to Disclosure

Notes: The sample is Experiment 2's general-population senders. The figure shows distributions of the two incentivized elicitations for positionally aligned facts ($\text{Align}_{ij} > 0$; bars) and unaligned facts ($\text{Align}_{ij} < 0$; black outline), as shares within each group; observations of senders with $\text{Pref}_i = 0$ (260 of 7,740) are omitted from the split. Panel (A) shows expected accuracy gain $\widehat{\Delta b}_{ijk}$ (0.05-unit bins; group means 0.173 aligned, 0.175 unaligned). Panel (B) shows expected persuasion $\widehat{\Delta\pi}_{ijk}$ (0.125-unit bins; the bin at $[-0.125, 0)$ contains exact-zero predictions; group means $+0.110$ aligned, -0.016 unaligned). Shaded regions mark negative values (disclosure expected to move the receiver's factual belief away from the truth, respectively the receiver away from the sender's position). Elicitations are incentivized via Quadratic Scoring Rule.

D Experiment 3: Supplementary Results

D.1 Sample Composition

Table D.1 compares the demographic and occupational characteristics of the Experiment 3 journalist sample to Loosen et al. (2023), the most recent representative survey of the German journalist population. The post-questionnaire collected gender, age, education, medium type, conditional broadcaster affiliation, geographic reach, role (multiple selection), and editorial autonomy. Fields not elicited in Experiment 3—years of experience, full-time versus freelance status, and topics covered—cannot be compared to the benchmark.

Figure D.1 reports the stated and revealed policy view distributions of the journalist sample, by topic, on the axes and bucket definitions of Figure C.1 for the Experiment 2 general-population sample.

D.2 Robustness of the Alignment Gap

The journalist alignment gap of Section 5.2.3 does not depend on the linear model. Across the 299 journalists who see at least one aligned and one unaligned fact, the mean within-journalist gap is +20.4 pp (one-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank $p < 0.001$), and the pre-registered logit gives average marginal effects within 0.002 of the linear ones. The registered alignment coefficient stays positive (one-sided $p < 0.001$) when journalists who needed more than two comprehension attempts or switched tabs are excluded, when the 123 whom either research assistant coded as naming the research question are excluded (Appendix Table G.3), and when each fact is dropped in turn (0.117 to 0.141).

D.3 Targeting

Let $\text{dirR}_{ij} = \text{Dir}_j \times (\text{Stance}_{ij}^{R} - 3)$ be the persuasive room the random assignment of facts to receivers creates, positive when the fact cuts against the receiver's position. Per unit, it raises the expected persuasion return by 0.100 among journalists and 0.015 in the general population's ACTION treatment. With sender and fact fixed effects and a control for political distance, journalists' provision rises by 2.0 pp per unit in immigration and 2.4 pp in climate (one-sided $p = 0.030$ and 0.020); the general population's shows no detectable response ($p = 0.942$).

Table D.1: Journalist Sample Characteristics: Comparison to Population Benchmark

	Experiment 3 ($N = 309$)	Loosen et al. (2023) ($N = 1{,}221$)
Gender		
Female	53.1	44.0
Male	45.0	55.9
Age		
Under 50	76.7	62.4
Education		
University degree (B.A.+)	84.7	67.1
Medium type		
Print	28.2	57.0
Online	45.8	3.1
Television	7.1	17.3
Radio/podcast	10.7	17.2
News agency	3.6	3.5
Broadcaster type (TV/radio respondents only)		
Public broadcaster	80.0	61.4
Role (multiple selection; shares exceed 100 %)		
Editor	57.5	—
Editorial autonomy		
High ($\geq 4/5$)	76.3	62.0
Political affiliation (no population benchmark)		
Grüne or Linke (closest party)	58.1	—
Mean left-right self-placement (0–10)	3.2	—

Notes: The Experiment 3 sample is $N = 309$ professional German journalists recruited via DJV and DJU mailing lists (convenience sample). The benchmark is Loosen et al. (2023), a stratified random sample of active German journalists ($N = 1{,}221$, September 2022–February 2023, HBI Hamburg; Loosen et al.). All figures are percentages. For medium type, Experiment 3 uses a single online category for all digital-native outlets; the Loosen et al. benchmark reports native-online journalists (3.1%) as a distinct population segment; print aggregates newspapers and magazines (57.0%). Broadcaster type is conditional on TV or radio respondents only. Role allows multiple selection; Loosen et al. report no breakdown by editorial position, so this row appears without a benchmark. Editorial autonomy is not a common item: Experiment 3 asks how often the respondent can decide which topics to work on (1 = never to 5 = very often), while Loosen et al. report the share describing themselves as very or completely free in topic selection. For age, Loosen et al. report a population mean of 45.3 years; Experiment 3 elicited age as a categorical variable. Political affiliation and left-right self-placement were not elicited in Loosen et al. and appear without a benchmark.

D.4 Heterogeneity and Stated Motives

Table D.2 reports the pre-registered exploratory heterogeneity among journalists. Table D.3 relates each journalist's alignment bias to the motives their post-task account was classified as citing, in the specification of Table B.15; the two experiments are coded under different versions of the scheme (Appendix F.1), so signs are comparable and magnitudes are not. Table D.4 reports, within each sample, the ratio of each determi-

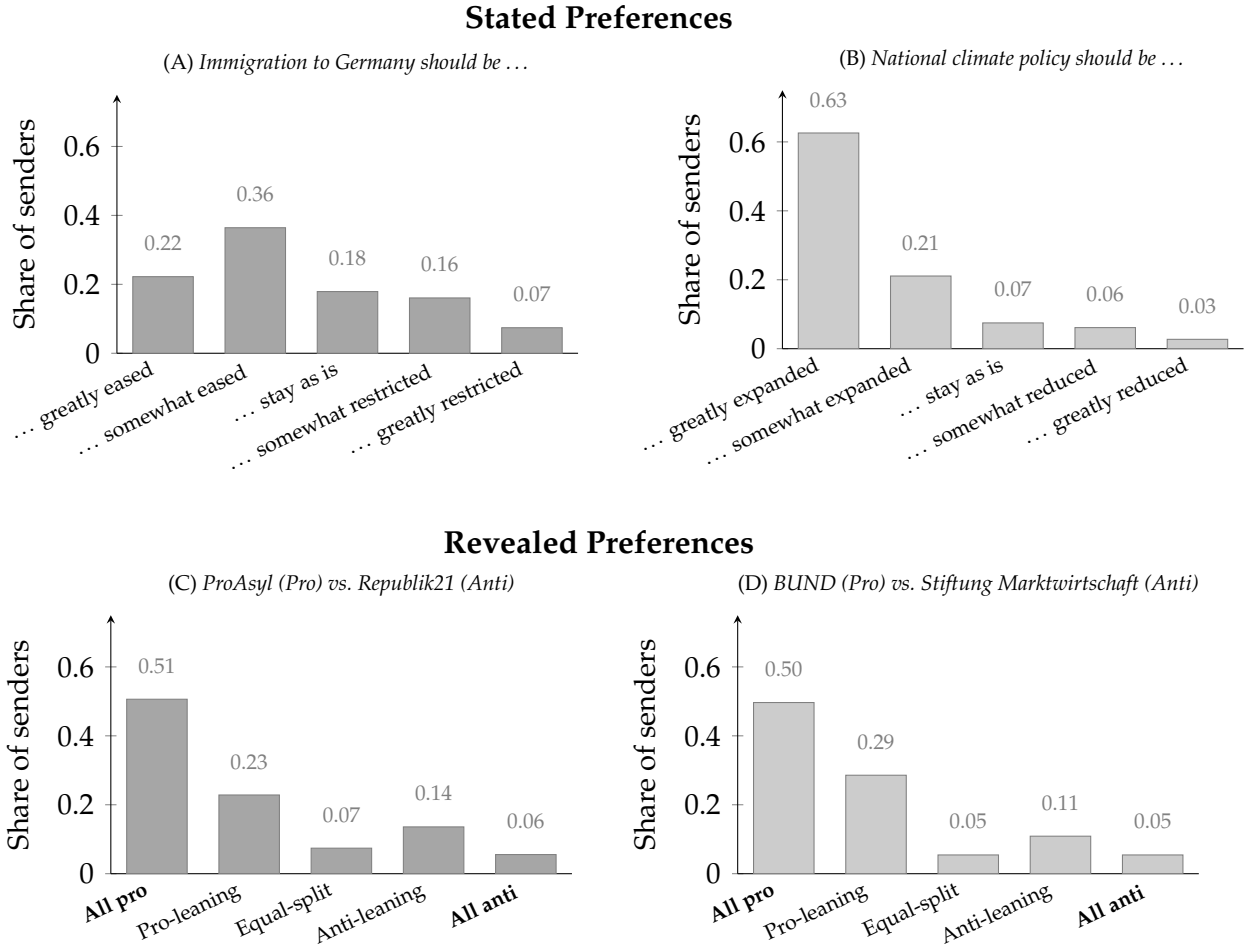


Figure D.1: Distribution of Policy Preferences Among Journalists

Notes: The sample is the Experiment 3 journalists ($N = 309$). The top row (Panels A–B) shows stated preferences from the 5-point Likert item; tick labels complete the stance statement shown in the panel title (e.g., *Immigration to Germany should be … greatly eased*). The bottom row (Panels C–D) shows revealed preferences from the real donation task, grouped into five buckets from All pro (€250 to the pro-policy organization) to All anti (€0), displayed pro-to-anti left to right. The left column shows immigration senders ($N = 162$, no non-response). The right column shows climate senders ($N = 147$, no non-response). Axes and bucket definitions are identical to Figure C.1, which reports the same distributions for the Experiment 2 general-population sample.

nant's index coefficient to the stance–fact alignment index coefficient, and its difference between journalists and the general population's ACTION treatment.

Moderator	Interaction of moderator with:				Obs.
	Align_{ij}	α_{ij}	Δb_{ijk}	$\Delta \pi_{ijk}$	
Distance $\lvert\text{Stance}_i - \text{Stance}_k\rvert$	0.027^{***}	0.043	0.018	0.004	1545
	(0.009)	(0.103)	(0.098)	(0.039)	
Polarization	0.017^{*}	0.086	-0.105	0.025	1540
	(0.010)	(0.086)	(0.096)	(0.037)	
Issue extremity	-0.039	0.085	0.110	0.051	1545
	(0.029)	(0.251)	(0.205)	(0.085)	
Online medium	-0.041	-0.100	-0.016	-0.014	1540
	(0.029)	(0.247)	(0.283)	(0.096)	
Public broadcaster	-0.140^{*}	-0.984^{*}	0.612	-0.147	275
	(0.074)	(0.591)	(0.776)	(0.266)	
National/international reach	-0.054^{*}	-0.248	0.183	0.120	1545
	(0.030)	(0.248)	(0.272)	(0.100)	
Editor role	-0.019	0.159	-0.205	0.063	1545
	(0.030)	(0.253)	(0.272)	(0.096)	
Editorial autonomy	-0.017	-0.150	0.333^{**}	0.062^{*}	1540
	(0.017)	(0.147)	(0.141)	(0.036)	

Notes: The sample is the Experiment 3 journalists. Column (1) is a linear probability model of positional alignment and its interactions. The remaining columns report probit index coefficients of the three-return specification, which are not probability-scale effects (Corollary 1). The dependent variable is the binary provision decision ($y_{ij} \in \{0, 1\}$). Each row reports interaction coefficients between one moderator and the selection measures; columns (2)–(4) are from a single regression interacting the moderator with the stance–fact alignment index (α_{ij}), the expected accuracy gain (Δb_{ijk}), and Persuasion ($\Delta \pi_{ijk}$) jointly. All specifications include fact fixed effects and journalist-clustered standard errors (in parentheses); moderators are centered at the estimation-sample mean. The moderators are sender–receiver distance, polarization (|left-right − 5|), issue extremity (|stance − 3|), and the pre-registered journalist background variables, coarsened as online medium (vs. all other medium types), public broadcaster (defined only for television and radio senders), national or international reach (vs. local or regional), any editor role in the multi-select role item, and editorial autonomy (Likert 1–5). Benjamini–Hochberg correction is applied within two families: the pre-registered positional-alignment battery (column 1; 8 tests) and the channel battery (columns 2–4; 24 tests). Stars mark unadjusted p-values: $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table D.2: Heterogeneity of Selection on Positional Alignment and on the Motive Channels Among Journalists

Table D.3: Self-Reported Motivations and Alignment Bias Among Journalists

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Belief correction	-0.122^{***}	-0.146^{***}	-0.125^{***}	-0.134^{**}
	(0.041)	(0.041)	(0.042)	(0.054)
Expression	0.213	0.187	0.207	0.199
	(0.139)	(0.138)	(0.140)	(0.144)
Persuasion	0.214^{***}	0.185^{***}	0.214^{***}	0.202^{***}
	(0.066)	(0.066)	(0.066)	(0.070)
Misc.	-0.196	-0.112	-0.208	-0.210
	(0.163)	(0.179)	(0.165)	(0.167)
$\lvert\text{Pref}_i\rvert$		0.255^{***}		
		(0.082)		
Constant	0.196^{***}	0.031		0.210^{***}
	(0.037)	(0.065)		(0.052)
Topic fixed effects	No	No	Yes	No
Sample	All	All	All	Referrers
Observations	296	296	296	220
Adjusted R^2	0.093	0.119	0.090	0.136

Notes: The sample is Experiment 3 journalists. The dependent variable is the journalist-level alignment bias, the within-journalist difference between the provision share for aligned facts and the provision share for unaligned facts, defined on the sample of journalists holding a directional policy preference and at least one fact of each type. Regressors are indicators for the motives a journalist's free-text account of their decisions was classified as citing; a journalist may cite more than one, and the omitted category is giving no account that refers to the sharing decision. Classification is by large language model under the coding scheme of Appendix F.1. Column (1) is the specification of Table B.15 for Experiment 1; column (2) adds preference intensity $\lvert\text{Pref}_i\rvert$; column (3) adds topic fixed effects; column (4) restricts to journalists who gave an account referring to the sharing decision. Experiment 3 assigns every journalist to the ACTION treatment, so the interactions with ACTION of the Experiment 1 specification are not estimable here. Heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors in parentheses. The expressive category is cited by eleven journalists. These items are recorded after the provision task and are not incentivized; the analysis is exploratory. $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table D.4: Ratios to the Stance–Fact Alignment Index Coefficient: Journalists and the General Population

	Ratio to the stance–fact alignment index coefficient		
	Journalists	General population (ACTION treatment)	Difference (1) − (2)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Persuasion	0.295	0.171	0.124
	[0.068, 0.823]	[0.069, 0.291]	[-0.132, 0.629]
Expected accuracy gain	0.641	0.094	0.547
	[0.073, 1.851]	[-0.150, 0.366]	[-0.074, 1.766]
Political distance	−0.469	−0.441	−0.028
	[-1.126, -0.250]	[-0.614, -0.322]	[-0.685, 0.251]

Notes: Each entry is the ratio of a determinant's probit index coefficient to the stance–fact alignment index coefficient within a sample, from the models of Table 8, Panel A; each sample's latent scale cancels within the ratio. Column (3) is the difference between samples. Brackets are 95% percentile intervals from 1,000 sender-cluster bootstrap replications, senders resampled within each sample. Comparing ratios across samples maintains equal shock shapes and that the imported index measures journalists' alignment.

E Experiment 4: Supplementary Results

E.1 Design and Sample Details

Figure E.1 reports receivers' stated policy views on their matched topic, elicited before matching.

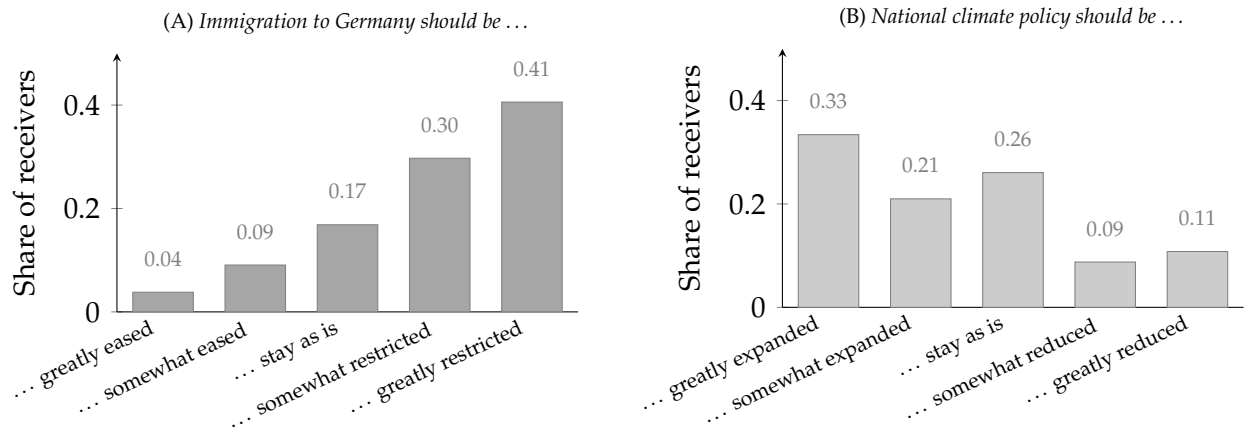


Figure E.1: Stated Policy Views Among Receivers

Notes: The sample is the Experiment 4 receivers (N = 1,043). Each receiver reports a stance on the matched topic on the same five-point item as the senders in Figure C.1, elicited before matching; tick labels complete the stance statement shown in the panel title. The left panel shows receivers matched on immigration (N = 552) and the right panel receivers matched on climate (N = 491).

Belief elicitation layout. The two answer words appear on the same side of the slider throughout for a given participant, and which side is randomized across participants, because the correct answer is the increase word for ten of twelve facts. The stored probability is on a named word and does not depend on the layout.

Exclusions. Of 2,000 raw records, 1,842 reached the instrument and 1,340 passed the checks that link a receiver to their sender and reached the transmission draw. Of the 1,081 who completed, 38 are excluded as speeders under the filed rule (completion time below a quarter of the median); the filed bot exclusion removed no one, because the export carries no fraud indicator. Without the speeder cut, no estimate of the primary specification moves by more than 0.002.

Attrition. Completion differs across reception states: 86.1 percent after receipt, 76.0 percent after failed transmission and 80.5 percent after withholding. Among completers, receipt and failed transmission are balanced on prior loss, intake policy view, alignment with the sender and demographics (joint $p = 0.778$). In the withholding state, completion falls with alignment with the sender ($p = 0.017$) and rises with prior loss

($p = 0.032$), so that state is selected by the sender and again by completion. Table E.2 reports trimming bounds for the primary specification.

Robustness. Dropping each of the twelve facts in turn, β_W ranges from 0.110 to 0.135 and β_F from 0.116 to 0.134 (all $p < 0.001$). Among the 295 receivers who pass the comprehension checks on the first attempt, the difference in posterior loss between the two non-receipt states is $+0.020$ ($p = 0.551$), against -0.002 ($p = 0.921$) among the rest.

Perceived selectivity. The actual disclosure rates are cell shares and carry binomial sampling error, which attenuates the slope of perceived on actual selectivity. Sampling variance accounts for 22.5 percent of the variance of actual selectivity, so the reliability-corrected slope is $0.066/0.775 = 0.085$. Table E.3 reports the registered secondary analyses.

E.2 Sender Forecasts and Receiver Outcomes

Both sender pre-registrations name a comparison of senders' forecasts with matched receivers' outcomes. Matched to the receiver they decided about, general-population senders forecast that receipt raises the share answering correctly by 0.170, against a realized 0.201 for receipt against failed transmission, and journalists 0.305, against 0.281. Forecasts of opinion movement are too large: an absolute shift of 0.66 scale points against a realized 0.15 in the general population, and 0.54 against 0.35 among journalists. Forecasts concern stance groups, a third or more have no benchmark cell, and receivers not shown a fact include those whose sender withheld it, so the comparison is descriptive.

Table E.1: Sample Characteristics

	Population (1)	Sample (2)
Gender		
Female	0.499	0.492
Male	0.501	0.508
Diverse	—	0.000
Age band		
18–29	0.179	0.174
30–39	0.178	0.178
40–49	0.170	0.167
50–59	0.193	0.219
60–75	0.279	0.262
Bundesland		
Baden-Württemberg	0.134	0.136
Bayern	0.159	0.158
Berlin	0.045	0.041
Brandenburg	0.030	0.031
Bremen	0.008	0.010
Hamburg	0.023	0.021
Hessen	0.075	0.073
Mecklenburg-Vorpommern	0.019	0.022
Niedersachsen	0.095	0.081
Nordrhein-Westfalen	0.216	0.233
Rheinland-Pfalz	0.050	0.052
Saarland	0.012	0.011
Sachsen	0.047	0.053
Sachsen-Anhalt	0.025	0.019
Schleswig-Holstein	0.035	0.031
Thüringen	0.025	0.030
School-leaving qualification		
Hauptschulabschluss or none	0.297	0.308
Mittlerer Abschluss (Realschule)	0.314	0.269
Fachhochschul-/Hochschulreife or higher	0.390	0.423

Notes: The sample is the $N = 1{,}043$ Experiment 4 receivers, German adults recruited on Bilendi (quota-sampled). Column (1) reports German population proportions, as in Table C.12. For gender, age band, and Bundesland, the benchmark is the population aged 18–75 as of 31 December 2024 (Bevölkerungsfortschreibung on the Zensus-2022 basis; Statistisches Bundesamt, Statistischer Bericht 12411, tables 12411-06 and 12411-09). No registry benchmark exists for "Diverse." For school-leaving qualification, the benchmark is the Mikrozensus 2023 (Statistisches Bundesamt, Bildungsstand der Bevölkerung), persons aged 15 and over excluding those still in school—a broader base than the sample's 18–75. Column (2) reports sample proportions.

Table E.2: Trimming Bounds for Differential Completion

Contrast	State trimmed	Trimmed (%)	Estimate	Bounds, trimming ranked on posterior loss	Bounds, trimming ranked on residual loss
Failed transmission vs. receipt (β_F)	R	11.7	0.126	[0.108, 0.186]	[0.063, 0.187]
Withholding vs. failed transmission ($\beta_W - \beta_F$)	W	5.6	0.001	[−0.028, 0.015]	[−0.035, 0.030]
Withholding vs. receipt (β_W)	R	6.5	0.128	[0.119, 0.164]	[0.089, 0.166]

Notes: The analysis sample is Experiment 4's receivers, $N = 1{,}043$. Each row refits equation (7) after trimming the reception state with the higher completion rate, from the top and from the bottom of the ranked outcome, by the completion gap divided by that state's completion rate. Completion is measured among receivers who reached the transmission draw: receipt 373/433, failed transmission 381/501, withholding 327/406. Residual loss is posterior loss net of prior loss and fact fixed effects. Receipt and failed transmission are randomly assigned among receivers whose sender disclosed, so the first row is a Lee (2009) bound under monotonicity: no receiver who completes after failed transmission would have left after receipt. Withholding is not randomly assigned, so the second and third rows are sensitivity ranges. Trimming shares use the completer counts before the filed speeder exclusion.

Table E.3: Updating after Non-Receipt and Moderation by the Fact's Support for the Receiver's View

	Coefficient	SE	p (= 0)	p (= 1)	N
Panel A. Posterior log-odds after non-receipt (Bayes: both coefficients equal one)					
Prior log-odds	0.585	(0.046)	< 0.001	< 0.001	685
Log-likelihood ratio at stated rates	-1.529	(0.387)	< 0.001	< 0.001	685
Panel B. Interaction with the fact's support for the receiver's view					
Belief change after non-receipt	-1.459	(5.825)	0.802		1,043
Perceived selectivity	0.060	(0.037)	0.100		1,043
Policy view after withholding	-0.249	(0.182)	0.170		1,043
Policy view after failed transmission	-0.014	(0.147)	0.924		1,043

Notes: The sample is Experiment 4's receivers. The analyses are registered as secondary questions (1) and (4) of AsPredicted No. 306857, which fixes no regression form; the specifications are mine. Panel A covers non-receipt states only; it regresses the logit of the posterior on the correct answer on the logit of the prior and the log-likelihood ratio of non-receipt implied by the receiver's own stated disclosure rates and a transmission probability of one half. Beliefs are clamped to $[0.005, 0.995]$ (165 observations). Bayesian updating at the stated rates implies both coefficients equal one. In Panel B, support is the cross-domain rating of how strongly the fact supports views at the receiver's stance. Belief change and policy view include fact fixed effects; the policy-view row controls for the intake view and demographics. HC3 standard errors.

F LLM Classification of Stated Motives

F.1 Classification Procedure

I classify the open-ended decision-reason responses of Experiment 1 (1,200 senders, in English) and Experiment 3 (306 of the 309 journalists, three having no codable row) into the categories of Table F.1. Each distinct response is classified in its own API call returning one structured JSON object, with the model pinned and default sampling settings; exact duplicates take the original's classification. A first-step gate asks whether the response refers to the sharing decision, the receiver, or the information provision, and responses that do not receive no category coding. Categories are not mutually exclusive, and a label is assigned only where the text gives distinct support for it.

Two versions of the scheme are in play, so comparisons between the two experiments are comparisons across versions. Experiment 3 is classified once, by Claude Sonnet 5 (`claude-sonnet-5`), under the earlier version, which assigns each response one primary motive alongside all categories it mentions. Experiment 1 is classified under a later and stricter version by Claude Sonnet 5, the primary classification, and by GPT-5.6 (`gpt-5.6-terra`) as robustness, under one prompt frozen and hashed before either run. This version records each category as absent, affirmed, or mentioned but rejected, with the supporting span of text; all regressions use the affirmed state. The complete prompt is available upon request.

F.2 Validation

For Experiment 1, the two models agree on 91 percent of gate decisions ($\kappa = 0.81$), 94 percent of belief-correction codings ($\kappa = 0.88$) and 98 percent of persuasion codings ($\kappa = 0.73$). Expression is affirmed for twelve and ten responses, and the models agree on six, so the expression row of Table B.15 describes a handful of senders and depends on the model. Under the second classifier every coefficient in that table keeps its sign and the persuasion interaction with ACTION remains significant at the five percent level (Appendix Table B.17). Agreement between two models applying one prompt cannot show that either coding is correct. Experiment 3 is classified once; the model's self-reported confidence is at least 0.7 for 81 percent of its responses.

F.3 Coding Examples

Tables F.2 and F.3 present representative responses in each category for Experiments 1 and 3, the latter translated from German.

Table F.1: Coding Scheme and Decision Rules

Category	Definition	Key boundary rule	Applies to
Belief correction	Truth-telling, honesty, or the receiver's right to accurate information; direction-blind	Does not depend on the fact's political direction	All
Expression	The fact's fit with the sender's own position is the stated decision factor, with no receiver goal	No receiver-directed goal. Exp. 1: the disclosure act and a directional selection criterion must both be explicit, so a bare statement of position fails the gate	All
Persuasion	A receiver-directed goal: moving what the receiver thinks or does	Any reference to the receiver changing is coded here. Exp. 1: an elliptical receiver-impact consideration offered as the answer qualifies	All
Balance	Deliberately sharing counter-attitudinal or both-sides content	The receiver is meant to see the other side	All
Role neutrality (journalists only)	Professional role integrity: it is not the journalist's place to filter what the reader sees	Distinct from *balance*; concerns the sender's role, not both-sidedness	Exps. 1, 3
Receiver tailoring	Decision conditioned on the receiver's beliefs or characteristics, without reference to attitude change	Any reference to the receiver changing → *persuasion*	Exps. 2–3
Disbelief	Credibility doubts about the fact or source as the reason for withholding	Politically motivated skepticism → *expression* or *persuasion*. In Exp. 1 a flag, not a category	Exps. 2–3
Relevance	The fact is judged irrelevant or unimportant for the receiver, without a directional stake	Misleadingness with a directional stake → *persuasion*	Exps. 2–3
Futility	"Facts do not change minds" offered as the stated reason	A general claim about receivers, not about one fact	Exps. 2–3
Other stated reason (Exps. 2–3: miscellaneous)	Refers to the decision and gives a reason outside the listed categories, or none that is interpretable	Residual category; enters the regression only as a control	All
Gate outcomes	Describes only the sender's own epistemic process or a different task, states a non-directional opinion with no decision link, or refers to the decision without giving a reason	Receives no category coding	All

Categories coded from the open-ended decision-reason responses of Experiments 1–3. Categories are not mutually exclusive; a label is assigned only where the text gives distinct support. The Experiment 2–3 version assigns each passing response one primary motive; the Experiment 1 version assigns none and records each category as absent, affirmed, or mentioned but rejected, with a required supporting text span. Role neutrality is available in the Experiment 1 version but is affirmed by neither classifier there, which is what the design anticipates for a general-population sample. Expression, persuasion, and belief correction map onto the expressive, persuasion, and factual-belief-correction channels in the main text.

Table F.2: Coding Examples: U.S. Senders

Category	Status	Example
Belief correction	Affirmed	*"People should know the truth."* *"I wanted the people who got the questions wrong to know the correct answer. People should be more knowledgeable about things."*
Expression	Affirmed	*"When I thought that the fact was unfavorable towards immigration, I chose to not share the fact."* *"I wanted to show a more positive view of immigrants."*
	Mentioned but rejected	*"Everyone should be informed about facts even if it goes against my beliefs or hiding facts to sway decisions. Nothing but the facts."* *"I think everyone deserves to know the truth and be informed, even if the facts dont align with my personal preferences."*
Persuasion	Affirmed	*"If the question had a direct impact on the way people view immigrants."* *"People who are ill informed, when they are enlightened, may choose to reallocate more funds towards helping immigrants if they know the truth."*
	Mentioned but rejected	*"Everyone should know the truth regardless of how it influences their decisions on immigration."* *"Wanting to be honest instead of manipulative."*
Other stated reason	Affirmed	*"Basically only on whether or not I personally would want/ care to know. For a couple of them, I WOULD want to know. And, for the other two, not as much."*
Referred, no stated reason	Gate outcome	*"Basic knowledge and provided information."* *"The information that was provided at the end."*
Different task only	Gate outcome	*"I made decisions based on what I truly thought was the correct answer and was surprised to find I was mistaken on a few."*
Did not refer to disclosure	Gate outcome	*"My own beliefs and also taking into consideration the information from research."* *"I think that immigration is a valuable thing for the US. I think immigrants help the economy and do important jobs US citizens do not want to do."*

Open-ended responses from Experiment 1 senders, illustrating the boundaries of the coding scheme. Every example shown is coded identically by both classifiers. *Affirmed* means the response gives distinct support for the category; *mentioned but rejected* means the response raises the consideration and states that it did not govern the decision—the two expression examples are senders who name their own position and say they disclosed regardless of it. The last three rows are gate outcomes and receive no category coding: a response may refer to the disclosure decision without giving a reason for it, may describe only a different task in the experiment, or may state a political opinion with no link to the decision. Responses are lightly excerpted for length; full text available upon request.

Table F.3: Coding Examples: Journalists

Primary motive	Example
Belief correction	*"All readers should have all the information so that they can form their own opinion. That is why I sent everything."* *"Everyone has a right to the facts, whatever their opinion. So I always sent them."*
Expression	*"I checked whether the information supported my opinion or not, and sent it accordingly."* *"Weighing the reader's existing opinion against the slant of the information—admittedly in favour of my own view."*
Persuasion	*"You try to nudge people a little towards your own opinion."* *"Starting from my own opinion, I tried to gauge in which case the person would move closer to my view."*
Role neutrality	*"I always send information. It is my job."* *"As a journalist I send facts neutrally—independent of my personal opinion. The readers' opinion was really secondary."*
Balance	*"Balance was important to me."* *"I tried to create a counterweight to the constant political propaganda."*

Representative open-ended responses from Experiment 3 senders (German journalists), illustrating the classification boundaries between primary motives. "Role neutrality" captures the professional-norm rationale of transmitting facts irrespective of the sender's or receiver's stance. Responses are translated from German and lightly excerpted for length; original text available upon request. Primary motive classification by Claude Sonnet 5.

G Stated Norms and Perceived Design Balance

Most participants perceived no political imbalance in the study: 85.5 percent of the general population and 82.2 percent of journalists (Table G.1, Panel A). Panel B reports the three normative items, and Table G.2 their interactions with the selection measures. Among journalists, the positional alignment slope falls from 0.180 among those who agree that one should pass on true information contradicting one's own position to 0.090 among those who strongly agree.

Two research assistants independently coded each participant's open-ended answer on what the study was about as a correct guess if it named the selective passing on of information depending on the sender's own position. Table G.3 reports the shares. The assistants agree on 96 to 99 percent of answers in Experiments 1, 2 and 4 and on 78 percent among journalists. In Experiment 4, 34 receivers' answers were exported before coding; counting all of them as correct guesses would raise the share to at most 4 percent.

	General population (Exp. 2)			Journalists (Exp. 3)		
	Mean	SD	% Agree	Mean	SD	% Agree
Panel A: Perceived political imbalance (% of valid answers)						
No imbalance perceived			85.5			82.2
Imbalance favoring the left			9.5			12.0
Imbalance favoring the right			5.0			5.8
Panel B: Normative and policy items (1–5 agreement)						
Share opposing information	4.13	0.90	80.0	4.61	0.67	95.5
Social-media transparency	4.05	0.96	75.7	4.61	0.65	95.1
Viewpoint-diversity obligation	4.17	0.90	80.4	4.21	0.91	82.5

Notes: The data are post-questionnaire self-reports, one per sender, from Experiments 2 and 3. Panel A reports answers to "Did you perceive a political imbalance in the study?" (options: no imbalance, imbalance favoring the left, imbalance favoring the right), in percent of valid answers; Experiment 2 $N = 1{,}548$ (no nonresponse), Experiment 3 $N = 309$ (no nonresponse). Panel B reports agreement on a 1–5 scale (1 = fully disagree, 5 = fully agree) with three items: whoever passes on political information should also pass on factually correct information that contradicts their own position (worded for journalists in Experiment 3); social media should be more transparent about why users see some political information and not others; platforms and media should be obligated to surface relevant information from different perspectives. % Agree is the share answering 4 or 5. Experiment 2 $N = 1{,}548$; Experiment 3 $N = 308$ (one nonresponse).

Table G.1: Perceived Design Balance and Normative Items

Item	Interaction of item with: Align_{ij}	α_{ij}	$\Delta\pi_{ijk}$	Obs.
Panel A: General population (Experiment 2)				
Share opposing information	0.006	0.027	0.006	7740
	(0.010)	(0.021)	(0.007)	
Social-media transparency	0.008	0.003	0.005	7740
	(0.009)	(0.019)	(0.006)	
Viewpoint-diversity obligation	0.017*	0.054***	0.010	7740
	(0.009)	(0.020)	(0.007)	
Panel B: Journalists (Experiment 3)				
Share opposing information	−0.090***	−0.110*	−0.040	1540
	(0.021)	(0.058)	(0.026)	
Social-media transparency	−0.054**	−0.009	−0.050**	1540
	(0.024)	(0.047)	(0.024)	
Viewpoint-diversity obligation	0.002	0.026	−0.011	1540
	(0.022)	(0.042)	(0.016)	

Notes: The samples are the Experiment 2 general population and the Experiment 3 journalists. The dependent variable is the binary provision decision ($y_{ij} \in \{0,1\}$). Each cell reports the interaction coefficient between the row item (centered at 3, the scale midpoint) and one selection measure, from a separate regression of provision on the measure, the item, and their interaction, with fact fixed effects and sender-clustered standard errors (in parentheses). The selection measures are positional alignment (Align_{ij}), the stance–fact alignment index (α_{ij}), and Persuasion ($\Delta\pi_{ijk}$). Items as in Table G.1, Panel B. Benjamini–Hochberg correction is applied across the 18-test family (3 items × 3 measures × 2 samples). Three interactions survive at the 10 % level: in Experiment 3, the opposing-information item with positional alignment ($q < 0.001$) and the transparency item with positional alignment ($q = 0.079$); in Experiment 2, the viewpoint-diversity item with the stance–fact alignment index ($q = 0.078$). The next smallest is $q = 0.185$. Stars mark unadjusted p-values: $^{***}p < 0.01$; $^{**}p < 0.05$; $^{*}p < 0.1$.

Table G.2: Normative Items and Selection: Channel × Item Interactions, General Population and Journalists

	Exp. 1 (U.S. senders)	Exp. 2 (German senders)	Exp. 3 (journalists)	Exp. 4 (receivers)
Perceived no political bias in the study	86.6	85.5	82.2	87.5
Correct guess, both research assistants	3.2	0.9	18.1	0.2
Correct guess, at least one research assistant	7.1	1.9	39.8	0.8
Agreement between research assistants	96.2	99.0	78.2	99.4
Participants	1,200	1,548	309	1,043

Notes: Shares are in percent. "Perceived no political bias" is the answer "no imbalance" to the closing question whether the study was politically imbalanced. The guessed purpose is coded from the open-ended closing question on what the study was about by two research assistants independently, from the text alone. An answer is a correct guess if it names the selective passing on of information depending on the sender's own position; in Experiment 1, the category "selective information provision" of a six-category scheme. In Experiment 4, the guessed purpose is coded for 1,009 of the 1,043 receivers, whose answers were exported during fielding.

Table G.3: Perceived Bias and Guessed Purpose of the Study

H Derivations

H.1 Sender Framework

The body writes each determinant linearly. Throughout this appendix I read Equations (2) and (3) in the more general form $\tau\,\theta_B(A)\,h_B(\Delta b) + \theta_E(A)\,h_E(\alpha) + \tau\,\theta_P(A)\,w(\Delta\pi) - \theta_R(A)\,D(\rho) + \kappa A$, where h_B, h_E, w and D are differentiable with strictly positive deriva-

tives on the relevant domain, and $w(0) = 0$, so that w preserves the sign of $\Delta\pi$. Setting each to the identity recovers the body model. The proofs write out w and D. The transformations h_B and h_E enter in the same way: they multiply $\partial U_A/\partial \Delta b$ by $h_B'(\Delta b) > 0$ and $\partial U_A/\partial \alpha$ by $h_E'(\alpha) > 0$, and in comparisons across A these factors are evaluated at the same point, by Assumption 3(i) for Δb and by definition for α. Every sign statement below therefore carries over; only the displayed rate formulas change. The linear ρ is a parameterization of magnitude: every sign statement below that involves ρ holds for any such D, so evidence against a linear distance profile bears on D and not on those statements.

Proof of Proposition 1. Fix A, with U_A as in Equation (2). Differentiating Equation (2),

$$\frac{\partial U_A}{\partial \Delta b} = \tau\,\theta_B(A), \qquad \frac{\partial U_A}{\partial \alpha} = \theta_E(A), \qquad \frac{\partial U_A}{\partial w(\Delta\pi)} = \tau\,\theta_P(A), \qquad \frac{\partial U_A}{\partial \rho} = -\theta_R(A)\,D'(\rho).$$

Each partial derivative holds the other disclosure determinants fixed, which is the ceteris paribus condition in the statement. Since $\tau > 0$, the first is strictly positive whenever $\theta_B(A) > 0$, the second whenever $\theta_E(A) > 0$, and the fourth is strictly negative whenever $\theta_R(A) > 0$, since $D'(\rho) > 0$. Where w is differentiable with $w'(\Delta\pi) > 0$, the chain rule gives $\partial U_A/\partial \Delta\pi = \tau\,\theta_P(A)\,w'(\Delta\pi)$, strictly positive whenever $\theta_P(A) > 0$. The term κA is constant in the four determinants and drops from every derivative. Because F_A does not vary with the determinants under Assumption 1, the chain rule applied to Equation (3) gives $\partial \Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A)/\partial x_j = f_A(U_A)\,\partial U_A/\partial x_j$ for each determinant x_j. Since $f_A > 0$, the probability response and the marginal utility share their sign. □

Proof of Proposition 2. Differentiating Equation (2) at fixed A gives $\partial U/\partial \Delta b = \tau\,\theta_B(A)$, $\partial U/\partial \alpha = \theta_E(A)$, $\partial U/\partial \Delta\pi = \tau\,\theta_P(A)$ and $\partial U/\partial \rho = -\theta_R(A)\,D'(\rho)$. Under Assumption 3(i) the expected accuracy gain and the expected persuasion return take the same values under both values of A, and alignment does by definition, so each derivative is compared at the same disclosure opportunity. Under the linear form the derivatives do not depend on the realized returns, so Assumption 3(i) is what makes the comparison one of the same opportunity rather than what makes the derivatives comparable; it binds directly under the general transformation, where w' is evaluated at the realized $\Delta\pi$. Differencing between $A = 1$ and $A = 0$,

$$\left.\frac{\partial U}{\partial \Delta b}\right|_{A=1} - \left.\frac{\partial U}{\partial \Delta b}\right|_{A=0} = \tau\left[\theta_B(1) - \theta_B(0)\right], \qquad \left.\frac{\partial U}{\partial \Delta\pi}\right|_{A=1} - \left.\frac{\partial U}{\partial \Delta\pi}\right|_{A=0} = \tau\left[\theta_P(1) - \theta_P(0)\right],$$

while the difference for α is $\theta_E(1) - \theta_E(0) = 0$ under Assumption 3(ii) and the difference for ρ is $-\left[\theta_R(1) - \theta_R(0)\right] D'(\rho) = 0$ under Assumption 3(iii). Both receiver-dependent differences are zero if valuations are unchanged, the first is positive if

$\theta_B(1) > \theta_B(0)$, and the second is positive if $\theta_P(1) > \theta_P(0)$, which gives parts (i)–(iii). Under the general transformation the persuasion difference is $\tau\,[\theta_P(1) - \theta_P(0)]\,w'(\Delta\pi)$, strictly positive wherever $w' > 0$. Since $\tau > 0$ is common to both values of A, it scales the two receiver-dependent differences and does not affect their sign. □

Derivation of Equation (4) and its sign. Differencing the probability responses in the proof of Proposition 1 between $A = 1$ and $A = 0$, at the same x, gives $\tau\,[f_1(U_1)\theta_P(1) - f_0(U_0)\theta_P(0)]\,w'(\Delta\pi)$ for the persuasion return, with the derivative evaluated at the common $\Delta\pi$ so that $w'(\Delta\pi) > 0$ is a common factor affecting no sign below, and the analogous expression without it for the expected accuracy gain. This is a difference of two products. It is strictly positive whenever $\theta_P(1) > \theta_P(0) \geq 0$ and $f_1(U_1) \geq f_0(U_0)$, and it is negative whenever $f_1(U_1)/f_0(U_0) < \theta_P(0)/\theta_P(1)$, which is compatible with $\theta_P(1) > \theta_P(0) > 0$ because the ratio of the two densities, each evaluated at its own point of its support, is unrestricted. So the sign of the change in the marginal utility does not determine the sign of the change in the probability response. For alignment, with the expressive weight held fixed under Assumption 3(ii), the difference is $\theta_E\,[f_1(U_1) - f_0(U_0)]$, which is zero only if the two densities coincide at those points: an unchanged weight need not leave the response of disclosure unchanged. □

Proof of Corollary 1. Under Assumption 4(i), $F_A(u) = G\big((u - \mu_A)/s_A\big)$ gives $\Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A) = G\big((U_A - \mu_A)/s_A\big)$, and G strictly increasing is invertible, so $G^{-1}\big(\Pr(d = 1 \mid x, A)\big) = (U_A - \mu_A)/s_A$. This step uses the shape restriction alone. Under Assumption 1, F_A, and hence μ_A and s_A, do not vary with the determinants, so differentiating in x_j gives $\beta_j(A) = s_A^{-1}\partial U_A/\partial x_j$, and the locations μ_A do not survive differentiation. For the distance term the index slope is $\beta_\rho(A) = -s_A^{-1}\,\theta_R(A)\,D'(\rho)$, so a distance profile that is not linear is a statement about D, not about the sign of θ_R.

For part (i), Assumption 4(ii), $s_1 = s_0 = s$, is what makes differencing between $A = 1$ and $A = 0$ deliver s^{-1} times the differences in Proposition 2, which uses Assumption 3. Because $s > 0$, every sign statement in that proposition is preserved.

For part (ii), one scale divides both slopes, so $\beta_j(A)/\beta_E(A) = (\partial U_A/\partial x_j)/(\partial U_A/\partial \alpha)$, the sender's marginal rate of substitution between x_j and alignment, well defined because $\theta_E(A) \neq 0$ and free of s_A. The cancellation requires the two slopes to be formed under the same value of A; it says nothing about s_1/s_0, which never appears. With the derivatives computed in the proof of Proposition 2,

$$\frac{\beta_m(A)}{\beta_E(A)} = \frac{\tau\,\theta_m(A)}{\theta_E(A)} \quad (m \in \{B, P\}), \qquad \frac{\beta_\rho(A)}{\beta_E(A)} = -\frac{\theta_R(A)\,D'(\rho)}{\theta_E(A)},$$

where the persuasion ratio carries the factor $w'(\Delta\pi)$ under the general transformation and the distance ratio reduces to $-\theta_R(A)/\theta_E(A)$ under the linear benchmark. Neither τ nor s_A enters the distance ratio. Under Assumption 3(ii) the denominator equals θ_E

under both values of A, and under Assumption 3(i) the two ratios are formed at the same disclosure opportunity, so differencing gives $\tau\left[\theta_m(1)-\theta_m(0)\right]/\theta_E$. Under Assumption 3(iii) the numerator of the distance ratio is also common to both values of A, so that ratio does not change with A. Under the general transformation Assumption 3(i) holds $\Delta\pi$ and hence w' fixed across the two, so the persuasion difference is $\tau\left[\theta_P(1)-\theta_P(0)\right]w'(\Delta\pi)/\theta_E$, of the same sign as its linear counterpart wherever $w'>0$. The arrival probability τ is positive and common to both values of A, so it affects neither the sign of a ratio nor the direction of its change. A ratio is measured in alignment per unit of its determinant: along an indifference curve, $d\alpha/dx_j=-\beta_j(A)/\beta_E(A)$, so its level says how much alignment is worth as much to the sender as a marginal unit of that determinant, not how strongly she holds either motive. With heterogeneous weights, scales or locations the cancellation holds sender by sender, and a pooled coefficient ratio need not equal the average of individual ratios. □

Remark: an increase in persuasiveness. The framework also yields a magnitude statement, recorded here because nothing in the body rests on it. Fix A and suppose $\theta_P(A)>0$ and $w'(\Delta\pi)>0$. Equation (3) gives $\partial\Pr(d=1\mid x,A)/\partial\Delta\pi=f_A(U_A)\,\tau\,\theta_P(A)\,w'(\Delta\pi)>0$: when receipt is expected to move the receiver toward the sender's position, disclosure rises with the expected strength of that movement. For $\Delta\pi<0$, writing $\Delta\pi=-|\Delta\pi|$, the chain rule gives $\partial\Pr(d=1\mid x,A)/\partial|\Delta\pi|<0$, so when receipt is expected to move the receiver away, disclosure falls with the expected strength of that movement. The boundary case, outside the class assumed above, is $w(\Delta\pi)=\operatorname{sign}(\Delta\pi)$, where the sender responds to the direction of persuasion and not to its magnitude.

H.2 Receiver Benchmark

The Bayesian benchmark. A sender who observes a binary state $\omega\in\{0,1\}$ discloses it with state-contingent probabilities $\sigma_1=\Pr(d=1\mid\omega=1)$ and $\sigma_0=\Pr(d=1\mid\omega=0)$. Disclosure is truthful, so she can transmit the state or withhold it but cannot report a state that did not occur. A disclosed state reaches the receiver with probability τ, so non-receipt pools withholding with a failed transmission and the receiver never observes which. A received message identifies the state. Non-receipt does not, and for a receiver who knows the rule,

$$b_{\varnothing}^{\text{Bayes}}=\Pr(\omega=1\mid m=\varnothing)=\frac{p\,(1-\tau\sigma_1)}{p\,(1-\tau\sigma_1)+(1-p)\,(1-\tau\sigma_0)}, \tag{8}$$

where p is the prior. Non-receipt carries information only when the two disclosure rates differ: at $\sigma_1=\sigma_0$ non-receipt leaves belief at the prior. A smaller τ pulls the ex-

pression toward p, because failed transmission then explains non-receipt more readily than withholding does. This fixes a reference and assumes nothing about behavior: a receiver may match it, fall short of it, or move against it. In the sender framework, σ_ω is F_A evaluated at the utility of disclosing a fact whose alignment and expected correction depend on which state obtained. Identifying σ_0 from disclosure observed at the realized state needs a restriction linking the sender's behavior across states.

Expected loss and the ambiguity of non-receipt. Taking expectations over the state and over transmission, the epistemic loss generated by the environment is

$$\mathcal{L} = p\tau\sigma_1(1-b_1)^2 + (1-p)\tau\sigma_0\, b_0^2 + p(1-\tau\sigma_1)(1-b_\varnothing)^2 + (1-p)(1-\tau\sigma_0)\, b_\varnothing^2. \quad (9)$$

Evaluated with the receiver's beliefs, $\mathcal{L}$ is the belief-accuracy loss relative to the realized state and requires no assumption on how she updates. Writing $q_1 = p(1-\tau\sigma_1)$ and $q_0 = (1-p)(1-\tau\sigma_0)$ for the non-receipt weights, with $b_\varnothing^{\text{Bayes}} = q_1/(q_1+q_0)$, the quadratic metric decomposes it as

$$\mathcal{L} = \underbrace{q_1(1-b_\varnothing^{\text{Bayes}})^2 + q_0(b_\varnothing^{\text{Bayes}})^2}_{\text{ambiguity of non-receipt}} + \underbrace{p\tau\sigma_1(1-b_1)^2 + (1-p)\tau\sigma_0\, b_0^2 + (q_1+q_0)(b_\varnothing - b_\varnothing^{\text{Bayes}})^2}_{\text{departure from Bayes}}.$$

The first term is the loss a Bayesian still bears because non-receipt overlaps across states—a function of $(p, \sigma_1, \sigma_0, \tau)$ alone, and zero only when non-receipt separates the states. The remaining terms are the receiver's departures from Bayes, each a squared deviation $(b_m - b_m^{\text{Bayes}})^2$ that vanishes under Bayesian updating and is strictly positive otherwise. Their nonnegativity holds given the benchmark $b_\varnothing^{\text{Bayes}}$, the single point at which a receiver-side rational-updating restriction enters, deliberately and minimally.

Selective disclosure is not intrinsically information-destroying. The ambiguity term equals $q_1 q_0/(q_1+q_0)$, a product of the two non-receipt weights whose sum $q_1+q_0 = 1-\tau\bar{\sigma}$ is fixed by the unconditional disclosure rate $\bar{\sigma} = p\sigma_1 + (1-p)\sigma_0$. A product with a fixed sum is largest when its two factors are equal, so selection lowers the term whenever it moves the weights apart, and whether it does so depends on the prior. Imperfect transmission bounds how far this goes, since for $\tau < 1$ both weights stay strictly positive and non-receipt never fully reveals the state.

I compare an environment with its volume-matched non-selective counterfactual $\sigma_1 = \sigma_0 = \bar{\sigma}$, holding τ fixed, which isolates the contribution of selection in two senses that rest on different restrictions. The first is what selection does to the ambiguity term, which I call the *Bayesian information effect of selection*. Its sign is ambiguous: at

a symmetric prior $p = 1/2$ the volume-matched counterfactual sits at the maximum of the ambiguity term, so selection weakly sharpens what non-receipt conveys, while away from $p = 1/2$ it can take either sign. The next paragraph derives the effect and the threshold where it turns. It depends on $\sigma_1 - \sigma_0$, and disclosure is observed only at the state that occurred: what a sender discloses knowing $\omega = 1$ restricts σ_0 only through an assumption linking her behavior across states, since the counterfactual is her disclosure of the same state had the truth run the other way.

The Bayesian information effect of selection. This paragraph and the next derive the two selection effects defined above. Throughout, $\tau\bar{\sigma} < 1$, so non-receipt has positive probability. Write $\Delta\sigma = \sigma_1 - \sigma_0$ and $K = 1 - \tau\bar{\sigma} > 0$, so that $\sigma_1 = \bar{\sigma} + (1-p)\Delta\sigma$ and $\sigma_0 = \bar{\sigma} - p\Delta\sigma$. The non-receipt weights are then $q_1 = pK - h$ and $q_0 = (1-p)K + h$ with $h = p(1-p)\tau\Delta\sigma$, and $q_1 + q_0 = K$. The ambiguity term is

$$\mathcal{A}(\tau, \sigma_1, \sigma_0) = \frac{q_1 q_0}{q_1 + q_0} = p(1-p)K + (2p-1)h - \frac{h^2}{K}.$$

The volume-matched non-selective rule sets $\Delta\sigma = 0$ and hence $h = 0$, giving $\mathcal{A} = p(1-p)K$. The Bayesian information effect of selection is the difference,

$$\mathcal{A}(\tau, \sigma_1, \sigma_0) - p(1-p)(1-\tau\bar{\sigma}) = p(1-p)\tau(2p-1)\Delta\sigma - \frac{p^2(1-p)^2\tau^2(\Delta\sigma)^2}{1-\tau\bar{\sigma}},$$

which is positive if and only if $\Delta\sigma$ and $2p-1$ share a sign and $|\Delta\sigma| < |2p-1|(1-\tau\bar{\sigma})/\big(p(1-p)\tau\big)$. At $p = 1/2$ the linear term vanishes and the effect reduces to $-\tau^2(\Delta\sigma)^2/\big(16(1-\tau\bar{\sigma})\big) \leq 0$, so selection weakly reduces the ambiguity of non-receipt at a symmetric prior.

The realized accuracy cost of selection. Let g index environments with frequencies λ_g summing to one, disclosure rates σ_g, and conditional mean losses $\mathcal{L}_g^R$ under receipt and $\mathcal{L}_g^\varnothing$ under non-receipt. Receipt occurs with probability $\tau\sigma_g$, so

$$\mathcal{L}(\sigma) = \sum_g \lambda_g \left[\tau\sigma_g\, \mathcal{L}_g^R + (1 - \tau\sigma_g)\, \mathcal{L}_g^\varnothing\right].$$

Replacing every σ_g by $\bar{\sigma} = \sum_g \lambda_g \sigma_g$ and holding τ, the frequencies, and the conditional losses fixed,

$$\mathcal{L}(\sigma) - \mathcal{L}(\bar{\sigma}) = \tau \sum_g \lambda_g (\sigma_g - \bar{\sigma}) \left(\mathcal{L}_g^R - \mathcal{L}_g^\varnothing\right) = \tau\, \mathrm{Cov}_\lambda\left(\sigma_g,\ \mathcal{L}_g^R - \mathcal{L}_g^\varnothing\right), \qquad (10)$$

which is the realized accuracy cost of selection. Holding the conditional losses fixed is a restriction on receiver behavior rather than an accounting identity: it requires that

the receiver's reading of receipt and of non-receipt in environment g not respond to the disclosure rule that generated them.

On the final Experiment 4 sample, holding the disclosure rate fixed within each topic and reallocating it across environments, the counterfactual of Equation (10) changes belief accuracy by 0.0025 loss units, one percent of the mean realized loss of 0.255, and its bootstrap interval includes zero. Holding the rate fixed across both topics instead gives 0.0026. Either way the comparison holds the aggregate volume of disclosure fixed and is silent on why that volume is what it is. The quantity is identified on 155 of the 261 environments that receivers occupy (of 300 possible), those containing both a receipt and a non-receipt observation, covering 79.9 percent of receivers, and cell disclosure rates rest on a median of 31 sender decisions, so it is the least precisely measured quantity in this experiment.

The benchmark at the actual rates. Evaluating Equation (8) at the senders' actual disclosure rates in the cell of each receiver who saw no fact, with the receiver's own prior, prescribes a mean absolute belief movement of 1.95 points on the 0–100 scale. Across the 685 receivers who saw nothing, mean squared loss is 0.312 at the prior, 0.301 at the reported posterior and 0.310 at the Bayesian posterior, so Bayes' rule would lower loss after non-receipt by 0.002. Actual selectivity runs in opposite directions across sender stances (mean -0.024), and the Bayesian information effect of selection is -0.0005.